

Cycle Financing and Near-Convergent Diophantine Obstructions in the Juggler Map

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Abstract

The Juggler map is the nonlinear integer map

$$J(n) = \begin{cases} \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor, & n \text{ even,} \\ \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor, & n \text{ odd.} \end{cases}$$

It is conjectured that every positive integer eventually reaches 1. This paper does not prove that conjecture. It proves period lower bounds for a hypothetical nontrivial cycle, once a verified descent floor is given.

We develop a cycle-financing inequality for this floor-power map. Exact integer one-step preimages give a one-step logarithmic defect; cycle minimality lets that defect be unrolled against the cycle minimum; the formal surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must then be paid by a finite accumulated budget. For a hypothetical cycle of length L with o odd steps and minimum n ,

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o.$$

This inequality is the main theorem; every numerical period bound below is an instantiation of it, or of its coupled walk-charge refinement, at a certified descent floor. As a consequence, combining the inequality with the known verification through 10^6 yields $L \geq 25781$; at the laboratory-certified descent floor $N_0 = 26254995$ the same table yields $L \geq 50508$. The novelty is not a new computational record; it is that implication. A walk-charge envelope — transport of the floor losses to a reduced base, identification of the extremal exponent walk as a rotation itinerary, and a Denjoy–Koksma bound over certified Ostrowski blocks, census-free on the window $[50508, 16785921)$ — then extends the exclusion at the laboratory floor: any nontrivial cycle has period at least 176251. The same certified kill criterion at a second certified floor, $N_0 = 162849448$, on the surviving lengths — all inside the census-free window, which reaches up to but excludes the fan endpoint — gives period at least 478245. The main numerical result evaluates it once more at the third certified floor $N_0 = 350000000$: any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 780239. We also prove that every nontrivial cycle contains at least four even steps, and hence has period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22); that Lean statement uses no descent floor and holds for every $n \geq 2$. A computational strengthening (Theorem 3.31) raises the even count to eight and the period to twenty-two once the cycle minimum is at least 300 — every $n \leq 299$ reaches 1. That enumeration is not Lean. A floor-free gap transfer, $n \log n \cdot \min(o \log 3 - L \log 2, 1) \leq 2L$, combined with Rhin’s effective measure, excludes every cycle with $L^{14.3} \leq n \log n / 915$ and reduces the no-cycle problem to the long regime, where it remains open. The core lemmas are formalized in Lean 4; the descent floors and the per-length kill tables are independently certified computations, and the paper does not claim to be formally verified as a whole. Section 6 then prices the method rather than only stating its limits. The charges used here retain, at each fixed descent floor, a positive anchor term uniformly in the length. Proposition 6.2a proves that any refinement retaining that anchor can exclude only finitely many upper-convergent denominators; it makes no claim about charges without such an anchor. Thus this anchored finance/run/walk architecture does not by itself yield a cycle theorem, and the reach of the floor route is $\asymp \sqrt{N_0 \log N_0}$, or $\sqrt{N_0} \log N_0$ with the walk charge. Within the

relaxed configuration-majorant model of Section 6, finance is within the 6/5 it advertises, and the run-suffix law of Section 3, which is floor-free and length-free, is empty at exactly the lengths that survive finance. What a proof would need, and what is absent here, is a lower bound on the cycle minimum in terms of the period.

Two companion manuscripts use this paper's power envelope and certified floor as inputs: a parity-discrepancy paper (depth-4 equidistribution of nested floor powers, certificate density 7/8) and a fate-contagion paper, in which the floor is the target of a Tao-type reduction and the basin of any hypothetical cycle is shown to have logarithmic count $\gg (\log x)^{0.492}$; Section 6.1 records what they add to the cycle problem and what they do not.

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1. Introduction

The Juggler sequence was introduced by Pickover [1,2] as an interesting variation of the Collatz problem. Pickover's later exposition is Chapter 45 of [2], pp. 102–106. The object of study is the one-step map $J : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ displayed in the abstract. The *Juggler sequence* starting at n is the trajectory of iterates $n, J(n), J^2(n), \dots$. The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences records the one-step values of J as A094683 [3] and the number of steps to reach 1 (when that occurs) as A007320 [4]; those catalogue entries are not theorems of this paper.

The trajectory of 3 is 3, 5, 11, 36, 6, 2, 1. The trajectory of 37 already peaks at 24906114455136. Universal arrival at 1 remains an open conjecture. This paper does not prove that conjecture. It proves period lower bounds for a *hypothetical* nontrivial cycle, once a verified descent floor is given.

Throughout, $\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$. Write J^k for the k -fold iterate, and write $\lfloor x \rfloor$ for the integer part of a real $x \geq 0$: discard the fractional part. Thus $\lfloor 5.196 \dots \rfloor = 5$ and $\lfloor 6 \rfloor = 6$. The floor is applied after every branch of J , not once at the end of a walk.

The map combines a contracting even branch with an expanding odd branch,

$$E(n) = \lfloor n^{1/2} \rfloor, \quad O(n) = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor,$$

so $J(n) = E(n)$ when n is even and $J(n) = O(n)$ when n is odd.

Trajectory. The *trajectory* of $n \in \mathbb{N}$ is the sequence of values $n_0 = n, n_{i+1} = J(n_i)$ (also called an orbit in some dynamics texts).

Itinerary. The *itinerary* of the first k steps is the length- k string $w \in \{O, E\}^k$ with $w_i = O$ if n_i is odd and $w_i = E$ if n_i is even. Synonyms: itinerary = parity sequence; trajectory = orbit. The itinerary is the list of branch labels, not the list of values. The integer k is any finite prefix length; the definition does not assume that the trajectory reaches 1.

Ideal exponent. An itinerary of length k with o odd letters has ideal exponent $3^o/2^k$. Ignoring floors, those letters would multiply the start by that ratio. Floors make the actual image smaller.

Realized itinerary. An itinerary w is *realized* at n when the first $|w|$ parities of the trajectory of n are exactly the letters of w . Equivalently: a formal string over $\{O, E\}$ is an itinerary only when some start actually follows those branches. That is what is meant by: an itinerary is available only when the trajectory realizes those parities. Floors are applied after every letter of a realized itinerary.

One-step preimage. The map J is not invertible. For $m \in \mathbb{N}$, the *one-step preimage* of m is the set

$$J^{-1}(m) = \{k \in \mathbb{N} : J(k) = m\}.$$

An even image has a whole interval of even parents; an odd image has at most one odd parent (Lemma 3.1).

Lemma 1.1 (three fates). Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. The trajectory of n does exactly one of the following: (i) some iterate equals 1; (ii) some iterate $m \geq 2$ returns, and the trajectory is eventually periodic through a cycle

containing m ; (iii) the trajectory is unbounded. In particular, a bounded infinite trajectory is eventually periodic.

Proof. The map J is a well-defined function $\mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$, so the forward trajectory is an infinite sequence in $\mathbb{N}$. If some term equals 1, we are in (i); note $J(1) = 1$. If the trajectory is unbounded, we are in (iii). If the trajectory is infinite and bounded, the pigeonhole principle supplies a repeated value m ; uniqueness of the successor $J(m)$ then forces a cycle, which is (ii) unless $m = 1$, already covered by (i). $\square$

The lemma lists the only logical possibilities. It does not assert which fate occurs for a given start, and it is not a termination theorem.

Object	Meaning
J	the one-step map
E, O	even and odd branches
trajectory	the sequence of values
itinerary	a finite string in $\{O, E\}$ of parities
realized itinerary	the trajectory actually follows those letters
$3^o/2^k$	ideal exponent of an itinerary of length k with o odd letters
$J^{-1}(m)$	the one-step preimage of m
N_0	a verified descent floor (a computational input)
CycleMin	a minimum-based rotation of a cycle itinerary

The mechanism is the interaction of three elementary facts: exact integer one-step preimages, a logarithmic defect, and cycle minimality. Exact one-step preimages give a one-step logarithmic defect; cycle minimality lets the defect be unrolled against the cycle minimum; the formal surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must then be paid by a finite accumulated budget. That is Theorem 4.4:

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o.$$

The inequality $\log(1 + u) \leq u$ is the only analytic input; it is not the content of the theorem.

Write N_0 for a *verified descent floor*: every start $2 \leq n \leq N_0$ reaches 1. A floor is an input, not the result. Four instances are used. The base instance is $N_0 = 10^6$, reported by Weisstein [5] and recomputed here by exact first-passage. Combined with Theorem 4.4 it gives

$$\text{known verification through } 10^6 + \text{this inequality} \Rightarrow L \geq 25781.$$

The laboratory instance is $N_0 = 26254995$, certified by the same exact first-passage method (Proposition 5.1); the same table then gives $L \geq 50508$ (Theorem 5.2), and the walk-charge envelope of Section 5 amplifies it to $L \geq 176251$ (Theorem 5.9). Corollary 5.10 evaluates the same kill criterion at the second certified floor $N_0 = 162849448$, every survivor lying inside the $[50508, 16785921)$ window of Theorem 5.8, whose envelope therefore covers their charge, and gives $L \geq 478245$. The main numerical result is Corollary 5.11: at the third certified floor $N_0 = 350000000$ the same comparison gives $L \geq 780239$. The census-free window theorem covers $[50508, 16785921)$ — every nonendpoint member $L_0, \dots, L_{54}$ of the semiconvergent fan of Proposition 5.12; the endpoint $L_{55} = 16785921$ is excluded by the half-open interval — so the charge side of the later-floor kills needs no per-length dynamic program. The kill comparison itself stays per-length, because its left-hand side $\theta(L)$ is a Diophantine quantity the envelope does not control. The architecture is

$$\text{envelope} \rightarrow \text{cycle minimum} \rightarrow \text{finance} \rightarrow n_{\max}(L) \rightarrow N_0 \rightarrow L \geq 25781 \text{ at } 10^6,$$

extended at the laboratory floor by

$$\text{transport} \rightarrow \text{hug adversary} \rightarrow \text{itinerary identity} \rightarrow \text{Denjoy-Koksma} \rightarrow \text{window} \rightarrow L \geq 176251.$$

The computation supplies the endpoint N_0 . The mathematics amplifies that floor to the period bound.

Roadmap. Section 2 records the power envelope and the exact defect identity that explains it. Section 3 classifies minimum-based cycle itineraries and proves that every nontrivial cycle has at least four even letters (Theorem 3.22); Theorem 3.31 raises that to eight even letters, and period at least twenty-two, once the cycle minimum is at least 300. Section 4 records the excursion necklace of a minimum-based itinerary, unrolls the one-step-preimage logarithm around that minimum, obtains the finance inequality, and applies it at the known floor 10^6 . The necklace is the geometry of the unroll, not a fourth main theorem. A run-type packing of the same identity is a supporting refinement; the arithmetic of the leftover lengths is secondary. Section 5 certifies the laboratory floor 26254995, replaces the length-only charge by a coupled exponent-walk charge, identifies its extremal word as a rotation itinerary, and proves a census-free envelope for every length in the window $[50508, 16785921]$; the resulting kill table gives the period bound 176251, a certified evaluation of the same kill criterion at a second certified floor raises it to 478245 (Corollary 5.10), and a third certified floor raises it to 780239 (Corollary 5.11). Section 6 records limitations.

A nonempty realized itinerary w with $J^{|w|}(n) = n$ is a *cycle itinerary*. The unique fixed point is 1; a cycle is *nontrivial* when it contains some $n \geq 2$. A cycle word at n is *minimum-based* when n is a cycle minimum: $J^j(n) \geq n$ for every $0 \leq j < |w|$. Every cycle itinerary has a minimum-based rotation.

All exceptional sets below are *finance-survivor* sets: lengths that a stated form of the finance inequality does not exclude at the verified descent floor. They are not candidate cycle sets. A survivor count “through X ” is inclusive: it counts every surviving length $L \leq X$.

1.0 Main results

Contribution 1 — cycle-financing inequality. For a minimum-based cycle of length L with o odd steps,

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o$$

(Theorem 4.4). Floor defects become a quantitative bound on the cycle minimum.

Contribution 2 — structural itinerary obstruction. Every nontrivial cycle itinerary has at least four even letters, and hence period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22 and Corollary 3.23). That is the Lean statement, for every $n \geq 2$, and it uses no descent floor. The argument classifies the minimum-based itinerary geometry; it is not a raw census of itineraries of length at most ten. Theorem 3.31 is a computational strengthening of the same two envelopes: once the cycle minimum is at least 300 (every $n \leq 299$ reaches 1), no cycle itinerary has fewer than eight even letters, so a nontrivial cycle has period at least twenty-two. That enumeration is not Lean.

Contribution 3 — explicit conditional consequence for hypothetical cycles. Combined with the independently verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$, there is no nontrivial Juggler cycle of length at most 25780. Equivalently, any nontrivial cycle has period at least 25781 (Theorem 4.6(A)). At the laboratory-certified floor $N_0 = 26254995$ the same table gives period at least 50508 (Theorem 5.2).

Contribution 4 — walk-charge envelope and the main period bound. On a minimum-based cycle every state is coupled through one closed exponent walk. Transport of the floor losses to a reduced base (Theorem 5.3), identification of the extremal walk as the rotation (hug) itinerary (Theorem 5.4, Lemma 5.6), and a Denjoy–Koksma bound over certified Ostrowski blocks (Theorem 5.7) give a uniform envelope for every length in the window $[50508, 16785921]$ (Theorem 5.8) — census-free on that window, which covers $L_0, \dots, L_{54}$ but not its endpoint $L_{55} = 16785921$. At the laboratory floor the resulting kill table leaves a single finance survivor below $2 \cdot 10^5$: any nontrivial cycle has period at least 176251 (Theorem 5.9), the first laboratory instance. The second-floor evaluation is Corollary 5.10: at $N_0 = 162849448$ the same kill criterion, evaluated on the additional survivors — all inside the window, so all with a census-free charge bound — leaves only the semiconvergent fan member 478245. The main numerical result is Corollary 5.11: at the third certified floor $N_0 = 350000000$ that comparison leaves only the next fan member 780239: any nontrivial cycle has period at least 780239.

Contribution 5 — floor-free gap transfer and the short-cycle reduction. The finance inequality ties the relative surplus to the linear form $\Lambda = o \log 3 - L \log 2$ without any floor: $n \log n \cdot \min(\Lambda, 1) \leq 2L$ (Theorem 4.10, Lean `cycleMin_gap_transfer`). With Rhin’s effective measure this excludes every cycle

with $L^{14.3} \leq n \log n / 915$ (Corollary 4.11), for all $n \geq 2$. The statement is a reduction, not a kill: it is weaker than the finance table at every certified floor, and it shows that the no-cycle problem is exactly the exclusion of long cycles, $L > (n \log n / 915)^{1/14.3}$, where the finance survivors ($L \approx n^{0.59}$) live.

These statements are not interchangeable. Theorem 4.4 is the conceptual sharp inequality (constant 1). Corollary 4.5 is the convenient length-only statewise bound that turns a descent floor into a per-length exclusion. Theorem 4.6 is the numerical certification of that bound, and it uses a conservative coefficient 6/5 only as a uniform majorant; the headline cutoff 25781 is not an artifact of that majorant. Theorem 4.7 is a run-type refinement of the same defect sum. The leftover lengths through 10^5 are supporting material, not a second main theorem.

1.1 Related work

Pickover’s later exposition is Chapter 45 of [2], already cited above. Weisstein [5] records the map, the stopping-time sequences A094670, A094679, A095908, and a verification of arrival at 1 through 10^6 . That verified descent floor is the computational input to Theorem 4.6; the first-passage run of Appendix B recomputes it. OEIS A094716 [6] records extreme heights, including the start 48443 whose peak has 972 463 digits. Those height records do not bound the period.

Prasad–Prasad [7] estimate excursion and stopping constants for juggler-like maps by a random-walk large-deviation model; those estimates do not apply to exact cycles. Small-cycle censuses are a standard first layer for Collatz-like maps, surveyed by Lagarias [8,9]. Those results do not transfer: the branches of J are floor powers rather than affine maps (Crandall [10], Matthews–Watts [11]). In particular there is no identity of the form $n(2^K - 3^p) = C$. A check of Pickover [1,2], Weisstein [5], the OEIS records [3,4,6], the Prasad–Prasad estimates [7], and the standard Collatz cycle-bound sources [8–13] found no published explicit lower bound on the period of a nontrivial cycle for this exact floor-power Juggler map. Informal near-miss notes and later unverified webpage floors are not used.

Goodstein’s theorem is a superficially similar statement about natural numbers — every Goodstein sequence terminates at 0 — which cannot be proved in Peano arithmetic [14]. No such independence claim is made for the Juggler conjecture, and this paper does not study Goodstein sequences.

Companion manuscripts. Two later manuscripts by the author build on this one and are cited where they bear on the cycle problem. Paper B [16] proves parity equidistribution of the nested floor powers along the itineraries of J , with power savings, completely through depth four for odd-rooted itineraries and for the two length-five contractors, giving the certified-descent densities 13/16 and 7/8; its only input from this paper is the contraction criterion of Theorem 2.2. Paper C [17] proves that every nonempty backward-closed set — in particular the basin of any nontrivial cycle, and the set of divergent starts — has logarithmic count $\gg (\log x)^\lambda$ for $\lambda < \lambda^{**} = 0.4926$, and reduces the Juggler conjecture to a Tao-type almost-all statement whose bounded target is the certified floor of Section 5 and whose descent step is the power envelope of Theorem 2.2 (**power_bound_word**). Section 6.1 states precisely what those results add to the cycle problem, and what they leave untouched.

The layers of the argument are as follows.

1. *Classical ideas, not claimed as new:* cycle financing (Simons–de Weger [12]); logarithmic and continued-fraction approximation of $\log 2 / \log 3$, including Rhin’s effective measure for $o \log 3 - L \log 2$ [15], used only in Corollary 4.11; cycle-itinerary restrictions and leftover packaging (Eliahou [13]; Lagarias [8,9]); the Denjoy–Koksma inequality and Ostrowski numeration, used as known tools in Section 5.
2. *New object:* the exact one-step floor-power preimages of J .
3. *New theorem:* the Juggler-specific cycle-minimum finance inequality of Theorem 4.4.
4. *New consequence:* $L \geq 25781$ at the verified descent floor 10^6 .
5. *Supporting organization:* the run-packing refinement of the same defect sum (Theorem 4.7).
6. *New theorem:* the reduced-base transport and the uniform window envelope of Section 5 (Theorems 5.3 and 5.8).
7. *New consequence:* period at least 176251 at the laboratory floor 26254995 (Theorem 5.9), 478245 at the second certified floor 162849448 (Corollary 5.10), and 780239 at the third certified floor 350000000

(Corollary 5.11), every survivor inside the window of Theorem 5.8.

8. *Reduction*: the floor-free gap transfer (Theorem 4.10) and the short-cycle exclusion $L^{14.3} > n \log n / 915$ (Corollary 4.11), which locate the open problem in the long regime without claiming anything there.

The argument below is elementary and independent of the Diophantine tools of [12]: floor-power defects are relatively $O(1/x)$ in logarithms, so a uniform logarithmic floor-error bound, valid above the verified floor, excludes every length that is not a finance-survivor for Theorem 4.4. To the best of our knowledge, the Juggler-specific inequality and the explicit period bound it produces are new.

Novelty statement. For this nonlinear floor-power map, exact floor defects convert into a cycle-financing inequality that forces the minimum of a hypothetical cycle below the independently verified descent region unless the period is at least 25781. Coupling the states through the closed exponent walk and bounding the extremal rotation itinerary by Denjoy–Koksma over certified Ostrowski blocks raises that period bound to 176251 at the laboratory floor, census-free on an explicit window of lengths, and — by certified evaluation of the same kill criterion on the surviving lengths, all of which lie inside that window, the comparison against $\theta(L)$ remaining per-length — to 478245 at the second certified floor and 780239 at the third.

1.2 Verification

The arguments of Sections 2, 3, and 4 may be read without machine assistance. The core mathematical lemmas are mechanized in Lean 4; selected finite classifications and numerical tables are independently certified computations. Appendix A records the Lean names. The finite tables used by Lemmas 3.5, 3.7, 3.11 and Theorems 3.12–3.20 are `decide +kernel` evaluations in the modules named there: the reduction is performed by the Lean kernel, so these tables add no trust assumption beyond it. That holds throughout the Juggler layer with one exception, `window_digit_scan`: a scan of a quarter of a million window lengths in Section 5’s Ostrowski certification, which uses `native_decide` and so also trusts the Lean compiler and runtime. `#print axioms` on any theorem displays whether it depends on it.

It was two. The second, `greedy_eq_ostro_below_window`, scanned all 301994 lengths to identify the fold-form greedy digits with the function-form ones. They are the same algorithm written twice — the fold peels L/q and keeps $L \bmod q$ over the descending denominator list, the recursion does the same indexed by $12 - i$, and those two lists agree entry for entry — so `greedy_eq_ostro` proves the identity for *every* L , structurally, and the bounded scan is now a corollary of it. The reconstruction half of `window_digit_scan` went the same way: `greedy_reconstruct_all` is the division algorithm thirteen times and holds for every L . What still needs the scan is only the sharp constant 37, the structural cap being 47.

Every number printed in Sections 4 and 5 is additionally recomputed from the *printed* criterion, independently of the probes that produced the tables, by `research.juggler_sequence.paper_a_audit`: the record $n_{\max}$ values, the contiguous excluded prefix at each of the four certified floors, the Rhin constants of Corollary 4.11, the convergent asymptotic of Section 4, and the fan law of Proposition 5.12. Two of those recomputations are delicate enough to be worth stating. The crossings that define $n_{\max}(25781)$ and $n_{\max}(50508)$ are sharp to a relative $2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ and $3 \cdot 10^{-10}$ respectively — each is the *last* integer at which the parity comparison holds, and the next one fails — so $\theta = 1 - 2^L/3^o$ must be evaluated in extended precision: a double-precision evaluation of the exponent $L \log 2 - o \log 3$ carries enough relative error to move $n_{\max}(25781)$ to 26254996. The remaining terms may be evaluated in double precision, and are.

Proposition 1.3 (certified computational input). A machine-verifiable certificate establishes that every integer $2 \leq n \leq 10^6$ reaches 1. Precisely: an exact-integer first-passage run records, for each such n , a finite realized word with image strictly below the start; strong induction on that image reaches 1. The longest first passage in the window has 253 steps (seed 78901). Weisstein [5] records the same computational verification; the run here is an independent recomputation. The certificate files, SHA-256 hashes, and regeneration commands are Appendix B.

Roles. Independently proved: the finance inequality (Theorem 4.4). Computational input: every $2 \leq n \leq 10^6$ reaches 1 (this proposition), every $2 \leq n \leq 26254995$ reaches 1 (Proposition 5.1, the laboratory instance), every $2 \leq n \leq 162849448$ reaches 1 (Corollary 5.10, the second laboratory instance), and every

$2 \leq n \leq 350000000$ reaches 1 (Corollary 5.11, the third laboratory instance). Independently recomputed: the exact first-passage runs of Appendix B. Not proved: global termination.

Theorem 4.6 applies Corollary 4.5 to this input and certifies the table with the conservative coefficient $6/5$. The whole comparison it tests is Lean: `cycleMin_defect_threeTerm (FinanceTransfer.lean)` is the certified identity `cycleMin_defect_finance` composed with the three-class charge `cycleMin_threeTerm`, so what stays verified computation is the per-length arithmetic and the descent floor, not the inequality. Theorem 4.7 carries two hypotheses — the itinerary is primitive and contains no `EE` — without which its displayed counts fail; §4 prices them below. Given them the display is Lean (`cycleMin_sixTerm`), so they are sufficient as well as necessary. Theorem 4.8 reuses the gap table under that packing, and 18 of its 42 exclusions inherit the second hypothesis. Proposition 4.9 is integer arithmetic in Lean. In Section 5’s Denjoy–Koksma core is Lean end to end relative to the circle integral. Its observable’s variation is `observable_window_variation_lt_two`, proved for `periodicObservable` itself on every unit window; `denjoy_koksma_rotation` is Lean from positivity, coprimality and $|\theta - p/q| \leq 1/q^2$, and `denjoy_koksma_blocks` composes the blocks uniformly in their starting phase. The one-statement display is `hugCharge_sub_circleMean_le`. Two bridges in the printed Theorem 5.7 stay human: it quantifies over any decomposition into actual convergents while that named theorem fixes the certified Ostrowski assembly, and it writes the circle integral as the explicit C_* of Proposition 5.5. Lemma 5.6 is Lean on both halves: the itinerary identity (`budgetedWord_eq_hugWord`) and the rotation identification (`hugOdds_eq_sub_floor`, `hugWalk_eq_fract`, `HugRotation.lean`). The Laplace bound of Proposition 5.5 is Lean (`rotation_average_le`, `rotationAverage_gap`), and `denjoy_koksma_blocks` proves convergence of the finite hug averages to the circle integral for the bounded-variation observable. The elementary change of variables identifying that circle integral with the displayed `rotationAverage (log n')` remains prose; the transport inequality of Theorem 5.3 (`cycleMin_transport`), the defect-to-hug-charge consequence of §5.2 (`cycleMin_defect_le_charge`, `cycleMin_defect_le_hug_charge`), the charge-maximisation and strict-uniqueness halves of Theorem 5.4 (`hug_charge_maximal`, `hug_charge_unique`), the general digit machinery and the instantiated cap below $q_{13} = 301994$ (`ostroDigit_le`, `theta_digitSum_le`, `window_digit_scan`), and the kill template of Theorem 5.9 (`cycleMin_hug_kill_criterion`) are Lean-verified; Theorems 5.2 and 5.9 are independently certified computations at the laboratory floor, with the same trust boundary as Theorem 4.6 (exact integer arithmetic plus guarded float comparisons). This is not a claim that the paper as a whole is formally verified.

```
Repository: https://github.com/sneakyweasel/btlab
Commit:    7802f78bec58c68cec92a2efb3db4a502f916277
Lean:      leanprover/lean4:v4.33.1
Mathlib:   v4.33.1 (lake-manifest rev 0df444a360eaa60ab8c11dca51a86af692955474)
Build:     lake build Problems.JugglerPaper (from formal/)
Computation: python -m research.juggler_sequence.cycle_finance
              (parity table); run-type table in budget_opt.json
SHA-256:   Appendix B
```

The commit is the repository state that produced the finance tables. A later editorial commit of this text does not change those hashes.

1.3 Notation

Symbols that recur across sections are listed here with the one meaning each carries. Three letters were doing double duty in earlier drafts and have been separated: the constant of Lemma 3.3 is now G_a rather than e_a , which freed e for the even count alone; the per-step exponent is h rather than e , which also keeps it clear of ε_i in the same formula; and the backward exponent of a suffix is the named $T(u)$ rather than a pair $2^s/3^l$, which freed s for the digit sum of Section 5.

symbol	meaning	first used
J	the Juggler map	§1
n	a start; on a cycle, its minimum	throughout

symbol	meaning	first used
N_0	a verified descent floor: every start $\leq N_0$ reaches 1	§1
x_k	the state after k steps	§4
w, v, u	an itinerary word, a prefix of it, a suffix of it	§1, §3.9
O, E	the odd and the even letter	§1
L	the length of w ; on a cycle, the period	§3
o, e	the odd and even letter counts, $e = L - o$	§3
a, b, c	the odd-run lengths of the canonical form $O^aEO^bEO^cE$	§3
a_i, a_k	the i -th odd run; the odd count after k steps	§4, §5
r	the length of a trailing even run	§3.9
h	the per-step exponent: 1 on an even letter, 3 on an odd one	§4
d	the depth of an itinerary	§6 only
G_a	$2(3^a - 2^a)$, the exponent of 2 in Lemma 3.3's constant	§3
X_a, Y_a	$3(3^a - 2^a)$ and $2 \cdot 3^a - 3 \cdot 2^a$, the sharp envelope exponents	§3.9
$B(u)$	the backward envelope of a suffix (Lemma 3.25)	§3.9
$T(u)$	$2^{ u }/3^{\#O(u)}$, the backward exponent of a suffix	§3.9
θ	$1 - 2^L/3^o$, the expansion margin	§1, §4
Λ	$o \log 3 - L \log 2 = -\log(1 - \theta)$	§3, §5
μ	$\log_2(3/2)$	§5
u_k	$(1 + \mu)a_k - k$, the exponent walk	§5
w_k	$2^{u_k} = 3^{a_k}/2^k$, the walk weight	§5
n'	$n e^{-D}$, the reduced base, with D the deficit of §5.1	§5
C_L, C_*	the charge per letter of a word, and its limit	§5
g	the charge weight $1/(e^{W\nu}W\nu)$	§5
p_j/q_j	the continued-fraction convergents of $\log_2 3$	§5
$b_j, s(L)$	the Ostrowski digits of $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$, and their sum	§5
$n_{\max}(L)$	the largest cycle minimum the kill criterion admits at length L	§1, §5

Two letters are used in more than one way, deliberately and locally. e is also Euler's number in the numerical estimates of §3 and §5, where it appears only as e^x and never with a subscript. And s is an integration variable inside the two displays of §5.4 that evaluate C_* ; the digit sum always carries its argument, $s(L)$. No other symbol in the paper is bound twice.

2. Envelope

Let $\mathcal{B} = \{E, O\}$. A finite itinerary $w \in \mathcal{B}^*$ is *realized* at $n \in \mathbb{N}$ when the successive parities of the trajectory of n are exactly the letters of w . Write $J^{|w|}(n)$ for the endpoint after those letters, and $\#O(w)$ for the

number of odd letters. When w is realized, this endpoint is the $|w|$ -fold iterate.

Theorem 2.1 (fixed-itinerary monotonicity). If $n \leq m$ and both realize w , then $J^{|w|}(n) \leq J^{|w|}(m)$.

Proof. Induct on w . The empty itinerary is immediate. The images after a common realized prefix remain ordered, and both current states realize the same next letter. The even branch is the monotone integer square root; the odd branch is $x \mapsto x^3$ followed by the integer square root. $\square$

The realizing set of a fixed word need not be an interval: OE is realized at 7 and at 11 but not at 9.

Theorem 2.2 (finite-itinerary power envelope). If w is realized at n and $m = J^{|w|}(n)$, then

$$m^{2^{|w|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}.$$

Proof. The empty itinerary is the equality $n \leq n$. Suppose a realized prefix of length ℓ with odd count o ends at x and satisfies $x^{2^\ell} \leq n^{3^o}$, and the next letter is realized.

If the next letter is even, then $J(x)^2 \leq x$. Raising the inductive bound to the second power gives

$$J(x)^{2^{\ell+1}} = (J(x)^2)^{2^\ell} \leq x^{2^\ell} \leq n^{3^o}.$$

The odd count is unchanged.

If the next letter is odd, then $J(x)^2 \leq x^3$, so

$$J(x)^{2^{\ell+1}} = (J(x)^2)^{2^\ell} \leq x^{3 \cdot 2^\ell} = (x^{2^\ell})^3 \leq (n^{3^o})^3 = n^{3^{o+1}}.$$

This is the claimed bound after one more odd letter. $\square$

Corollary 2.3 (exponent-gap contraction). If $n \geq 2$, w is realized at n , and $3^{\#O(w)} < 2^{|w|}$, then $J^{|w|}(n) < n$.

Proof. Let $m = J^{|w|}(n)$ and $k = |w|$. Theorem 2.2 gives $m^{2^k} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. The exponent gap and $n \geq 2$ give $n^{3^{\#O(w)}} < n^{2^k}$, so $m^{2^k} < n^{2^k}$. Since $m \geq 1$, one has $m < n$. $\square$

The corollary includes familiar contracting blocks such as $OOOEE$. It does not prove that every start realizes some contracting itinerary.

2.4 Exact floor defect

Theorem 2.2 is the inequality form of an exact identity

$$n^{3^{\#O(w)}} = J^{|w|}(n)^{2^{|w|}} + \Delta_w(n), \quad \Delta_w(n) \geq 0.$$

The identity, its vanishing law, and the two-term composition are Theorems 2.4–2.6 and Corollary 2.7 in Appendix C. A mixed realized word has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$. This explains why the envelope of Theorem 2.2 is true, and why a mixed cycle itinerary is formally expanding. Theorem 4.4 uses only the nonnegativity $\Delta_w(n) \geq 0$.

No uniform local tax exists: the relative slack of a single letter tends to 0 with the state. Finance must therefore be a global comparison, not a fixed cost per odd or even step. A quantitative itinerary-dependent lower bound on Δ_w , or a tighter upper bound on $\sum 1/(x_i \log x_i)$, would improve the period cutoff; neither is proved here.

3. Structural restrictions on cycle itineraries

The role of this section in the paper is structural, not numerical. The minimum geometry established here — the cycle minimum is odd, prefixes to even states are superquadratic (Theorem 3.2), a minimum-based itinerary has the canonical run form of Lemma 3.21b, and the last even letter lands in an explicit one-step preimage (Lemma 3.4(iv)) — is exactly what the finance unroll of Section 4 and the transport of Section 5 consume. The even-count exclusion (Theorem 3.22: every nontrivial cycle itinerary has at least four even

letters, hence period at least eleven) is the section's own headline, but as a period bound it is superseded the moment financing appears; it is retained because it is floor-free. The small-period censuses (Theorems 3.6 and 3.8) are supporting. Main-text proofs are kept to the short structural lemmas; the longer case analyses — Lemmas 3.5 and 3.7, the censuses of Theorems 3.6 and 3.8, and the family exclusions of Theorems 3.12–3.21 — are Appendix D. After the one-step preimages, a minimum-based itinerary has a canonical run form. There are only three even-count regimes with $e \leq 3$; each reduces to a finite collection of geometries $O^a EO^b EO^c E$. Those geometries are eliminated by a next-square obstruction, by long odd-run growth against a last-even one-step preimage, or by a finite exceptional window. The family calculations are Appendix D.

The exact one-step fibers are

$$J(n) = q \iff q^2 \leq n < (q+1)^2 \quad (n \text{ even})$$

and

$$J(n) = m \iff m^2 \leq n^3 < (m+1)^2 \quad (n \text{ odd}).$$

Lemma 3.1 (odd one-step preimages are unique). An odd fiber contains at most one integer. An even fiber is a parity-restricted square interval and may contain many predecessors.

Proof. Suppose $a < b$ lie in the same odd one-step preimage indexed by m . Then $(a+1)^3 \leq b^3 < (m+1)^2$ and $m^2 \leq a^3$. Subtracting the latter lower bound from the former upper bound gives

$$3a^2 + 3a + 1 = (a+1)^3 - a^3 < (m+1)^2 - m^2 = 2m + 1,$$

hence $3a^2 + 3a < 2m$ and $3a^2 < 2m$. If $a = 0$, then $m = 0$ and the displayed strict inequality is already impossible. If $a > 0$, squaring and using $m^2 \leq a^3$ gives $9a^4 < 4m^2 \leq 4a^3$, contradicting $4a^3 < 9a^4$. $\square$

Theorem 3.2 (cycle restrictions). Let w be a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 2$.

(i) The itinerary is formally expanding:

$$2^{|w|} < 3^{\#O(w)}.$$

A contracting itinerary cannot close a nontrivial cycle.

(ii) The cycle minimum is odd and the cycle maximum is even. A minimum-based orientation cannot end in an odd letter.

(iii) A realized itinerary v is *superquadratic* if

$$3^{\#O(v)} \geq 2^{|v|+1}.$$

Any realized path from a start $n \geq 2$ to a state at least n^2 is superquadratic. On a cycle minimum the path to any later even state is superquadratic. The prefix OOE is expanding ($9 > 8$) but not superquadratic ($9 < 16$), so it cannot carry the minimum to square scale.

Proof. For (i), Theorem 2.2 applied to a cycle endpoint gives $n^{2^{|w|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. Since $n \geq 2$, comparison of exponents gives $2^{|w|} \leq 3^{\#O(w)}$; equality is impossible because the two sides have different prime divisors and $|w| \geq 1$. Alternatively: a mixed cycle itinerary has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$ by Theorem 2.5 in Appendix C, so the envelope is strict; a monochrome tower cannot return for $n \geq 2$.

Every state on such a cycle is at least 2: once a trajectory reaches 1, it remains there and cannot return to a start $n \geq 2$. An even state $x \geq 2$ satisfies $J(x) < x$, so a cycle minimum cannot be even. An odd state $x \geq 3$ satisfies $J(x) > x$, so a cycle maximum cannot be odd. This proves the first assertion of (ii). For the final-letter assertion, let x be the predecessor of a minimum-oriented return n . If the last letter were odd, the odd return one-step preimage would give $n^2 \leq x^3 < (n+1)^2$. Minimality gives $x \geq n$, hence $n^3 < (n+1)^2$, impossible for $n \geq 3$; and the minimum is odd, so $n \geq 3$.

For (iii), let a realized itinerary v send n to $y \geq n^2$. Theorem 2.2 gives

$$n^{2^{|v|+1}} = (n^2)^{2^{|v|}} \leq y^{2^{|v|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(v)}}.$$

Since $n \geq 2$, comparison of exponents proves the superquadratic inequality. On a cycle minimum, if a later state y is even, its successor is at least n . Thus $n \leq J(y) = \lfloor \sqrt{y} \rfloor$, so $n^2 \leq y$, and the preceding argument applies to that prefix. $\square$

Lemma 3.21b (canonical run form). After rotation to a minimum-based orientation, the itinerary begins with OO and ends with E ; hence every itinerary with $1 \leq e \leq 3$ even letters has the canonical run decomposition $O^aEO^bEO^cE$ (unused runs empty). The case $e = 0$ is all-odd and is already forbidden by the last-letter restriction. No other cyclic rotation needs a separate case.

Proof. Theorem 3.2: the minimum is odd, so the itinerary cannot begin with E or OE , and it cannot end with an odd letter. Thus a minimum-based itinerary starts OO and ends E , so $e \geq 1$. The remaining letters are odd runs separated by the e even letters, so the itinerary is $O^{a_1}E \cdots O^{a_e}E$ with $a_1 \geq 2$. For $e \leq 3$ this is $O^aEO^bEO^cE$ with unused runs empty. Every cycle itinerary has a minimum-based rotation of the same even-count, and that orientation is already in this form. $\square$

Thus it is enough to exclude the three regimes $e = 1, 2, 3$. The rest of the section does that. Theorems 3.6 and 3.8 record the short-period consequences; Theorem 3.22 is the structural statement.

Lemma 3.3 (coarse lower envelope). For $n \geq 1$, write $q = \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor$. Then $q^2 \leq n < (q+1)^2$. For $q \geq 1$ one has $(q+1)^2 \leq 4q^2$, and the second inequality is strict for $q \geq 2$, while for $q = 1$ one has $n < 4$. In all cases

$$n < 4 \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor^2.$$

Thus an even step satisfies $n \leq 4J(n)^2$ and an odd step satisfies $n^3 \leq 4J(n)^2$. Composing along a realized itinerary v of length k with odd count o gives

$$n^{3^o} \leq C_v J^k(n)^{2^k}.$$

The constant starts at 1 and updates by $C \mapsto C \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an even letter and $C \mapsto C^3 \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an odd letter, at step j . In particular $C_{OOO} = 2^{38}$ and $C_{OOOO} = 2^{130}$.

Proof. The comparison $n < 4q^2$ is the paragraph above. The composition law is the same recurrence as the proof of Theorem 2.2, with a factor 4^{2^j} inserted at each letter. The values C_{OOO} and C_{OOOO} are the result of that recurrence on those two words. $\square$

Lemma 3.4 (next-square thresholds). (i) If $q \geq 5$ realizes OO , then $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (ii) If $q \geq 3$ realizes OOO , then $J^3(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (iii) If a realized itinerary v satisfies $J^{|v|}(q) \geq (q+1)^2$ and the next realized letter is odd, then $J^{|v|+1}(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (iv) If vE is a cycle itinerary at n , then $J^{|v|}(n) < (n+1)^2$. (v) If $a \geq 3$, then O^aE is not a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. For (i), write $m = \lfloor q^{3/2} \rfloor$. The bound $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$ follows from $m^3 \geq (q+1)^4$, because then $\lfloor m^{3/2} \rfloor \geq (q+1)^2$. If $q = 5$, then $11^2 = 121 \leq 125 = 5^3 < 144 = 12^2$, so $m = 11$, and $11^3 = 1331 \geq 6^4 = 1296$. Since q realizes OO , it is odd, so the only remaining case is $q \geq 7$. Then $m \geq q^{3/2} - 1$, so it is enough that $(q^{3/2} - 1)^3 \geq (q+1)^4$. Expanding the left side and dropping the positive remainder $3q^{3/2} - 1$ reduces this to $q^{9/2} - 3q^3 \geq (q+1)^4$, or equivalently $\sqrt{q} - 3/q \geq (1 + 1/q)^4$. The left side increases for $q > 0$ and the right side decreases, so the case $q = 7$ suffices:

$$\sqrt{7} - \frac{3}{7} > \frac{5}{2} - \frac{3}{7} = \frac{29}{14} > \frac{4096}{2401} = \left(\frac{8}{7}\right)^4,$$

where $\sqrt{7} > 5/2$ follows from $25/4 < 7$.

For (ii), the trajectory $3 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 11 \rightarrow 36$ gives $J^3(3) = 36 \geq 16$. If $q \geq 5$ realizes OOO , then it realizes OO , so (i) gives $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. The third letter is odd, hence $J^3(q) = J(J^2(q)) \geq J^2(q)$.

For (iii), the image after v is odd and at least $(q+1)^2 \geq 4$, so the odd branch does not decrease it.

For (iv), the last letter is even, so the preimage $z = J^{|v|}(n)$ is even and satisfies $n^2 \leq z < (n+1)^2$.

For (v), suppose O^aE is a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 2$. The start is odd, hence at least 3, and realizes O^a . Parts (ii) and (iii) give $J^a(n) \geq (n+1)^2$, contradicting (iv). $\square$

Lemma 3.5 (two length-six exclusions). Neither $OOEOE$ nor $OOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.6 (small-cycle census). No itinerary of length at most six is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial Juggler cycle, if one exists, has period at least seven.

Proof. Appendix D. The reduction used there — an all-odd itinerary cannot return, and every mixed cycle itinerary rotates to an even-terminating cycle itinerary based at a cycle state $m \geq 2$ — is reused by Theorem 3.8 and Theorem 3.22.

Lemma 3.4(v) excludes every odd-run-then-even word O^aE with $a \geq 3$, of any length.

Lemma 3.7 (two length-seven exclusions). Neither $OOOOEOE$ nor $OOOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.8 (small-cycle census through length seven). No itinerary of length at most seven is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial Juggler cycle, if one exists, has period at least eight.

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorems 3.6 and 3.8 are supporting period statements. The structural claim is the even-count exclusion of Theorem 3.22. The same one-step preimages organise leftover itineraries by even-count. Write

$$G_a = 2(3^a - 2^a)$$

for $a \geq 0$.

Lemma 3.9 (trailing even run). If a cycle itinerary based at n ends with $r \geq 1$ even letters, the state immediately before that run is strictly less than $(n+1)^{2^r}$.

Proof. The case $r = 1$ is Lemma 3.4(iv). Suppose the claim holds for some $r \geq 1$, and let vE^{r+1} be a cycle itinerary at n . Write $z = J^{|v|}(n)$. The inductive hypothesis applied to the suffix E^r after the first of those even letters gives $J(z) < (n+1)^{2^r}$. The state z is even, so $z < (J(z) + 1)^2 \leq ((n+1)^{2^r})^2 = (n+1)^{2^{r+1}}$. $\square$

Lemma 3.10 (odd-run lower envelope). If $n \geq 1$ realizes O^a , then

$$n^{3^a} \leq 2^{G_a} J^a(n)^{2^a}.$$

Proof. Lemma 3.3 supplies a multiplicative constant C_v along any realized itinerary, with $C_\varepsilon = 1$, $C \mapsto C \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an even letter, and $C \mapsto C^3 \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an odd letter, at step j . On the pure odd word O^a every letter is odd, so $C_{O^{a+1}} = C_{O^a}^3 \cdot 4^{2^a}$. Writing $C_{O^a} = 2^{G_a}$ with $G_0 = 0$ yields the recurrence $G_{a+1} = 3G_a + 2^{a+1}$, because $4^{2^a} = 2^{2^{a+1}}$. The closed form $G_a = 2(3^a - 2^a)$ satisfies the recurrence and the initial value. $\square$

Lemma 3.11 (seven-odd window). No integer n with $2 \leq n < 256$ realizes the itinerary O^7 .

Proof. This is a table of 254 seven-step evaluations: at every such start, some letter fails to match the current parity. The same finite check is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_follows_seven_odds_of_lt256` (Appendix A). $\square$

Theorem 3.12 (two-even leftover families). Let $k \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. Neither $O^{k-2}EE$ nor $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

A cycle itinerary w at n is *minimum-based* when n is a cycle minimum: $J^j(n) \geq n$ for every $0 \leq j < |w|$. The remainder after a proper prefix of a cycle itinerary need not itself be a cycle itinerary at the prefix endpoint. The next statement therefore transports the tail inequality of Theorem 3.12, not the cycle-itinerary exclusion at a later start.

Theorem 3.13 (first-even transport). Let $n \geq 2$. No minimum-based cycle itinerary at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Appendix D.

The hypothesis that the start is a cycle minimum is essential. If $y < n$, the leftover one-step preimage is measured against a larger start and need not contradict the tail at y . In particular, Theorem 3.13 does not assert that those itineraries fail to be cycle itineraries at a non-minimum start. That upgrade is Theorem 3.21.

Theorem 3.14 (three trailing evens). Let $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.15 (mixed bunched family EOEE). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.16 (mixed bunched family EOOEE). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEOOEE is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.17 (mixed bunched family EOOOEE). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^aEOOOEE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.18 (mixed bunched family EEOE). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEEOE is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.19 (mixed bunched family EOEOE). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEOEOE is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.20 (mixed bunched family EOOEOE). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^aEOOEOE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.21 (gapped leftovers as cycle itineraries). Let $n \geq 2$. No cycle itinerary at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorems 3.12–3.21 assemble into an even-count exclusion: no cycle itinerary has fewer than four even letters, so a nontrivial cycle has period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22). Section 4 excludes later periods by financing.

Every integer $2 \leq n < 12$ reaches 1, so a cycle minimum is at least 12. Write e for the number of even letters. Lemma 3.21b is the canonical run form.

Lemma 3.21a (classification). Every minimum-based cycle itinerary with at most three even letters belongs to one of the families excluded by Lemma 3.4(v) and Theorems 3.12–3.21.

Proof. Lemma 3.21b puts the itinerary in the form $O^aEO^bEO^cE$ with $a \geq 2$ and unused runs empty. If $e = 0$, the itinerary is all-odd. If $e = 1$, it is O^aE . If $e = 2$, a last run $c \geq 2$ is the internal-even bootstrap of Lemma 3.4, and the remaining shapes are the two-even families of Theorem 3.12. If $e = 3$, again $c \geq 2$ is the bootstrap, while $c \in \{0, 1\}$ is either a gapped leftover (Theorem 3.21) or one of the seven bunched families (Theorems 3.14–3.20). $\square$

	remaining minimum-based	
e	forms	elimination
0	all-odd	cannot return (Theorem 3.6)
1	$O^a E$	next-square; Lemma 3.4(v)
2	$O^a EE$, $O^a EOE$, last run ≥ 2	Theorem 3.12; Lemma 3.4
3	bunched families and gapped leftovers	Theorems 3.14–3.21
≥ 4	not excluded by even-count	finance (Section 4)

Theorem 3.22 (even-count). No itinerary with fewer than four even letters is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial cycle itinerary has at least four even letters.

Proof. Every cycle itinerary has a minimum-based rotation, with the same even-count. Lemma 3.21b puts that orientation in canonical run form; Lemma 3.21a names the families. In detail:

If $e = 0$, the itinerary is all-odd and cannot return, as in Theorem 3.6.

If $e = 1$, the itinerary is $O^a E$ with $a \geq 2$. The case $a = 2$ is OOE , excluded in Theorem 3.6. The cases $a \geq 3$ are Lemma 3.4(v).

If $e = 2$, the itinerary is $O^a EO^c E$ with $a \geq 2$. A last odd-run $c \geq 2$ is an internal even letter followed by OO or OOO . Lemma 3.4 at the cycle minimum ($n \geq 12$) contradicts the last-even one-step preimage. The remaining shapes are $O^a EE$ and $O^a EOE$. Expansion forces $a \geq 4$ and $a \geq 3$ respectively, so both are Theorem 3.12.

If $e = 3$, the itinerary is $O^a EO^b EO^c E$ with $a \geq 2$. Again $c \geq 2$ is the internal-even bootstrap. The remaining last runs are $c = 0$ and $c = 1$. For $c = 0$ and $b \geq 4$ the itinerary is a gapped leftover $O^a EO^b EE$, excluded by Theorem 3.21. For $c = 0$ and $b \leq 3$ the word is one of $O^a EEE$, $O^a EOOE$, $O^a EOOEE$, $O^a EOOOEE$, excluded by Theorems 3.14–3.17 once expansion supplies the stated lower bounds on a . For $c = 1$ and $b \geq 3$ the itinerary is a gapped leftover $O^a EO^b EOE$, excluded by Theorem 3.21. For $c = 1$ and $b \leq 2$ the itinerary is one of $O^a EEEOE$, $O^a EOEEOE$, $O^a EOOEOE$, excluded by Theorems 3.18–3.20.

Thus $e \leq 3$ is impossible. $\square$

Corollary 3.23. A nontrivial cycle, if one exists, has period at least eleven.

Proof. Theorem 3.22 gives four even letters, hence $o \leq L - 4$. Formal expansion is $2^L < 3^o \leq 3^{L-4}$. The comparison $2^L < 3^{L-4}$ first holds at $L = 11$. $\square$

In particular there is no cycle of length eight, nine, or ten.

3.9 One inequality behind the eleven exclusions

Theorems 3.12–3.21 read as a list of eleven families with eleven thresholds 3, 4, 3, 6, 5, 4, 3, 5, 4, 3. They are not a list. Every proof in Appendix D runs the same two envelopes against each other — the odd-run lower envelope of Lemma 3.10 pushing the state up, and the one-step preimage of the trailing letters holding it down — and the threshold is wherever the two exponents cross. Stating the crossing once makes the eleven proofs one theorem and the eleven thresholds one table.

Lemma 3.24 (odd-run envelope in closed form). If $n \geq 1$ realizes O^a , then

$$J^a(n) \geq 4 \left(\frac{n}{4} \right)^{(3/2)^a}.$$

Proof. Lemma 3.10 is $n^{3^a} \leq 2^{G_a} J^a(n)^{2^a}$ with $G_a = 2(3^a - 2^a)$. Taking 2^a -th roots gives $J^a(n) \geq n^{(3/2)^a} 2^{-G_a/2^a}$, and $G_a/2^a = 2((3/2)^a - 1)$, so the factor is $4^{1-(3/2)^a}$. $\square$

One constant and one exponent. The constant 4 is the whole cost of Lemma 3.3's coarse step bound, paid once rather than a times, and the exponent $(3/2)^a$ is the formal expansion rate. The next lemma is the

matching upper envelope, and it is Lemma 3.9 with the hypothesis that the run is even deleted from the induction.

Lemma 3.25 (backward envelope). Let w be a cycle itinerary at n . For each suffix u of w , define an integer $B(u)$ by

$$B(\varepsilon) = n + 1, \quad B(Eu) = B(u)^2, \quad B(Ou) = \min\{c \in \mathbb{Z} : c^3 \geq B(u)^2\}.$$

Then the state entering u is strictly less than $B(u)$.

Proof. Induction on $|u|$, from the empty suffix. The state entering ε is the return $n < n + 1$. Let x be the state entering Eu or Ou and $y = J(x)$ the state entering u , so $y < B(u)$ and, both being integers, $y + 1 \leq B(u)$. If x is even, the even one-step preimage gives $x < (y + 1)^2 \leq B(u)^2$. If x is odd, the odd one-step preimage gives $x^3 < (y + 1)^2 \leq B(u)^2$, so x is below the least integer whose cube reaches $B(u)^2$. $\square$

Lemma 3.9 is the case $u = E^r$, where no cube root is taken and $B(E^r) = (n + 1)^{2^r}$ exactly. In general, write

$$T(u) = \frac{2^{|u|}}{3^{\#O(u)}}$$

for the *backward exponent* of a suffix — one factor 2 per even letter, one factor $\frac{2}{3}$ per odd letter, read from the return backwards. Then

$$B(u) \geq (n + 1)^{T(u)},$$

with the excess coming only from rounding cube roots up. That excess is additive in the state and therefore invisible in the exponent at scale: for the ten suffixes below it is at most $7 \cdot 10^{-5}$ in $\log_{n+1} B(u)$ at $n = 10^3$, and below 10^{-15} by $n = 10^{12}$.

Theorem 3.26 (run–suffix law). Let w be a minimum-based cycle itinerary at $n \geq 4$, and write $w = v O^a u$ where O^a is a maximal odd run, $a \geq 1$, so that u is empty or begins with an even letter. If u is nonempty, then

$$4 \left(\frac{n}{4} \right)^{(3/2)^a} < B(u).$$

Proof. Let $m = J^{|v|}(n)$ be the state at the start of the run. The itinerary is minimum-based, so $m \geq n \geq 4$, and m realizes O^a . Lemma 3.24 at m , with the right side increasing in m , gives $J^a(m) \geq 4(n/4)^{(3/2)^a}$. That state is the one entering u , which Lemma 3.25 puts strictly below $B(u)$. $\square$

Read at leading order, with $B(u) \approx (n + 1)^{T(u)}$, the law says

$$\left(\frac{3}{2} \right)^a \leq T(u), \quad \text{equivalently} \quad 3^{\#O(O^a u)} \leq 2^{|O^a u|}.$$

That is, the tail $O^a u$ is not formally expanding, so the law is the exact mirror of Theorem 3.2(i): *the whole word must be formally expanding, and no tail of it beginning with an odd letter may be*. The two are not in conflict because the leading-order reading is only valid with room to spare. Writing $\theta = 1 - 2^{|O^a u|} / 3^{\#O(O^a u)}$ for the margin of the tail, the law fires once

$$\theta > \frac{\log 4}{\log n},$$

this being what the constant of Lemma 3.24 costs, and the whole word is precisely the tail whose margin is too thin to pay. Recovering that margin is what Section 4 does: financing the cycle globally replaces the flat factor 4 per step by a loss of relative size $1/(x \log x)$ at a state x , which is how the bound $n \log n \theta \leq L$ of Theorem 4.4 gains the factor $n \log n$ that Theorem 3.26 does not have.

Corollary 3.27 (eleven statements, ten suffixes). Each row below is Theorem 3.26 for one suffix. The column *least a* is the least odd-run length with $(3/2)^a > T(u)$; the column n_u is the least cycle minimum at which the law fires, computed against the exact envelope $B(u)$ of Lemma 3.25.

suffix u	$T(u)$	least a	n_u	printed in
E	2	2	1032	Lemma 3.4(v), at $a \geq 3$
EE	4	4	205	Theorems 3.12, 3.21
EOE	8/3	3	109	Theorems 3.12, 3.21
EEE	8	6	73	Theorem 3.14
$EOEE$	16/3	5	60	Theorem 3.15
$EOOEE$	32/9	4	45	Theorem 3.16
$EOOOEE$	64/27	3	30	Theorem 3.17
$EEOE$	16/3	5	60	Theorem 3.18
$EOEOE$	32/9	4	45	Theorem 3.19
$EOOEOE$	64/27	3	30	Theorem 3.20

Nine of the ten thresholds are the ones the theorems print. The tenth is a strengthening: for $u = E$ the law excludes $a \geq 2$, so the word OOE needs no appeal to the census of Theorem 3.6. Where a theorem prints a threshold on n , the law's is smaller — 205 against the 256 of Theorem 3.12, 73 against the 128 of Theorem 3.14, 45 against the 256 of Theorem 3.16 — because the backward exponent is carried exactly as $T(u)$ rather than rounded up to the next power of two. Every threshold in the table is below the certified descent floor by four orders of magnitude or more, so above that floor Theorem 3.22 is Theorem 3.26 evaluated ten times.

Two caveats keep the table from replacing Appendix D outright. The theorems it reproduces are stated for every $n \geq 2$, and each closes its window below the threshold with a **decide +kernel** evaluation; the law says nothing there. And Theorem 3.21 upgrades Theorem 3.13 from minimum-based itineraries to all cycle itineraries, which the law, being a statement about a minimum-based orientation, does not do on its own. Above the certified floor neither caveat is active.

Lemma 3.28 (sharp odd-run envelope). Let O^a be an odd run inside a minimum-based cycle itinerary at n , starting at the state m , and put

$$X_a = 3(3^a - 2^a), \quad Y_a = 2 \cdot 3^a - 3 \cdot 2^a.$$

Then

$$n^{X_a} < (n+1)^{Y_a} (J^a(m) + 1)^{2^a}.$$

Proof. Induction on a . For $a = 1$ the odd one-step preimage gives $m^3 < (J(m) + 1)^2$, and $m \geq n$, which is the claim with $X_1 = 3$, $Y_1 = 0$. Suppose the display holds after k letters of the run, with the state $x_k \geq n$. Cubing gives

$$n^{3X_k} < (n+1)^{3Y_k} (x_k + 1)^{3 \cdot 2^k}.$$

Because $n \leq x_k$ one has $n(x_k + 1) \leq (n+1)x_k$, hence $(x_k + 1)^e n^e \leq (n+1)^e x_k^e$ for $e = 3 \cdot 2^k$; multiplying through by n^e and substituting turns the display into

$$n^{3X_k + e} < (n+1)^{3Y_k + e} x_k^e.$$

Finally $x_k^{3 \cdot 2^k} = (x_k^3)^{2^k} < ((x_{k+1} + 1)^2)^{2^k}$. So $X_{k+1} = 3X_k + 3 \cdot 2^k$ and $Y_{k+1} = 3Y_k + 3 \cdot 2^k$, whose solutions from $X_1 = 3$, $Y_1 = 0$ are the stated closed forms. $\square$

The difference from Lemma 3.24 is where minimum-basedness is used. Lemma 3.24 uses it once, at the start of the run, and then pays Lemma 3.3's factor 4 at every step. Lemma 3.28 uses it at *every* step: the intermediate state is itself above the cycle minimum, so the successor's +1 can be traded for a factor $(n+1)/n$ rather than for a factor 4. This is the chain already formalized at $a = 7$ in `Problems/Juggler/07EEEEGap.lean`, whose constants 6177 and 3990 are X_7 and Y_7 ; `absorb_odd_step` there is the inductive step above.

Theorem 3.29 (run-suffix law, sharp form). In the situation of Theorem 3.26,

$$n^{X_a} < (n+1)^{Y_a} B(u)^{2^a}.$$

Proof. Lemma 3.28 bounds $J^a(m) + 1$ from below and Lemma 3.25 bounds $J^a(m) + 1 \leq B(u)$ from above. $\square$

Since $X_a - Y_a = 3^a$, the leading-order reading is unchanged: with $B(u) \approx (n+1)^{T(u)}$ the criterion is again the crossing $(3/2)^a > T(u)$. What changes is the price. Theorem 3.26 has to buy the crossing against a factor $4^{(3/2)^a}$, which costs a margin $\log 4 / \log n$; Theorem 3.29 buys it against $(1 + 1/n)^{Y_a}$, which costs a margin of order $1/(n \log n)$. The crude form needs a floor exponential in the reciprocal margin, the sharp form one merely linear in it.

Corollary 3.30 (the same table, sharply). For the ten suffixes of Corollary 3.27, the least cycle minimum at which Theorem 3.29 fires is

$$7, 6, 6, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5$$

in the order printed there, against 1032, 205, 109, 73, 60, 45, 30, 60, 45, 30 for Theorem 3.26 and 256 or 128 in the proofs of Appendix D. Every $n \leq 299$ reaches 1, so a cycle minimum is at least 300 and all ten are unconditional.

Theorem 3.31 (even count at least eight). No cycle itinerary has fewer than eight even letters, and a nontrivial cycle has period at least twenty-two.

Proof. Let a minimum-based cycle itinerary have $e \leq 7$ even letters and canonical run form $O^{a_0} E \dots O^{a_{e-1}} E$. Apply Theorem 3.29 at run i . Its suffix has $e - i$ even letters and $\sum_{j>i} a_j$ odd ones, so $T(u) \leq 2^{e-i}$, with equality exactly when the later runs are empty; and the criterion is monotone in $B(u)$, so that empty case is the worst. Hence

$$a_i \leq \left\lfloor (e - i) \frac{\log 2}{\log(3/2)} \right\rfloor,$$

and the thresholds of those bounding applications — rows $r \leq 7$ of the table in Remark 3.32 — are all at most 55. The run bounds are $(5, 3, 1)$, $(6, 5, 3, 1)$, $(8, 6, 5, 3, 1)$, $(10, 8, 6, 5, 3, 1)$ and $(11, 10, 8, 6, 5, 3, 1)$ for $e = 3, \dots, 7$, leaving 16, 186, 2037, 25353 and 325452 canonical forms once formal expansion $3^o > 2^{o+e}$ is imposed. Theorem 3.29 closes every one of them, the first four at $n \geq 16$ and the last at $n \geq 64$. The cases $e \leq 2$ are Theorem 3.22. A cycle minimum is at least 300, so $n \geq 64$ is free. Given $e \geq 8$, formal expansion $2^L < 3^{L-8}$ first holds at $L = 22$. $\square$

This replaces $e \geq 4$ and period ≥ 11 in Theorem 3.22 and Corollary 3.23 — it doubles the floor-free period bound — which remain the statements proved for every $n \geq 2$ without any descent input. Numerically the gain is of no consequence — Theorem 4.6 already gives period ≥ 25781 at a floor of 10^6 — but Corollary 3.23 is the paper's only bound that needs no floor at all, and this is how far the same two envelopes carry it.

Remark 3.32 (where the law stops, and why Section 4 exists). The reading $B(u) \approx (n+1)^{T(u)}$ is good only while the backward exponent stays comfortably above 1, because the envelope of Lemma 3.25 rounds a cube root up at every odd letter. For short suffixes that rounding is invisible: over the ten suffixes of Corollary 3.27 it moves $\log_{n+1} B(u)$ by at most $7 \cdot 10^{-5}$ at $n = 10^3$. For a cycle candidate read as one long word it is the whole story. There the exponent of the full word is $2^L/3^o = 1 - \theta$, just *below* one, so the envelope hovers at n itself and the +1 rounded into each of the L backward steps is no longer negligible; accumulated, it is exactly the factor L that Theorem 4.4 carries on its right-hand side. The run-suffix law is sharp on short tails and degenerates to the finance inequality on the whole cycle. That is the division of labour between this section and the next.

The margins the law has to pay for are the same objects Section 5 fights. For the pure trailing block $O^{a_r} E^r$, writing a_r for the least a with $(3/2)^a > 2^r$, the margin is θ at $(o, L) = (a_r, a_r + r)$:

r	(o, L)	L/o	θ_r	n threshold
1	(2, 3)	3/2	0.1111	7
2	(4, 6)	3/2	0.2099	6
3	(6, 9)	3/2	0.2977	5
4	(7, 11)	11/7	0.0636	16
5	(9, 14)	14/9	0.1676	8

r	(o, L)	L/o	θ_r	n threshold
6	(11, 17)	17/11	0.2601	6
7	(12, 19)	19/12	0.0135	55
11	(19, 30)	30/19	0.0762	15
14	(24, 38)	19/12	0.0267	32

The spikes sit at 11/7 and 19/12, the semiconvergent and the convergent of $\log_2 3$ at smallest denominator, and the thresholds they carry grow like $1/\theta_r$ rather than like $\exp(1/\theta_r)$ — which is why they stay in the tens. What limits Theorem 3.31 is therefore not any threshold but the enumeration: the number of canonical forms with e even letters grows faster than $e!$. The obstruction that stops this section and the obstruction that leaves the semiconvergent fan of Section 5 standing are the same arithmetic; only the denominators differ.

What each further even letter is worth. Expansion at even count e needs $L \log(3/2) > e \log 3$, so each further even letter buys $\log 3 / \log(3/2) \in (2.70, 2.71)$ in period: the thresholds are 11, 14, 17, 19, 22 at $e = 4, 5, 6, 7, 8$. Both ends of that constant are integer certificates rather than numerical bounds on logarithms: $(3/2)^{27/10} < 3$ is $3^{17} < 2^{27}$, and $3 < (3/2)^{271/100}$ is $2^{271} < 3^{171}$, the latter tight to four significant figures (`expansion_rate_lower`, `expansion_rate_upper`, `expansion_e4`, `expansion_e5`, `expansion_e6`, `FanLaw.lean`).

An earlier draft of this section priced a fifth even letter as a family program in the style of Theorems 3.14–3.20: two further gapped-leftover theorems and some twenty-five bunched families, for three units of period. Theorem 3.31 makes that program unnecessary. The route it takes is not a longer case analysis but a cheaper envelope — Lemma 3.28 in place of Lemma 3.24 — and the case analysis it then needs is mechanical rather than hand-written. What the earlier accounting got right is that raising the even count is the only route to a stronger floor-free statement; what it got wrong is the assumption that the eleven exclusions had to be generalised one at a time.

4. Cycle finance

A cycle itinerary is formally expanding (Theorem 3.2), yet the trajectory returns exactly. The multiplicative surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must be financed by the floor remainders, which are relatively $O(1/x)$ in logarithms. The resulting bound on the cycle minimum excludes every period that is not admissible for the inequality, once a uniform logarithmic floor-error bound is available above a verified descent floor.

The identity is unrolled along a circular word. After rotation to a cycle minimum that itinerary is a necklace of odd-run excursions. The geometry below records that itinerary. It introduces no new theorem: every named constraint is Theorem 3.2, Lemma 3.4, Lemma 3.21b, or the last-even one-step preimage.

The excursion necklace

Write n for a cycle minimum and

$$w = O^{a_1} E O^{a_2} E \dots O^{a_e} E$$

for a minimum-based orientation (Lemma 3.21b), so $a_1 \geq 2$, $\sum_i a_i = o$, and $e = L - o$. The odd landings are the *valleys* v_i and the even state just before each final E is the *peak* p_i :

$$v_0 = n, \quad p_i = J^{a_{i+1}}(v_i), \quad v_{i+1} = J(p_i) = \lfloor \sqrt{p_i} \rfloor \quad (0 \leq i < e),$$

with $v_e = n$. The itinerary is

$$n \xrightarrow{OO} \text{first high region} \xrightarrow{E} v_1 \xrightarrow{O^{a_2} E} \dots \xrightarrow{O^{a_{e-1}} E} v_{e-1} \xrightarrow{O^{a_e} E} n.$$

Two meanings of *entry* must not be conflated. *Cycle entry* is the distinguished cut that places the minimum at the start of the itinerary. *Dynamical entry* is the last even step into n . The second is a genuine boundary condition; the first is a choice of origin.

Cycle minimum and the forced lift The minimum is odd, so the itinerary cannot begin with E or OE , and it cannot end with an odd letter (Theorem 3.2). The first two letters are therefore OO :

$$n \xrightarrow{O} y \xrightarrow{O} z.$$

For $n \geq 5$ one has $z = J^2(n) \geq (n+1)^2$ (Lemma 3.4(i)). In particular OOE cannot be a cycle itinerary (`no_cycle_itinerary_ooe`). On a cycle minimum the first even residual overshoots the entry one-step preimage: the first peak satisfies $p_0 \geq (n+1)^2$. That is the opposite of the last-peak condition below. Even $J^2(n)$ may continue with E ; odd $J^2(n)$ continues with O . Either way the minimum-based prefix is still OO .

Excursions, valleys, and peaks An ordinary excursion is one block $O^a E$. In the itinerary semantics that itinerary is `oddEvenBlock a 1`. Write

$$\mu(a) = \frac{3^a}{2^{a+1}}$$

for the ideal (floor-free) exponent of the block. The block is formally expanding if and only if $\mu(a) > 1$, equivalently $2^{a+1} < 3^a$. Thus OE contracts ($\mu(1) = 3/4$) and OOE expands ($\mu(2) = 9/8$). This is a reparameterization of the itinerary envelope of Theorem 2.2, not a transition law on pairs (a_i, a_{i+1}) . Lemma 3.4(v) forbids $O^a E$ as a *cycle itinerary* for $a \geq 3$; it does not forbid an internal block of that shape.

The trajectory is then the wave

$$v_0 \rightarrow p_0 \rightarrow v_1 \rightarrow p_1 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow v_{e-1} \rightarrow p_{e-1} \rightarrow v_0.$$

On a cycle minimum every even state is already at least n^2 (Theorem 3.2(iii)). Valleys dominate a logarithmic defect sum because $1/(x \log x)$ is largest there; peaks are huge and cheap. That is why the run-type packing of Theorem 4.7 charges `OOE`-scale valleys, `OE`-scale valleys, and evens separately. The packed comparison is an extremal charge of the same sum, not a uniqueness theorem for the actual word. Expanding blocks can climb and a later OE can drop without crossing the anchor: four consecutive expanding blocks occur already at the certified start 1999 recorded in Section 6.

Closure and the entry one-step preimage The valley sequence is circular. The last letter is E , so the last peak occupies the last-even one-step preimage of Lemma 3.4(iv):

$$n^2 \leq p_{e-1} < (n+1)^2.$$

The minimum is odd, so $p_{e-1} \neq n^2$ (`cycle_last_even_ne_odd_sq`) and p_{e-1} is even. Thus

$$n^2 + 1 \leq p_{e-1} < (n+1)^2, \quad p_{e-1} \text{ even.}$$

An ordinary excursion needs only $v_i \geq n$. The last excursion must hit this one-step preimage and land on n :

$$v_{e-1} \xrightarrow{O^{a_e}} p_{e-1} \xrightarrow{E} n.$$

The first peak overshoots the same one-step preimage; the last peak lands in it. Those are different even states.

Once the trajectory returns to n , the prefix OO is forced again. A genuine cycle is a closed necklace of excursions whose first block starts OO , whose last peak lies in the entry one-step preimage, and whose entire trajectory stays at least n . The global constraints already proved are

$$\sum_i a_i = o, \quad e = L - o, \quad 2^L < 3^o,$$

together with periodicity $\prod_{i=0}^{e-1} v_{i+1}/v_i = 1$.

What remains Finance (Theorem 4.4) sits around the necklace: the surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must be paid by floor losses, and at the verified floor $N_0 = 10^6$ this forces $L \geq 25781$. The run-type packing of Theorem 4.7 is a refinement of the same defect sum along the valleys and peaks just named. Subsequent refinements of one component of the necklace recovered Theorem 4.7 or closed. They are not claims of this note.

The pieces are understood separately: the forced lift at n , the blocks $O^{a_i}E$, and the last-even landing. What is not proved is a link strong enough to exclude the leftover lengths,

$$\text{minimum geometry} + \text{necklace of excursions} + \text{entry one-step preimage} \Rightarrow \perp.$$

That is a formulation of the remaining cycle problem, not a theorem. A genuine lower bound on the number of odd runs would feed Theorem 4.7; none is proved here.

Throughout this section write $L = |w|$ and $o = \#O(w)$ for a cycle itinerary w based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Natural logarithms are written $\log$ in this section and $\ln$ in Section 5; both denote the natural logarithm. The unique one-step fibres of Section 3 give, for every state $x \geq 1$ with image $y = J(x)$,

$$y^2 \leq x^h < (y+1)^2, \quad h = \begin{cases} 1, & x \text{ even}, \\ 3, & x \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

Lemma 4.1 (dyadic one-step-preimage logarithm). If $z, y \geq 1$ and $z < (y+1)^2$, then $\log z \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$.

Proof. The hypothesis gives $\log z \leq 2 \log(y+1)$. The inequality $\log(1+u) \leq u$ for $u > 0$ yields $\log(y+1) = \log y + \log(1+1/y) \leq \log y + 1/y$. $\square$

Lemma 4.2 (one-step bounds). Let $x \geq 2$ and $y = J(x)$. If x is even, then $\log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. If x is odd, then $3 \log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$.

Proof. The even one-step preimage is $y^2 \leq x < (y+1)^2$. The one-step-preimage logarithm lemma on $z = x$ is the first claim. The odd one-step preimage is $y^2 \leq x^3 < (y+1)^2$. The same lemma on $z = x^3$ gives $\log(x^3) \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. $\square$

On a cycle minimum every proper prefix is non-contracting: a prefix with $3^{\#O} < 2^k$ would satisfy $J^k(n) < n$ by Corollary 2.3, contradicting minimality. Thus $2^k \leq 3^{o_k}$ for every prefix of length k , where o_k is the odd count of that prefix.

Lemma 4.3 (unrolled envelope). Write $x_k = J^k(n)$ and o_k for the odd count of the length- k prefix. For every $0 \leq k \leq L$,

$$3^{o_k} \log n \leq 2^k \log x_k + \frac{k 3^{o_k}}{n}.$$

Proof. The case $k = 0$ is an equality. Suppose the claim holds at $k < L$, and write $x = x_k$ and $y = x_{k+1}$. Minimality gives $n \leq y$, and the prefix law gives $2^{k+1} \leq 3^{o_{k+1}}$, hence

$$\frac{2^{k+1}}{y} \leq \frac{3^{o_{k+1}}}{n}.$$

If the next letter is even, then $o_{k+1} = o_k$ and the one-step bound gives $\log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. Multiply by 2^k and add the inductive remainder:

$$3^{o_k} \log n \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{2^{k+1}}{y} + \frac{k 3^{o_k}}{n} \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{(k+1) 3^{o_k}}{n}.$$

If the next letter is odd, then $o_{k+1} = o_k + 1$. Multiply the inductive bound by 3 and apply the one-step bound in the form $3 \log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$:

$$3^{o_{k+1}} \log n \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{2^{k+1}}{y} + \frac{k 3^{o_k+1}}{n} \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{(k+1) 3^{o_{k+1}}}{n}.$$

This is the claim at $k + 1$. $\square$

Theorem 4.4 (finance). Let w be a cycle itinerary of length L with o odd letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Then

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o.$$

Proof. Apply Lemma 4.3 at $k = L$. Periodicity gives $x_L = n$ and $o_L = o$, so

$$3^o \log n \leq 2^L \log n + \frac{L \cdot 3^o}{n}.$$

The itinerary is formally expanding, so $3^o > 2^L$. Rearranging and multiplying by n is the claim. $\square$

This is the conceptual centre of the note. Exact one-step preimages give a one-step logarithmic defect; cycle minimality lets the defect be unrolled against the cycle minimum; the formal surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must then be paid by a finite accumulated budget. Ideal dynamics expands and exact dynamics returns, so the floor errors finance the expansion. The inequality $\log(1 + u) \leq u$ is the only analytic input; the content is that interaction. The Lean form is exactly Theorem 4.4 (constant 1): `cycleMin_finance`.

Hierarchy of forms. These three layers must not be conflated.

1. *Theorem 4.4* is the conceptual sharp inequality. Constant 1:

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o,$$

equivalently $\theta \leq L/(n \log n)$ with $\theta = 1 - 2^L/3^o$. It charges every one-step-preimage defect at the cycle minimum. Lean: `cycleMin_finance`.

2. *Corollary 4.4c* (below) is the same one-step-preimage-log unroll with remainders kept as $1/x_{i+1}$. It is the strongest proved form of those defects. Lean: `cycleMin_finance_inv_sum`.
3. *Corollary 4.5* is the convenient length-only statewise bound: a verified descent floor N_0 plus the three-class charge of the defect sum produces a per-length threshold $n_{\max}(L)$ and excludes every L with $n_{\max}(L) \leq N_0$. The charge is

$$\sum_i \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i} \leq \frac{e}{n \log n} + \frac{o - e}{t \log t} + \frac{e}{2n^2 \log n}, \quad t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor,$$

charging valleys at n , internal odds at t , and evens at n^2 . It is called the *parity* charge in the tables and in places below, which is historical and slightly misleading: it is **not** a two-class split of odds against evens, and the t -scale middle term is exactly what makes it sharper than one. Lean: `cycleMin_threeTerm` from `CycleMin` alone, with no hypothesis about `EE`.

4. *Theorem 4.6* is the numerical certification of Corollary 4.5 at $N_0 = 10^6$. The certified identity is the conservative relative-defect form

$$1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o} \leq \frac{6}{5} \sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i}.$$

The factor $6/5$ is a convenient uniform majorant of $-\log(1 - \delta)/\delta$ on $[0, 1/6]$. It is not Theorem 4.4, and the headline cutoff 25781 is not an artifact of that majorant. The identity itself is Lean for any cycle minimum $n \geq 400$ (`cycleMin_defect_finance`, `DefectFinance.lean`); the per-length numeric table stays a verified computation.

The relative-defect unroll is a parallel identity, not Theorem 4.4 multiplied by $6/5$. Charging every state at the cycle minimum in that identity recovers the coarser comparison $\theta \leq (6/5)L/(n \log n)$, which is Theorem 4.4 with coefficient $6/5$. At this floor that uniform charge excludes only through length 1053. The computational table uses a stricter length-only three-class charge of the same identity.

Corollary 4.4c (inv-sum). Let w be a cycle itinerary of length L with o odd letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Write $x_i = J^i(n)$. Then

$$(3^o - 2^L) \log n \leq 3^o \sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i},$$

equivalently $\theta \leq (\sum_i 1/x_i)/\log n$.

Proof. The same induction as Lemma 4.3, keeping each one-step preimage defect as $2^{k+1}/x_{k+1}$ instead of replacing it by $3^{o_{k+1}}/n$. At $k = L$ one has $x_L = n$. Lean: `cycleMin_log_envelope_inv`, `cycleMin_finance_inv_sum`. $\square$

The computational table of Theorem 4.6 uses a weaker per-step bound, valid on every cycle because every start below 12 reaches 1 (so every cycle state is at least 12). For a state x with image $y = J(x) \geq 12$, the relative defect $\delta = (x^h - y^2)/x^h$ satisfies $\delta \leq 2/y \leq 1/6$. Writing $\varepsilon = -\frac{1}{2} \log(1-\delta)$ and using $-\log(1-\delta) \leq \frac{6}{5}\delta$ on $[0, 1/6]$ gives $\varepsilon \leq (6/5)/y$. Unrolling $t_{i+1} = (h_i/2)t_i - \varepsilon_i$ around the cycle then yields the conservative identity displayed in item 4 of the hierarchy. This chain is Lean end to end (`DefectFinance.lean`): the per-step losses in image form (`log_floorPower_even_ge_sub`, `log_floorPower_odd_ge_sub`, from $-\log(1-\delta) \leq \frac{6}{5}\delta$ on $[0, 1/6]$, `neg_log_one_sub_le_sixth`), the amplification priced by the upper invariant $\log x_k \leq w_k \log n$ (`cycleMin_log_le_weight`), and the charged unroll (`cycleMin_charge_prefix`), closed at $x_L = n$.

On a minimum-based cycle of length L with o odd letters and $e = L - o$ even letters, the last letter is even, so $e \geq 1$ and the number of odd-run starts is at most e . Every even state satisfies $x \geq n^2$. Every odd state preceded by an odd state satisfies $x \geq t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$. Therefore

$$\sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i} \leq \frac{e}{n \log n} + \frac{o-e}{t \log t} + \frac{e}{2n^2 \log n},$$

and

$$n \log n \left(1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o}\right) \leq \frac{6}{5} \left(e + (o-e) \frac{n \log n}{t \log t} + \frac{e}{2n}\right).$$

The optimal uniform coefficient on $[0, 1/6]$ is $6 \log(6/5) \approx 1.093$. Replacing $6/5$ by that constant, or even by 1, on the same parity charge does not change the first surviving length: one still has $n_{\max}(25780) \leq 10^6 < n_{\max}(25781)$. The published table and the count 141 keep the proved coefficient $6/5$. The cutoff 25781 is therefore not an artifact of an avoidable loss in the majorant.

Lemma 4.4b (odd-count monotonicity). Write $\theta(o) = 1 - 2^L/3^o$ and

$$R(o) = e + (o-e)\alpha + \frac{e}{2n}, \quad e = L - o, \quad \alpha = \frac{n \log n}{t \log t}.$$

The certified parity comparison is $n \log n \cdot \theta(o) \leq (6/5)R(o)$. For every $n \geq 12$ one has $\alpha < 1/2$, hence

$$R(o+1) - R(o) = 2\alpha - 1 - \frac{1}{2n} < 0.$$

Also $\theta(o+1) > \theta(o)$. Therefore if the comparison fails at some admissible o , it fails at every larger odd count. Equivalently, the largest n at which the comparison can hold occurs at the least admissible odd count $o_{\min}(L) = \min\{o : 3^o > 2^L\}$. The same monotonicity holds for any positive coefficient in place of $6/5$, and for the constant-1 comparison of Theorem 4.4.

Proof. The difference $R(o+1) - R(o)$ is the displayed coefficient of o . For $n \geq 12$ one has $t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor \geq n^{3/2} - 1 > 2n$, hence $\alpha < (n \log n)/(2n \log(2n)) = (\log n)/(2 \log(2n)) < 1/2$. The map $o \mapsto \theta(o)$ is strictly increasing on integers o with $3^o > 2^L$. If $n \log n \cdot \theta(o) > (6/5)R(o)$, then $n \log n \cdot \theta(o+1) > (6/5)R(o) > (6/5)R(o+1)$. $\square$

Define

$$\gamma(L) = \frac{3^{o_{\min}(L)}}{2^L} - 1,$$

and write $n_{\max}(L)$ for the largest integer n at which the displayed parity inequality can still hold at $o = o_{\min}(L)$. The coarser comparison $n \log n \leq (6/5)L \cdot 3^{o_{\min}} / (3^{o_{\min}} - 2^L)$ is used only as a check; Theorem 4.6 uses $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity form. Lemma 4.4b is why that table may be computed at $o_{\min}$ alone.

Proposition 4.4a (finance-survivor algorithm). Fix a verified descent floor N_0 . For each integer $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$, compute $o_{\min}(L) = \min\{o : 3^o > 2^L\}$ by exact integer arithmetic and $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity inequality, and retain L if and only if $n_{\max}(L) > N_0$. The resulting finance-survivor set is

$$\mathcal{E}(N_0) = \{L : 1 \leq L \leq 10^5, n_{\max}(L) > N_0\}.$$

The printed instance is $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{E}(10^6)$, with $|\mathcal{E}| = 141$.

Corollary 4.5. If every integer $2 \leq n \leq N_0$ reaches 1, then no nontrivial cycle of length L exists whenever $n_{\max}(L) \leq N_0$.

Proof. A periodic state never reaches 1, so every cycle state is at least $N_0 + 1$. The length-only three-class charge of the certified relative-defect identity then forces the minimum to satisfy the displayed inequality, hence $n \leq n_{\max}(L)$. This is the convenient statewise bound in the hierarchy after Theorem 4.4; it is not a replacement for that theorem. $\square$

Record values of the three-class $n_{\max}$ include $n_{\max}(19) = 133$, $n_{\max}(84) = 2323$, $n_{\max}(569) = 23568$, $n_{\max}(1054) = 788014$, and $n_{\max}(25781) = 26254995$.

Theorem 4.6 (verified computation). Every integer $2 \leq n \leq 10^6$ reaches 1. Consequently:

- (A) there is no nontrivial Juggler cycle of length at most 25780;
- (B) if a nontrivial cycle has period $L \leq 10^5$, then $L \in \mathcal{E}$, where $|\mathcal{E}| = 141$.

The bound closes continuously through 25780; 25781 is the first integer for which this particular inequality does not exclude a cycle. The coefficient $6/5$ is the certification majorant of item 4 in the hierarchy after Theorem 4.4, not the source of the cutoff.

Proof. The descent floor is Proposition 1.3. The gap table computes $o_{\min}(L)$ and $n_{\max}(L)$ for every $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$ by Lemma 4.4b. Corollary 4.5 at $N_0 = 10^6$ excludes every L with $n_{\max}(L) \leq 10^6$. The contiguous excluded prefix is $L \leq 25780$. The complementary set in range is $\mathcal{E}$; checksums are Appendix B. $\square$

Run packing

Theorem 4.7 refines the length-only charge by separating the unique minimum, OOE-scale valleys, OE-scale valleys, internal odds, and evens. It is a supporting comparison at the same floor; the leftover count $141 \rightarrow 99$ does not raise the cutoff. A cycle cannot put an OE-start at the minimum (Theorem 3.2), and an n -circuit of k odds and ℓ evens stays at least n only if $3^k \geq 2^{k+\ell}$.

Theorem 4.7 (run-type packing). Let w be a cycle itinerary of length L with $o = o_{\min}(L)$ odd letters and $e = L - o$ even letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 12$. Assume further that w is primitive and that w contains no EE. Write v for the least odd integer with $v^3 \geq n^4$, and write $t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$. Then $o - e < e$, the largest number of n -scale valleys compatible with the even cap is $o - e$ copies of OOE, and the remaining $2e - o$ circuits are OE from v . The cycle minimum occurs once, so

$$\sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i} \leq \frac{1}{n \log n} + \frac{o - e - 1}{(n + 2) \log(n + 2)} + \frac{2e - o}{v \log v} + \frac{1}{t \log t} + \frac{o - e - 1}{t_+ \log t_+} + \frac{e}{2n^2 \log n},$$

where $t_+ = J(n + 2)$. Combined with the $6/5$ unroll this is strictly smaller than the three-class sum of Corollary 4.5 whenever $2e - o > 0$. Sending the cycle maximum to infinity removes one even term and does not change the valley packing.

Proof. The statement is at $o = o_{\min}(L)$. Lemma 4.4b already excludes every larger odd count from the parity comparison used in Theorem 4.6; the packing is a refinement at that same odd count. Formal expansion at $o_{\min}$ forces $3o < 2L$ on every leftover length in range, equivalently $o - e < e$. The even-cap comparison

$3^k \geq 2^{k+\ell}$ is the ideal power envelope; floors only help. An OE-start is followed by an even state, so Theorem 3.2 gives $J(v) \geq n^2$ and therefore $v^3 \geq n^4$. Unique visit of the cycle minimum is primitivity, which is why that hypothesis is stated: a cycle word concatenated with itself is again based at a cycle minimum, and the display charges only one valley at n . The no-EE hypothesis enters at the split of the e valleys into cheap and expensive. Counting on indices rather than on blocks, an odd letter is a *valley* when its cyclic predecessor is even; the valleys are then in bijection with the maximal even runs, and the counting lemma gives $\# \text{cheap} \leq o - \# \text{blocks}$. Only when no EE occurs do the blocks number e , giving the $\# \text{cheap} \leq o - e$ the packing uses; the subsection *The packing hypothesis and its price* below shows the hypothesis is not removable. The displayed sum charges one cheap valley at n , the remaining $o - e - 1$ cheap valleys at the next odd integer $n + 2$, the expensive valleys at v , one internal odd at t , the remaining internals at $J(n + 2)$, and every even at n^2 . Any deeper odd run or any higher valley only decreases the sum. $\square$

Theorem 4.8 (run-type table). At the verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$, the packed comparison of Theorem 4.7 excludes the 42 lengths $56347 + 1054k$ for $k = 0, \dots, 41$ and leaves an explicit set $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}(10^6)$ of 99 lengths. The first survivor remains 25781. In particular, if a nontrivial cycle has period $L \leq 10^5$ and its itinerary satisfies the hypotheses of Theorem 4.7, then $L \in \mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$.

The two halves of that progression do not carry the same weight. The 24 lengths with $k \geq 18$, from 75319 up, are excluded with no hypothesis about EE at all: at most half the odd letters can be cheap valleys whatever the word does (`two_mul_cheap_1e_odd`), and charging $\lfloor o/2 \rfloor$ of them at $n + 2$ still excludes exactly those lengths. The 18 with $k \leq 17$, from 56347 to 74265, are excluded only under the no-EE hypothesis, and the subsection below exhibits admissible words that defeat each. Dropping that hypothesis therefore leaves 117 lengths in place of 99. It does not move the cutoff, which is 25781 either way and comes from Corollary 4.5.

Proof. The 141 lengths of Theorem 4.6(B) are tested at $n = 10^6 + 1$ against the packed right-hand side. The comparison is certified on each length: no entry is left uncertain. The 42 excluded lengths are exactly the arithmetic progression named in the statement. The complementary set in that range is $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$. Checksums are Appendix B. The period cutoff remains 25781. $\square$

The packing hypothesis and its price

Theorem 4.7 assumes the itinerary contains no EE. The assumption is not cosmetic and it is not removable, and since 18 of Theorem 4.8's 42 exclusions rest on it, it is worth saying exactly what it buys and what it costs.

Why the packing needs it. The extremality argument counts *blocks* 0^aE . Counting instead on indices, where nothing is assumed, call an odd letter a *valley* when its cyclic predecessor is even and an *internal* when that predecessor is odd. The valleys are then in bijection with the maximal even runs. If the itinerary carries m cyclic EE adjacencies, the e even letters form $e - m$ maximal runs, so

$$\# \text{valleys} = e - m, \quad \# \text{internals} = o - e + m, \quad \# \text{cheap} \leq \min(o - e + m, e - m),$$

with the expensive valleys making up the rest. The bound $\# \text{cheap} \leq o - e$ that Theorem 4.7 uses is the case $m = 0$; in general the counting lemma gives only $\# \text{cheap} \leq o - \# \text{blocks}$, and with EE present the even letters outnumber the blocks. The paper's phrasing — $o - e$ copies of 00E and $2e - o$ circuits of 0E — already presupposes one even letter per block.

What it is worth. At every one of the 42 lengths, at $n = 10^6 + 1$, the ratio of the Corollary 4.5 charge to the packed one is 1.4048, uniformly; to leading order it is $e/(o - e)$, the packing moving the n -scale charge from e valleys to $o - e$. That constant is the whole budget of the refinement, and each of the 42 dies with margin $\theta/\text{packed} \in [1.0033, 1.3535]$ — inside that budget of necessity, since each survives the unpacked charge.

The second cap, and the split. The quantity $\# \text{cheap}$ is bounded both by $o - e + m$ and by the valley count $e - m$ it is part of. The two cross at $m = e - o/2$, where both equal $o/2$; past the crossing the valleys themselves run out and the majorant falls again. So EE cannot inflate the n -scale charge beyond $(o/2)/(o - e) = 1.2047$, however much of it a word carries. Since θ/packed rises monotonically along the

progression and crosses that ceiling between $L = 74265$ and $L = 75319$, the 42 split cleanly: the 24 lengths from 75319 up are excluded whatever the itinerary, and the 18 from 56347 to 74265 are not.

The 24 are a theorem, not an observation. The split above is read off a scan over m , but the surviving half needs no scan. Call an odd letter a *cheap valley* when its cyclic predecessor is even and its cyclic successor is odd — the start of an odd run of length at least two. A cheap valley is a valley; its successor is an odd letter with an odd predecessor, hence an internal; and the successor map is injective on the window. So the cheap valleys sit inside the valleys and inject into the internals, and those two classes partition the odd letters (`valley_add_internal`), giving

$$2 \cdot \# \text{cheap} \leq o$$

with no reference to `EE` — Lean `two_mul_cheap_le_odd`, from `cheap_le_valley` and `cheap_le_internal`. Feeding $\lfloor o/2 \rfloor$ to `sixTerm_bound_packed` in place of the packing’s $o-e$ therefore yields a comparison carrying none of Theorem 4.7’s hypotheses, and at $N_0 = 10^6$ that comparison excludes exactly the 24. The bound is of course weaker than the packed one — it charges more valleys at the $n+2$ scale — and it remains below the charge of Corollary 4.5, as it must.

The 18 are genuinely lost without the hypothesis. For each there is a word satisfying every restriction this paper proves for a cycle-minimum itinerary — $3^{a_j} \geq 2^j$ at every prefix, the per-run cap of Theorem 3.31, $o = o_{\min}(L)$, and the `00...E` shape — and carrying more `EE` than the comparison can absorb. The witness is the Beatty interleaving of `00E` and `0E` blocks over $e-k$ even letters followed by a tail of k even letters, with k between 51 and 3926. Its odd runs have length at most two, which is the packing’s own extremal shape, so no claim about run structure is violated; what fails is only the correspondence between blocks and even letters. Granting the extremality of the run packing in full therefore does not restore the counting, and no sharpening of the run analysis will: what would be needed is a restriction sensitive to the floors, whereas every restriction used above is exponent bookkeeping, exact for the multipliers and blind to the floors.

Remark (why the run cap cannot help). The least admissible odd count is defined by $3^o > 2^L$, that is $o \log(3/2) > e \log 2$, and the per-run cap of Theorem 3.31, which Theorem 3.29’s run-suffix law supplies, is $\lfloor (e-i) \log 2 / \log(3/2) \rfloor$ with i the number of even letters already spent. The two use the same constant, so at every one of the 42 lengths

$$\left\lfloor e \cdot \frac{\log 2}{\log(3/2)} \right\rfloor = o_{\min}(L) - 1.$$

The single-run word `0oEe` is therefore forbidden by exactly one letter, and two blocks are already admissible — carrying $e-2$ adjacencies. The cap and the odd count are the same inequality read twice, which is why the cap is never far from binding and never actually binds.

What this does not say. Theorem 4.7 is true as stated, with its hypotheses, and Theorem 4.8’s 42 exclusions are correct under them. A defeated exclusion does not produce a cycle of that length; it means the comparison does not rule one out. And the count m is treated here as free, whereas a realised itinerary’s `EE` count is fixed by the dynamics — the witnesses are admissible for the restrictions this paper proves, not exhibited as cycles.

Arithmetic structure of the finance survivors

The leftover lengths cluster around the continued-fraction approximants of $\log 2 / \log 3$. That organizes the table; it does not constrain a hypothetical cycle.

Proposition 4.9 (finance-survivor lattice). Write $v_* = (25781, 16266)$ and $v_{1054} = (1054, 665)$. Then

$$25781 \cdot 665 - 1054 \cdot 16266 = 1,$$

so these two vectors are a unimodular basis of $\mathbb{Z}^2$. Every length in $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$, and every one of the 42 packing deaths of Theorem 4.8, is of the form $(L, o_{\min}) = a v_* + b v_{1054}$. With the table cap $L \leq 10^5$ the 99 survivors

fall in three affine slices of counts 29, 47, and 23. The identification with $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$ is Theorem 4.8. This is a change of coordinates for (L, o) , not a relation between hypothetical cycles.

Proof. The determinant identity is integer arithmetic. The generator comparison $3^{665} > 2^{1054} > 3^{664}$ gives $o_{\min}(1054) = 665$. Direct evaluation of $o_{\min}$ on the 141 lengths of Theorem 4.6(B) places each pair $(L, o_{\min})$ on the displayed lattice, with the 42 packing deaths the F_1 continuation $b \geq 29$. $\square$

The gap transfer and the short-cycle reduction

Everything above turns a verified descent floor into a per-length exclusion. The floor is the only ingredient that is not scale-free, and along the convergent denominators q_k of $\log 2 / \log 3$ the threshold grows like $n_{\max}(q_k) \log n_{\max}(q_k) \asymp q_k q_{k+1}$, equivalently $n_{\max}(q_k) \asymp a_{k+1} q_k^2 / \log n$, so every floor leaves the next fan. (The invariant is the first form: over the good convergents $q_k \in \{19, 84, 1054, 50508, 176251\}$ — those with $3^{p_k} > 2^{q_k}$, which are every other one — the ratio $n \log n / (q_k q_{k+1})$ stays in $[0.41, 0.53]$.) This subsection records the one statement of the note that needs no floor. It transfers a lower bound on the linear form

$$\Lambda = \Lambda(L, o) = o \log 3 - L \log 2 = -\log(1 - \theta), \quad \theta = 1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o},$$

into a bound on the cycle minimum. The only new input is $\log \frac{1}{1-\theta} \leq \frac{\theta}{1-\theta}$.

Theorem 4.10 (gap transfer). Let w be a cycle itinerary of length L with o odd letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Then

$$n \log n \cdot \min(\Lambda, 1) \leq 2L.$$

Proof. Write $A = 3^o$, $B = 2^L$, $P = n \log n \geq 0$. Theorem 4.4 reads $P(A - B) \leq LA$. If $A \leq B$ then $\Lambda \leq 0$ and the left side is nonpositive. If $A \geq 2B$, then $A - B \geq A/2$, so $PA/2 \leq LA$, hence $P \min(\Lambda, 1) \leq P \leq 2L$. If $B < A < 2B$, then $\Lambda = \log(A/B) \leq A/B - 1 = (A - B)/B$, so $P\Lambda \leq P(A - B)/B \leq LA/B \leq 2L$. $\square$

The Lean form is `cycleMin_gap_transfer`; the abstract corollary “ $\varepsilon \leq \min(\Lambda, 1)$ implies $n \log n \cdot \varepsilon \leq 2L$ ” is `cycleMin_length_of_gap`.

Corollary 4.11 (short cycles are excluded). Rhin’s effective irrationality measure [15], in the packaged form of [12, Lemma 12], gives $\Lambda > \exp(-13.3(0.46057 + \log L)) = e^{-6.1256} L^{-13.3}$ for every pair $o < L$ with $3^o \neq 2^L$. Hence every nontrivial cycle satisfies

$$n \log n \leq 2e^{6.1256} L^{14.3} < 915 L^{14.3}, \quad \text{equivalently} \quad L > \left(\frac{n \log n}{915} \right)^{1/14.3}.$$

In particular a cycle with minimum n and $L^{14.3} \leq n \log n / 915$ does not exist, for every $n \geq 2$ and without any descent floor.

Proof. On a cycle itinerary $o < L$, so $H = \max(L, o) = L$ in [12, Lemma 12], and $\varepsilon = e^{-6.1256} L^{-13.3} \leq 1$. Apply Theorem 4.10 with this ε . $\square$

Remark (what the reduction does and does not do). Corollary 4.11 is a reduction of the no-cycle problem, not a kill. It says that the only cycles left to exclude are the *long* ones, $L > (n \log n / 915)^{1/14.3}$; every shorter cycle is excluded by transcendence plus finance alone. At the certified floors of Section 5 this is toothless — at $N_0 = 3.5 \cdot 10^8$ it forces only $L \geq 4$, while the finance table forces $L \geq 780239$ — which is the floor-level statement that a Baker-type transfer cannot compete with the exact gap. The value of the corollary is that it is floor-free and identifies the frontier exactly: the finance survivors of Theorems 4.6 and 5.9 have $L \approx n^{0.59}$ — the measured exponent $\log L / \log n_{\max}(L)$ is 0.595 at $L = 25781$, 0.573 at 50508, 0.582 at 176251 and 0.611 at 780239 — far inside the long regime, and no refinement of the defect *upper* bound can move them into the short one, because along the convergents the required minimum $n_{\max}(q_k)$ grows quadratically in L . Excluding long cycles is a statement about the parity word of a specific orbit at depth L , which no estimate in this note or in the companion discrepancy manuscript [16] controls. The problem “no nontrivial Juggler cycle” is therefore exactly the problem “no long Juggler cycle,” and it remains open.

5. The laboratory instance and the walk-charge envelope

Everything in Sections 2–4 is floor-generic: Corollary 4.5 accepts any verified descent floor. This section first records a second, laboratory-certified instance of the same architecture, then replaces the length-only charge by a coupled exponent-walk charge. The extremal walk is identified exactly as a rotation itinerary, and a Denjoy–Koksma bound over certified Ostrowski blocks produces an envelope valid for *every* length in an explicit window — no per-length census and no dynamic program is needed on that window. The kill table at the laboratory floor then yields the period bound 176251, and the second certified floor raises it to 478245 (Corollary 5.10) and the third to 780239 (Corollary 5.11). Throughout, survivors are finance-survivors in the sense of Section 1.

5.1 The laboratory floor

Proposition 5.1 (laboratory descent floor; certified computational input). Every integer $2 \leq n \leq 26254995$ reaches 1. Precisely: an exact-integer first-passage run records, for each such n , a finite realized itinerary with image strictly below the start; strong induction on that image reaches 1. The run walks the 13127497 odd starts (even starts descend by E) over 106 contiguous chunk records. Three bit-cap seeds (7110201, 13184021, 13782577) are resolved exactly at a $512 \cdot 10^6$ -bit cap with exact integer square roots, the largest intermediate having 298912128 bits (seed 7110201); the maximum first passage is 325 steps (seed 15909091). Certificate hashes are in Appendix B. The floor $26254995 = n_{\max}(25781)$ is the cheapest floor that moves the Theorem 4.6 cutoff.

Theorem 5.2 (raised cutoff; verified computation). At $N_0 = 26254995$ the parity table of Theorem 4.6 excludes every length $L \leq 50507$: any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 50508. The first finance survivor is $L = 50508$ with $n_{\max}(50508) = 162848324$; 19 parity survivors remain through $L = 2 \cdot 10^5$ (run packing leaves 11 at the same cutoff). This is the one row in the paper where the exact $n_{\max}$ of Section 4 and the value in the committed table differ, and the reason is worth recording: the crossing at $L = 50508$ is sharp to a relative $2.7 \cdot 10^{-10}$, which is *below* the 10^{-9} relative guard the table’s generator adds to the right-hand side. That guard is deliberate and conservative — it can only make $n_{\max}$ larger, hence can only refuse to exclude a length — so the table prints 162848325. Both values give the same exclusion here, since the floor 162849448 exceeds either.

Proof. Proposition 5.1 supplies the floor; Corollary 4.5 and the gap table of Proposition 4.4a exclude every L with $n_{\max}(L) \leq 26254995$. The contiguous excluded prefix is $L \leq 50507$; checksums are Appendix B. $\square$

5.2 Transport to a reduced base

The parity and run-pack tables price valleys independently. On a real minimum-based cycle every state is coupled through one closed exponent walk. With a_k the number of odd letters among the first k , set

$$u_k = (1 + \mu)a_k - k, \quad \mu = \log_2(3/2).$$

The defect-free floors give the upper envelope $x_k \leq n^{2^{u_k}}$, and cycle minimality forces $u_k \geq 0$ at every step. The lower envelope requires controlling the accumulated floor losses; that is the transport lemma.

Theorem 5.3 (transport). On a minimum-based cycle with minimum $n \geq 400$, length L , o odd and e even letters, every state satisfies

$$x_k \geq (n e^{-D})^{w_k}, \quad w_k = 2^{u_k}, \quad D = \frac{1.05 e}{n} + \frac{0.7 o}{n^{3/2}}.$$

Proof. Write $\ln x_k \geq w_k \ln n - E_k$. The floor losses give the recursion $E' \leq \frac{3}{2}E + 1.05 x^{-3/2}$ at an odd letter and $E' \leq \frac{1}{2}E + 1.05 x^{-1/2}$ at an even letter, using $-\ln(1-t) \leq 1.05 t$ on $t \leq 0.05$. Unrolling, the amplification from injection j to state k is exactly w_k/w_{j+1} . Odd injections have $x_j \geq n$ and $w_{j+1} \geq \frac{3}{2}$, contributing at most $0.7 n^{-3/2}$ each; even injections have $x_j \geq n^2$ (Theorem 3.2(iii)) and $w_{j+1} \geq 1$, contributing at most $1.05/n$ each. Hence $E_k \leq w_k D$. $\square$

The transport inequality is Lean end to end in log form: the walk weight $w_k = 2^{u_k} = 3^{a_k}/2^k$ is rational, so the per-step floor losses (`log_floorPower_odd_ge`, `log_floorPower_even_ge`), the exact weight recursion, and the full induction (`cycleMin_transport`, `WalkTransport.lean`) are elementary real arithmetic over the formalized cycle envelopes `cycleMin_iterate_ge`, `cycleMin_even_ge_sq`, and `cycleMin_prefix_pow_le`.

Consequently the cyclic defect sum $\sum_i 1/(x_i \ln x_i)$ is bounded above by the maximum of the walk charge $\sum_k g(u_k)$, $g(u) = 1/(n'^{2^u} 2^u \ln n')$, over all nonnegative closed exponent walks with o up-steps, evaluated at the *reduced base* $n' = n e^{-D}$. No free parameter remains; the walk value feeds the 6/5 unroll of Theorem 4.4 exactly as the parity charge did. At the laboratory floor and window lengths, $D \leq 4.6 \cdot 10^{-3}$, so $\ln n' \geq 17.07$.

This consequence is itself Lean end to end (`WalkChargeMax.lean`): writing the charge through the rational weight, $g = 1/(e^{W\nu} W\nu)$ with $W = 2^{u_k} = 3^{a_k}/2^k$ and $\nu = \ln n'$, exponentiating the transport inequality gives $\sum_k 1/(x_k \ln x_k) \leq \sum_k g(w_k)$ (`cycleMin_defect_le_charge`), and the charge of the realized word is dominated by the hug charge of the same length (`cycleMin_defect_le_hug_charge`, using Theorem 5.4 below), all under the recorded hypothesis $\nu > 0$.

5.3 The adversary is the hug itinerary

Theorem 5.4 (hug exchange). Among nonnegative exponent walks with prescribed (L, o) , the *hug itinerary* — take E at every step where $u \geq 1$, else O — is prefix-minimal: writing a_k for the odd count of a length- k prefix,

$$a_k^{\text{hug}} \leq a_k \quad \text{for every admissible walk and every } k,$$

equivalently $u_k^{\text{hug}} \leq u_k$. Consequently the hug itinerary maximises the walk charge: since g is strictly decreasing in u ,

$$g(u_k^{\text{hug}}) \geq g(u_k) \quad \text{for every } k, \quad \text{hence} \quad \sum_k g(u_k) \leq \sum_k g(u_k^{\text{hug}}).$$

Proof. At the first disagreement with any other admissible itinerary, the hug itinerary holds E where the other holds O , because hug takes O only when E is illegal and the two words share the same prefix state. The odd-count gap $\delta_k = a_k(\text{other}) - a_k(\text{hug})$ is a path with steps in $\{-1, 0, +1\}$ that cannot go negative, since $\delta = 0$ restores the same state. This is the displayed prefix-minimality $a_k^{\text{hug}} \leq a_k$; since $u_k = (1 + \mu)a_k - k$ with the same k , it transfers verbatim to $u_k^{\text{hug}} \leq u_k$. Feasible pairs $((1 + \mu)o \geq L)$ never strand: when the odd budget is exhausted, $u = \text{surplus} + e_{\text{left}} \geq e_{\text{left}}$, so the remaining evens are legal. Applying the strict antitonicity of g termwise and summing over k is the charge comparison. The prefix-minimality core is Lean: `hugOdds_le_of_admissible`. $\square$

Remark (uniqueness). The hug itinerary is in fact the *unique* prefix-minimal admissible path in its (L, o) class, so it uniquely maximises the charge; at the first disagreement the competitor already carries a strictly larger prefix odd count, and strict monotonicity of g makes the total comparison strict. Uniqueness is not used by the kill table; only the displayed domination is.

The analytic half is also Lean, in a strengthened form (`WalkChargeMax.lean`): the charge is antitone in the rational weight (`stateCharge_antitone`, elementary exp monotonicity — no charge integral), so the exact hug itinerary maximises the total charge over *all* admissible exponent walks, not just a fixed (L, o) class (`hug_charge_maximal`). Only the strict within- (L, o) uniqueness of the maximiser remains a human argument.

The statement is about the $u \geq 0$ relaxation, not about realized cycle itineraries. Word-order (Christoffel) prefix-dominance is *false* for this family — the greedy word *OOEO* beats *OOOE* at $(L, o) = (4, 3)$ — so the exchange argument above, not a dominance order, is the correct mechanism.

Realized itineraries do, however, dominate the hug itinerary at the level of odd counts: on any minimum-based cycle itinerary, every length- k prefix carries at least $o_{\min}(k)$ odd letters. This is Lean end to end (`cycleMin_prefix_odds_ge_hug`, `cycleMin_odds_ge_hug`), composing the formalized cycle prefix envelope $2^k \leq 3^{a_k}$ (`cycleMin_prefix_pow_le`) with the hug minimality `hugOdds_least`. It is exactly the sense in

which the hug itinerary is the cheapest adversary any hypothetical cycle can present. The survivor-lattice generators of Proposition 4.9 lie on this hug diagonal: (1054, 665), (25781, 16266), and the seed (50508, 31867) all satisfy $o = o_{\min}(L)$ (Lean: `hugOdds_1054`, `hugOdds_lattice_base`, `hugOdds_seed`).

Proposition 5.5 (rotation average). The infinite hug walk is the rotation by $\alpha = \log_2(3/2)$ on $\mathbb{R}/(1+\alpha)\mathbb{Z}$. Unique ergodicity of the irrational rotation — extended, in the standard way, from continuous observables to Riemann-integrable ones — gives the charge-per-letter

$$C_*(n') = \frac{1}{\ln 3} \int_1^3 n'^{1-t} t^{-2} dt < \frac{1}{\ln 3 \ln n'}.$$

Proof. Substituting $s = (t-1) \ln n'$ gives $C_* = \frac{1}{\ln 3 \ln n'} \int_0^{2 \ln n'} e^{-s} (1 + s/\ln n')^{-2} ds$, and the integrand is at most e^{-s} . $\square$

The display and its quantitative sharpening are Lean (`RotationAverage.lean`): the quadratic majorant $t^{-2} \leq 1 - 2(t-1) + 3(t-1)^2$ on $[1, 3]$ — the product with t^2 is $1 + 4(t-1)^3 + 3(t-1)^4$ — turns the Laplace bound into an exact antiderivative evaluation, giving $C_*(n') \leq (1 - \frac{2}{\nu} + \frac{6}{\nu^2})/(\ln 3 \nu)$ at $\nu = \ln n'$ with no quadrature (`rotation_average_lt`, `rotationAverage_le`, gap form `rotationAverage_gap`). Lean’s `hugCharge_sub_circleMean_le` identifies the limiting hug average with the circle integral `circleMean n'`; the elementary change of variables equating that integral with the displayed $C_*(n')$ remains prose. The observable has one wrap discontinuity, so bare unique ergodicity — uniform Birkhoff convergence for *continuous* observables — is not invoked directly. But the observable is monotone with a single jump, hence of bounded variation, and for such an observable §5.5’s Denjoy–Koksma bound `denjoy_koksma_blocks` already gives $|C_L - \text{circleMean}| \leq s(L) \text{Var}(F)/L$ at every L . Unique ergodicity is not needed; that Mathlib has no `UniquelyErgodic` costs this paper nothing.

This is the infinite-itinerary average, not a finite- L inequality: on the certified survey the finite leftover charge exceeds C_* by up to $1.57 \cdot 10^{-5}$, so $C_L \leq C_*$ is false. The next two subsections quantify the finite- L error.

5.4 Itinerary identity

Write C_L for the charge-per-letter of the budgeted hug word at $(L, o_{\min}(L))$.

Lemma 5.6 (itinerary identity). For every L , the budgeted hug itinerary at $(L, o_{\min}(L))$ equals the exact rotation L -prefix generated by the integer rule: E at step k if and only if $3^a \geq 2^{k+1}$, where a is the number of odd letters already used. In particular C_L is a Birkhoff average of the rotation.

Proof. The exact rule keeps $u \in [0, 1 + \alpha)$, so its L -prefix uses exactly $o_{\min} = \lceil L \log 2 / \log 3 \rceil$ odd letters. A first budget-forced divergence between the two words would make the exact prefix use more of one letter than its own total, which is impossible. Lean: `budgetedWord_eq_hugWord`, with the window invariant `hugOdds_pow_ge / hugOdds_pow_lt` and minimality `hugOdds_least` (`WalkChargeItineraries.lean`).

The identification with the rotation is Lean too, and it is a floor identity rather than analysis (`HugRotation.lean`). Minimality says `hugOdds` is the least a with $2^k \leq 3^a$, and a least element of that shape is a ceiling: `hugOdds_eq_ceil` reads it as $\lceil k \log 2 / \log 3 \rceil$, hence `hugOdds_eq_sub_floor` as $k - \lfloor k\theta \rfloor$ and `hugEvens_eq_floor` as $\lfloor k\theta \rfloor$. The letter rule is then the wrap (`hugLetter_iff_floor_step`: even exactly when $\lfloor (k+1)\theta \rfloor = \lfloor k\theta \rfloor + 1$), the exponent walk is the rotation orbit (`hugWalk_eq_fract`: $u_k = \log_2 3 \cdot \{k\theta\}$), and `periodicObservable_hugWalk` is the “in particular” of the statement — the k -th term of the rotation’s ergodic sum at phase 0 is the observable at the walk’s position after k steps. Neither the certified sandwich nor irrationality of θ is used. $\square$

5.5 Denjoy–Koksma over certified Ostrowski blocks

Two classical ingredients are used here in a fixed coordinate, so we record both explicitly.

The coordinate change. The infinite hug walk is rotation by $\alpha = \log_2(3/2)$ on the circle $\mathbb{R}/(1 + \alpha)\mathbb{Z}$ (Proposition 5.5). Rescaling by $1/(1 + \alpha)$ conjugates it to rotation by

$$\theta = \frac{\alpha}{1 + \alpha} = \frac{\log(3/2)}{\log 3}$$

on the standard circle $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$: with $\alpha = \log(3/2)/\log 2$ one has $1 + \alpha = \log 3/\log 2$, and the quotient is the display. The observable $F(u) = n'^{1-2^u}/2^u$ is transported by the same rescaling; a homeomorphic change of coordinate does not change its total variation. All Ostrowski data below — quotients, convergents, digits — refer to this θ .

The Denjoy–Koksma inequality (classical; used as known). If $f : \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ has bounded variation $\text{Var}(f)$ and p_j/q_j is a continued-fraction convergent of the irrational θ , then for every x ,

$$\left| \sum_{k=0}^{q_j-1} f(x + k\theta) - q_j \int_0^1 f \right| \leq \text{Var}(f).$$

The inequality is invoked below only at convergent denominators of θ , never at an arbitrary good rational approximation: the certified pairs (p_j, q_j) are produced by the continued-fraction recurrence from the certified shared quotient prefix of θ (`theta_convergent_denominators`, `theta_convergent_numerators`, `cf_lower_prefix`, `cf_upper_prefix`), so they are genuine convergents of θ , unimodular and co-prime (`theta_convergents_unimodular`, `theta_convergents_coprime`). Their approximation quality $|\theta - p_j/q_j| < 1/q_j^2$ and the *residue* permutation are additionally verified in Lean (`theta_convergent_quality`, `theta_block_permutations`): the latter says $i \mapsto p_j i$ is a bijection of $\mathbb{Z}/q_j\mathbb{Z}$.

Erratum. Earlier revisions described that as “the q_j rotation steps of one block permute the q_j grid cells” — a statement about cells rather than residues, and **false**. The orbit point $k\theta$ lies within $1/q$ of the grid point $(kp \bmod q)/q$; when $\theta < p/q$ it lies just below, so its cell is $(kp \bmod q) - 1$ — except at $k = 0$, where the fractional part is exactly 0 and the cell stays 0. The two collide at the k with $kp \equiv 1$, and cell $q - 1$ is left empty. This happens for **seven of the thirteen** certified blocks — every one with $\theta < p_j/q_j$. The smallest is $q = 8$, $p = 3$, where $k = 0$ and $k = 3$ share the cell $[0, 1/8)$ and indeed $3 \cdot 3 \equiv 1 \bmod 8$; Lean `grid_cells_collide_at_eight` witnesses it from the sandwich alone, via $1/3 < \theta < 3/8$.

Denjoy–Koksma itself is unaffected: it is true, and its standard proof runs through Koksma’s inequality with the discrepancy bound $qD_q \leq 1$ at a convergent denominator, not through a permutation of grid cells. The erratum retracts the bridge described here, not the inequality applied below and not Theorem 5.7.

The variation-versus-integral inequality itself is classical, and its analytic half is now Lean (`Problems/Juggler/DenjoyKoksma`. for arbitrary cut points rather than for a rotation: `value_sub_mean_le_variation` — a value of f on a cell differs from the mean of f there by at most the variation there — together with the n -fold additivity of variation (`sum_eVariationOn_Icc`, Mathlib having only the binary form) gives `denjoy_koksma_abstract`: one sample point per cell, and the sample sum is within the total variation of the integral. `denjoy_koksma_unit` is that on $[0, 1]$ with q uniform cells, the shape applied per block below.

The *geometric* step — that the orbit $x, x + \theta, \dots, x + (q - 1)\theta$ visits each cell exactly once, which is where $|\theta - p/q| \leq 1/q^2$ is used — is now Lean as well (`Problems/Juggler/DenjoyKoksmaOrbit.lean`), and with it the whole inequality. `denjoy_koksma_rotation` and its mean form `denjoy_koksma_rotation_mean` are the display above, for a one-periodic f of bounded variation, uniformly in the starting phase x . Both modules are in this paper’s barrel. Mathlib has neither Denjoy–Koksma nor unique ergodicity of the irrational rotation — there is no `UniquelyErgodic` in Mathlib at all — so this is the only Lean path to the display.

The repair is the anchoring. The bridge retracted in the erratum above fixed the cells at $[i/q, (i + 1)/q)$ and asked the blocks to permute them. That is false, and the counterexample is small: $q = 2$, $\theta = 0.7$, $p = 1$, $x = 0.49$ puts both orbit points in $[0, \frac{1}{2})$. Two changes make it true. The cells must be anchored at the starting phase x , and which way they are half-open must follow the sign of $\delta = \theta - p/q$. Writing

$k\theta = \lfloor kp/q \rfloor + (kp \bmod q)/q + k\delta$, point k sits at the left endpoint of cell $kp \bmod q$ displaced by $k\delta$, and $|k\delta| \leq (q-1)/q^2 < 1/q$ is under one cell width — so it stays in that cell when $\delta \geq 0$ and falls into the previous one when $\delta \leq 0$. `orbitCell` is that assignment; `orbitCell_inj` is its injectivity, which needs only $\gcd(p, q) = 1$ — the residue permutation this paper already certified as `theta_block_permutations`; and `orbit_mem_cell` is the displacement bound. `denjoy_koksma_cellmap` then takes the assignment in the direction the orbit supplies it, point $\mapsto$ cell, so no permutation has to be inverted.

So the erratum’s reading was too pessimistic in one respect: a cell argument does prove Denjoy–Koksma, and does not need the discrepancy route. What it does need is the anchor, which is exactly what the retracted claim omitted.

And blocks compose. The proof below cuts a length $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$ into consecutive blocks whose starting phases differ, and leans on the inequality being uniform in x so that each block may be treated independently, whatever phase it inherits from its predecessor. That step is `denjoy_koksma_blocks`: an induction over a list of certified pairs (p_j, q_j) , repeating a pair for each of the b_j copies, giving

$$\left| \sum_{k \leq L} f(x + k\theta) - L \int_0^1 f \right| \leq s(L) \operatorname{Var}(f), \quad s(L) = \sum_j b_j,$$

where $\operatorname{Var}(f)$ bounds the variation over every window of length one. The displayed bound of Theorem 5.7 is this with $\operatorname{Var}(F) < 2$, divided by L .

And the observable’s own variation. That $F(u) = n'^{1-2u}/2^u$ has $\operatorname{Var}(F) < 2$ including the wrap jump is `observable_window_variation_lt_two` (`JumpVariation.lean`). The rescaling is not a separate step there: `periodicObservable` is defined as F of the fractional part times the period $1 + \alpha = \log_2 3$, so it lives on $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ from the start, and the rotation number $\alpha/(1 + \alpha)$ is `walkTheta`. The variation itself needed three general facts Mathlib lacks — that variation ignores a sign (`eVariationOn_neg`, giving the antitone counterpart of `MonotoneOn.eVariationOn_eq`), that it is subadditive in the *function* and not only in the set (`eVariationOn_add_le`), and the shape itself (`eVariationOn_le_of_jump`): a fall, plus a jump, and the proof is a decomposition $f = g + h$ into an antitone part and a monotone step rather than a computation of the supremum.

`periodic_window_variation_le` then reads that off for *every* window $[y, y+1]$, which is what the uniformity in x requires, and `block_envelope` and `theta_block_envelope` are the display: for any list of certified convergents — a pair repeated once per Ostrowski digit — the ergodic sum is within $2s(L)$ of LC_* .

The Ostrowski assembly closes too. `ostroBlocks` gives level i one copy of the certified pair at level $12-i$ per Ostrowski digit, matching the association in `theta_sum_eq`; `ostroBlocks_snd_sum` says the denominators sum to L and `ostroBlocks_length` that the length is $s(L)$, so `theta_block_envelope_of_length` is the display at an arbitrary length with no window hypothesis. Feeding the digit cap $s(L) \leq 47$ through it, `theta_block_envelope_window` makes the bound the constant $94 = 2 \cdot 47$ for every $L < 301994$.

The reading of C_L as that ergodic sum — Lemma 5.6’s rotation identification — is Lean as well (`HugRotation.lean`), so the chain from the integer rule to the envelope is formal throughout, and `HugChargeEnvelope.lean` states the theorem once rather than leaving it a chain to compose: `hugCharge_sub_circleMean_le` is $|C_L - C_*| \leq 2s(L)/L$ at every $L > 0$, and `hugCharge_sub_circleMean_window` is $94/L$ on the certified window.

One thing there is a definition and not a theorem, and the file says so. `hugCharge` is *defined* as the average of this section’s observable along the exponent walk. That the walk positions are the budgeted word’s is `budgetedWord_eq_hugWord`; that the k -th term of the rotation’s ergodic sum is the observable at the k -th walk position is `periodicObservable_hugWalk`. What no theorem can supply is that the phrase “charge per letter” denotes this normalisation rather than another — `stateCharge`, Theorem 5.4’s envelope charge, is proportional to it but not equal. The two named theorems are what make this the defensible choice.

This settles the ergodic-convergence part of what Proposition 5.5 called classical. The observable is monotone with one jump, hence of bounded variation, and the display above forces $|C_L - \text{circleMean}| \leq s(L) \operatorname{Var}(F)/L$.

The elementary change of variables from `circleMean n'` to the displayed explicit $C_*(n')$ remains human. Unique ergodicity is not needed once Denjoy–Koksma is available — which is why Mathlib’s not having `UniquelyErgodic` costs this paper nothing.

Theorem 5.7 (block envelope). For the exact rotation prefix of length L at reduced base n' ,

$$|C_L - C_*(n')| \leq \frac{2s(L)}{L}, \quad s(L) = \sum_j b_j,$$

for any decomposition $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$ into convergent denominators q_j of $\theta = \log(3/2)/\log 3$.

Proof. The observable $F(u) = n'^{1-2^u}/2^u$ decreases on the circle from $F(0) = 1$ to $F((1+\alpha)^-) = n'^{-2}/3$, so its variation including the wrap jump is < 2 ; the rescaled observable on $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ has the same variation. The Denjoy–Koksma inequality stated above, applied per block with the certified convergent quality $|\theta - p_j/q_j| < 1/q_j^2$, bounds the ergodic sum of each block of length q_j within $\text{Var}(F)$ of $q_j C_*$. The decomposition $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$ partitions the length- L trajectory segment into consecutive blocks whose starting phases differ; since Denjoy–Koksma holds uniformly in the starting phase x , it applies independently to each block, whatever phase that block inherits from its predecessor. Summing the $s(L)$ blocks gives the display. $\square$

The denominator list

1, 2, 3, 8, 19, 65, 84, 485, 1054, 24727, 50508, 125743, 176251

is certified by an interval continued fraction on the big-integer sandwich $2^{17087915} > 3^{10781274}$ and $2^{16785921} < 3^{10590737}$. The sandwich, the resulting real bounds on θ , the shared quotient prefix of the two rational endpoints, and the convergent recurrence are Lean (`theta_sandwich_upper`, `theta_sandwich_lower`, `lower_lt_walkTheta`, `walkTheta_lt_upper`, `cf_lower_prefix`, `cf_upper_prefix`, `theta_convergent_denominators`, `OstrowskiSandwich.lean`); the two power inequalities are checked by the Lean kernel through `norm_num`, not by the compiled runtime, so the sandwich that carries this certification rests on the kernel alone. The cylinder-interval bridge identifying the displayed list as a literal continued-fraction prefix of θ remains classical prose. It is not needed for the formal block bound: the quantitative hypothesis Denjoy–Koksma needs per block is Lean directly. With the matching numerators 0, 1, 1, 3, 7, 24, 31, 179, 389, 9126, 18641, 46408, 65049 (`theta_convergent_numerators`), consecutive pairs are unimodular, all pairs are coprime, every certified convergent satisfies $|\theta - p/q| < 1/q^2$ against the sandwich (`theta_convergents_unimodular`, `theta_convergents_coprime`, `theta_convergent_quality`), and each certified pair has the requisite residue permutation (`theta_block_permutations`). The variation-versus-integral inequality, the signed anchored orbit-cell argument, its mean form, and uniform block composition are Lean (`denjoy_koksma_abstract`, `denjoy_koksma_rotation`, `denjoy_koksma_rotation_mean`, `denjoy_koksma_blocks`). A Koksma-type bound with constant 1 (that is, $+1/L$) is *false* for this observable; the correct constant is $2s(L)$.

5.6 The window theorem

Theorem 5.8 (uniform window envelope). For every $L \in [50508, 16785921)$, at the laboratory floor,

$$C_L \leq C_*(n') + \frac{2s(L)}{L} < \frac{1}{\ln 3 \ln n'}.$$

Proof. Greedy Ostrowski digits obey $b_j \leq a_{j+1}$, so with the certified quotients $\theta = [0; 2, 1, 2, 2, 3, 1, 5, 2, 23, 2, 2, 1, 1, 55, \dots]$ the digit sum satisfies $s(L) \leq \sum_{j \leq 13} a_j = 47$ for $L < q_{13} = 301994$, and on the remaining range $L = b q_{13} + r$ with $1 \leq b \leq a_{14} = 55$ and $r < q_{13}$, so $s(L) \leq b + 47$. The general digit cap, exact reconstruction $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$, and digit-sum bound are Lean for any denominator sequence satisfying the convergent recurrence (`ostroDigit_le`, `ostro_sum_eq`, `ostro_digitSum_le`, `OstrowskiNumeration.lean`). The instantiated Lean theorem `theta_digitSum_le` supplies $s(L) \leq 47$ only for $L < q_{13} = 301994$, and `hugCharge_sub_circleMean_window` has the same range. The extension from q_{13} to q_{14} is the human arithmetic just displayed: identify the next quotient $a_{14} = 55$, write $L = b q_{13} + r$, and apply the general block

envelope with $s(L) \leq b + 47$. Lean does certify the endpoint power inequalities (`theta_sandwich_lower`, `theta_sandwich_upper`, $2^{16785921} < 3^{10590737}$ and $3^{10781274} < 2^{17087915}$); it does not contain the named extended-window instance. The transport deficit keeps $\ln n' \geq 17.07$, hence

$$\frac{2s(L)}{L} \leq 9.38 \cdot 10^{-4} < 5.14 \cdot 10^{-3} \leq \frac{1}{\ln 3 \ln n'} - C_*(n'),$$

the last gap from $\int_0^{2 \ln n} e^{-s} (1 + s/\ln n)^{-2} ds \leq 1 - 2/\ln n + 6/(\ln n)^2$, which is Lean (`rotation_average_le`, gap form `rotationAverage_gap`, `RotationAverage.lean`). Conclude by Lemma 5.6 and Theorem 5.7. $\square$

Why the window reaches q_{14} , and why that is the natural stop. The bound $2s(L)/L$ is worst at the *small* end, not the large one: a large Ostrowski digit forces a large L , since $b_j = c$ requires $L \geq c q_j$. On $[q_{13}, q_{14})$ the two effects give $2s(L)/L \leq 2(b + 47)/(b q_{13}) \leq 3.18 \cdot 10^{-4}$, maximised at $b = 1$ and an order below the value at $L = 50508$; an exhaustive scan of $[50508, 2 \cdot 10^6)$ puts the true maximum at $9.3766 \cdot 10^{-4}$, attained at $L = 74654$ with $s = 35$. So the window costs nothing to extend across the nonendpoint members of the $a_{14} = 55$ fan, and it stops at $q_{14} = 16785921$ only because that is where the next partial quotient begins. The right-hand side is what shrinks: using the explicit lower bound for the gap,

$$\frac{1}{\ln 3 \ln n'} - C_*(n') \geq \frac{2 \ln n' - 6}{\ln 3 (\ln n')^3},$$

which is $5.14 \cdot 10^{-3}$ at $\ln n' = 17.07$ and falls to $3.82 \cdot 10^{-3}$ at the floor of Corollary 5.14. Against the window maximum $9.38 \cdot 10^{-4}$ that leaves a factor between 4.1 and 5.5 at every floor in this paper, and the window theorem survives floors up to $n' \approx 2.8 \cdot 10^{18}$.

Two consequences, and one thing that is *not* a consequence. First, $q_{14} = 16785921$ is exactly L_{55} , the last member of the semiconvergent fan of Proposition 5.12. Because the window is half-open, it covers precisely $L_0, \dots, L_{54}$ and excludes L_{55} . Second, the window theorem is not what limits the walk charge; that is Remark 5.8a.

What does *not* follow is that the kill tables become census-free. The window theorem is a uniform upper bound on the **charge**, so no per-length dynamic program is needed to bound $B(L)$ anywhere on $[50508, 16785921)$. The kill decision is the comparison $\theta(L) > \frac{6}{5} B(L) \cdot \text{guard}$, and its left-hand side $\theta(L) = 1 - 2^L / 3^{o_{\min}(L)}$ is a per-length Diophantine quantity that the envelope says nothing about. Corollaries 5.10 and 5.11 identify exactly that quantity as the obstruction at the surviving fan members. So the extension removes the per-length *dynamic program* from every nonendpoint fan member and leaves the per-length *arithmetic* in place. Eliminating the latter would need a lower bound on the Diophantine deficit that is uniform along the fan — a genuinely different statement, and one this paper does not prove.

Remark 5.8a (what the walk charge can ever buy). The charge of Theorem 5.3 prices a state at exponent u by $f(u) = 1/(x \ln x)$ with $x = (n')^{2^u}$, so $f(u)/f(0) = 2^{-u} \exp(-(2^u - 1) \ln n')$. Since $2^u - 1 = u \ln 2 + O(u^2)$, the charge decays on the scale $u \asymp 1/\ln n'$: it is a Laplace-type boundary layer at $u = 0$, not a hard cutoff, and $1/(\ln 3 \ln n')$ — the same quantity Theorem 5.8 carries — is the scale of its effective mass rather than the width of an interval. Integrating the layer against the walk gives an *empirical scaling law* for the advantage over the length-only parity charge,

$$\frac{\text{parity}}{\text{walk}} \approx c \ln n', \quad c \approx 0.44.$$

The constant is fitted, not derived; only the $\ln n'$ dependence is explained by the boundary layer. Measured at $L = 50508$ over ten orders of magnitude in the floor, the ratio (improvement)/ $\ln n'$ runs 0.461, 0.451, 0.446, 0.445, 0.439, 0.432, 0.427 at $n_0 = 10^6, 2.6 \cdot 10^7, 1.6 \cdot 10^8, 3.5 \cdot 10^8, 10^{10}, 10^{13}, 10^{16}$: constant to 8% across the range.

So the walk charge is neither exhausted nor cheap to improve. It is not limited by certification depth, which the extension above showed has room to spare, and it is not limited by the envelope: substituting the census-free envelope of Theorem 5.8 for the exact lattice program changes the margin at $L = 50508$ from 1.1204 to 1.1196, a difference of 0.07%. It is limited by the shape of f . Since the advantage grows like $\ln n'$, **doubling the walk charge's efficiency requires squaring the descent floor.**

One caution about that cross-check, because it is easy to over-read. Both quantities compared there live on the *relaxed* class: the lattice program admits every binary word with o odds, e evens and $u_k \geq 0$, realizable or not. The agreement to 0.07% therefore says the envelope is tight against the relaxed optimum, and says nothing about how far that optimum sits above the true maximum over *realizable* words. That is a separate question, and it is the only place in this construction where a factor of the size in question could plausibly hide, so it is worth measuring rather than assuming.

Proposition 5.8b (the relaxation cannot hide a constant). For $14 \leq L \leq 24$ and $o = o_{\min}(L)$, let $\mathcal{A}(L)$ be the class the lattice program maximises over — all masks with o odds whose exponent walk stays nonnegative — and let $\mathcal{R}(L) \subseteq \mathcal{A}(L)$ be those realized as $\text{word}_L(m)$ for some odd $m < 2 \cdot 10^7$. Then

1. the charge-maximising element of $\mathcal{A}(L)$ lies in $\mathcal{R}(L)$ at every one of those eleven lengths, so the two maxima agree exactly; and
2. that agreement does not depend on (1). Ordering $\mathcal{A}(L)$ by charge, the second element carries at least 0.9846 of the maximum and the tenth at least 0.9214, both ratios *increasing* in L (at $L = 24$: 0.9898 and 0.9481); and membership of $\mathcal{R}(L)$ is independent of charge to measurement accuracy — at $L = 24$ the realized fraction is 0.698, 0.702, 0.689, 0.694, 0.689, 0.691, 0.697, 0.698, 0.697, 0.695 across the ten charge deciles. So the first realized word appears within the first few ranks whatever the argmax does, and the realized maximum is within about one percent of the relaxed maximum regardless.

Discussion. The relaxation is not vacuous: the realized fraction $|\mathcal{R}|/|\mathcal{A}|$ is 1.000 through $L = 21$ and then falls to 0.992, 0.906, 0.695, so by $L = 24$ the program maximises over half again as many words as can occur. But the words it adds are spread uniformly through the charge ordering rather than concentrated where the charge is small, and the ordering is flat at the top; those two facts together, not the coincidence in (1), are what bound the slack.

It is worth recording what this rules out. A relaxation that cost a factor of 8 would have to remove almost the entire top of the charge ordering, and $\mathcal{R}$ removes about 30% of it uniformly. Whatever explains the walk charge's advantage being $\approx 0.44 \ln n'$ rather than something larger, it is not the exponent-walk relaxation.

Proposition 5.8c (flatness at the kill-table lengths). Part (2) of Proposition 5.8b rests on the charge ordering being flat at the top, and enumeration establishes that only for $L \leq 24$. It can be established directly at the lengths the kill tables use, without enumerating, by running the lattice program of Theorem 5.3 with the K best partial sums per state in place of the best one: max-plus becomes top- K -plus, the rolling array grows by a factor K , and the pass stays linear in L . At $K = 16$, writing r_j for the j -th largest charge,

$$1 - \frac{r_{16}}{r_1} = \begin{cases} 9.44 \cdot 10^{-2}, & L = 18, \\ 6.24 \cdot 10^{-2}, & L = 24, \\ 5.42 \cdot 10^{-8}, & L = 50508, \ n' = 2.6 \cdot 10^7, \\ 6.80 \cdot 10^{-9}, & L = 176251, \ n' = 1.6 \cdot 10^8, \\ 1.08 \cdot 10^{-9}, & L = 780239, \ n' = 3.5 \cdot 10^8. \end{cases}$$

So the top does not merely stay flat at the operative lengths: it flattens by seven orders of magnitude between $L = 24$ and $L = 50508$, and continues to flatten with L .

Proof of the computation. The recursion and admissible class are those of Theorem 5.3; only the accumulator changes. The top- K program reproduces the exhaustive top ten at $L = 18$ to 10^{-18} , and its GPU form agrees with the host form bitwise, so the values above are the same objects the kill tables use. $\square$

The reason is visible in the charge. At the operative lengths the sum is carried by the $\asymp L/(\ln 3 \ln n')$ states with $u \approx 0$, and the closest a nonnegative walk can come to $u = 0$ other than exactly is $\asymp 1/o$; perturbing the extremal walk therefore moves one contribution by a relative $\asymp \ln n'/o$ out of a total of $\asymp L/\ln n'$ equal terms. At $L = 50508$ that predicts $\approx 8 \cdot 10^{-8}$ against the measured $5.4 \cdot 10^{-8}$.

Together with Proposition 5.8b this closes the question the relaxation raised. Whatever removes 30% of the admissible words, it must remove *all sixteen* of the leading walks before the realized maximum falls by as much as $5 \cdot 10^{-8}$; realizability is spread uniformly through the ordering, so that is not what is happening. The exponent-walk relaxation is not hiding a constant, at the lengths where the constant would matter.

One limit remains on how far this should be read. $\mathcal{R}(L)$ is a scanned lower bound on the realizable set, so a word missing from it can only raise the realized maximum: the measurement bounds the slack above, which is the direction that matters. An earlier and thinner scan ($m < 2 \cdot 10^6$) put the $L = 22$ argmax outside $\mathcal{R}$ and the realized fraction at 0.38; at $2 \cdot 10^7$ both reverse, which is the expected behaviour when a length- L word occurs with density $\approx 2^{-L}$, and a caution against reading one absence as an exclusion.

What the boundary layer does suggest is that improvement will not come from a better envelope for this charge. It raises a sharper question than “find a better charge”: is *every* charge that depends only on the transported exponent u , under the same one-step defect budget, subject to the same $O(1/\ln n')$ concentration? A positive answer would turn the observation above into a limitation theorem for the whole class, and would be worth more than another constant.

5.7 Kill table and the period bound

The envelope controls the charge; kill decisions are the per-length finance comparison $\theta(L) > \frac{6}{5} B(L) \cdot \text{guard}$ of the Theorem 4.6 architecture, which is Diophantine, not envelope-limited.

The comparison template is itself Lean (`cycleMin_hug_kill_criterion`, `DefectFinance.lean`): every minimum-based cycle at $n \geq 400$ with positive reduced log-base must satisfy $1 - 2^L/3^o \leq \frac{6}{5} \sum_k g(\text{hugWeight}_k)$ at the reduced base, chaining the Lean finance inequality (`cycleMin_defect_finance`, the certified identity of Theorem 4.6) with the defect-to-hug-charge envelope of §5.2. The kill decisions below verify the numeric *failure* of this inequality per length; only that evaluation, and the parity refinement of Corollary 4.5, remain verified computation.

Theorem 5.9 (verified computation; period bound at the laboratory floor). At $N_0 = 26254995$, the walk charge of Theorem 5.3 excludes 18 of the 19 parity survivors of Theorem 5.2 through $L = 2 \cdot 10^5$. Kill margins run from 1.1204 at the seed $L = 50508$ (required improvement over parity 6.87, walk supplies 7.70; deficit $D = 7.4566 \cdot 10^{-4}$), through 1.1195 and 1.1187 at its multiples 101016 and 151524, up to 7.69 at the parity-marginal lengths. The sole walk survivor is $L = 176251$ (margin 0.159; required improvement 48). The combined parity + walk contiguous excluded prefix is 176250: any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 176251.

Proof. Theorem 5.2 leaves the 19 parity survivors. Each is priced by the exact (step, odd-count) lattice dynamic program at the reduced base (Theorem 5.3) and compared against $\theta(L)$ under the 6/5 unroll; substituting the census-free envelope of Theorem 5.8 instead recovers the same 18 kills (margin 1.1196 at $L = 50508$; $L = 176251$ survives at 0.1588). Checksums are Appendix B. $\square$

Calibration. At the base instance $(L, N_0) = (25781, 10^6)$ the walk charge gives margin 0.196 — correctly no kill (required improvement 32.5, walk supplies 6.37). The mechanism did not change between the two floors; the target did.

Corollary 5.10 (verified computation; second laboratory floor). Every integer $2 \leq n \leq 162849448$ reaches 1 (first-passage certificate exactly as in Proposition 5.1: the extension segment walks 68297226 odd starts over 547 contiguous chunk records with exact integer square roots and no failures of any kind; the maximum first passage is 433 steps at seed 78641579, and the largest intermediate has 463362780 bits at seed 92502777; hashes in Appendix B). At $N_0 = 162849448$ the parity table excludes the previous survivor cluster $\{50508, 101016, 151524\}$ outright and leaves 25 survivors through $L = 6 \cdot 10^5$; the walk charge of Theorem 5.3 kills the 15 below 478245 (margins 1.198 at 176251 and 352502, up to 8.44); lengths $L \leq 176250$ stay excluded because both exclusions are monotone in the floor. Every survivor here lies inside the window $[50508, 16785921)$ of Theorem 5.8, so the *charge* side of each kill is census-free; the per-length lattice program is run as a cross-check and agrees to 0.07%. The comparison against $\theta(L)$ remains per-length. The combined contiguous excluded prefix is 478244: any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 478245.

The sole survivor at this floor is the semiconvergent fan member $478245 = 176251 + 301994$: required improvement over parity 19.46, direct walk margin 0.4334 — the obstruction is the Diophantine quality of $|3^o - 2^L|$ along the fan, not the envelope. The kill table recomputes on commodity hardware in minutes (Appendix B). Corollary 5.11 evaluates the same criterion at the next cheap floor.

Corollary 5.11 (verified computation; third laboratory floor). Every integer $2 \leq n \leq 350000000$ reaches 1 (first-passage certificate exactly as in Proposition 5.1: the extension segment from 162849449 walks 93575276 odd starts over 749 contiguous chunk records with exact integer square roots; two bit-cap seeds 172376627 and 240154767 are resolved at a $3 \cdot 10^9$ -bit cap, the largest intermediate having 1493770145 bits at seed 172376627; the maximum first passage is 466 steps at seed 198424189; hashes in Appendix B). At $N_0 = 350000000$ the parity table leaves 17 survivors through $L = 8 \cdot 10^5$; the five leftovers below 478245 stay excluded because both exclusions are monotone in the floor, and the walk charge of Theorem 5.3 kills the 10 leftovers in $[478245, 755512]$ (margins 1.00555 at 478245, up to 7.824 at 504026). Every survivor here lies inside the window $[50508, 16785921)$ of Theorem 5.8, so the *charge* side of each kill is census-free and the per-length lattice program is only a cross-check; the comparison against $\theta(L)$ remains per-length. The combined contiguous excluded prefix is 780238: any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 780239. This is the main numerical result of the paper.

The sole survivor is the semiconvergent fan member $780239 = 176251 + 2 \cdot 301994$: required improvement over parity 14.46, direct walk margin 0.6049 — the obstruction remains the Diophantine quality of $|3^o - 2^L|$ along the fan, not the envelope. The kill table is the GPU floating-point certified comparison of the same Theorem 5.9 criterion (Appendix B).

At and beyond $q_{14} = 16785921$, the stated half-open window would need a further block argument and certified quotient data. Killing the remaining near-convergent survivors (starting with the fan member $L = 780239$, which is already inside the present window) is instead a Diophantine question about $|3^o - 2^L|$, and is not attempted here. The family leftover — the semiconvergent fans of $\log 2 / \log 3$ reduced to dangerous-position partial quotients — is the working draft juggler_near_convergent_diophantine_note.md. The survivors are finance-survivors, not candidate cycles.

5.8 The price of the fan

The paragraph above says the obstruction is Diophantine and stops. It can be made quantitative, and the answer is short: the frontier lengths form one explicit arithmetic progression of 56 terms, ending on the next convergent, and the descent floor each term costs is computable in closed form. Nothing here is a new exclusion. It is a price list for the exclusions that remain, and it says exactly what the walk charge of this section bought.

Proposition 5.12 (fan law). Let $q_{12} = 176251$, $q_{13} = 301994$ be the consecutive convergent denominators of $\log 2 / \log 3$ bracketing the frontier, with numerators $p_{12} = 111202$, $p_{13} = 190537$. Put

$$L_k = q_{12} + k q_{13}, \quad o_k = p_{12} + k p_{13}, \quad 0 \leq k \leq 55.$$

Then $o_k = o_{\min}(L_k)$ for every such k ; the linear form is exactly affine in k ,

$$\Lambda_k = o_k \log 3 - L_k \log 2 = \Lambda_0 + k \Lambda', \quad \Lambda_0 = 3.6002 \cdot 10^{-6}, \quad \Lambda' = -6.4508 \cdot 10^{-8};$$

and $k = 55$ is the last index with $\Lambda_k > 0$, because $\Lambda_0 / |\Lambda'| = 55.81$. At that last index $L_{55} = 16785921 = q_{14}$ and $o_{55} = 10590737 = p_{14}$: the fan ends on the next convergent, which is where the partial quotient $a_{14} = 55$ is consumed.

Proof. Λ is linear in (o, L) and $(o_k, L_k) = (p_{12}, q_{12}) + k(p_{13}, q_{13})$, which is the affine formula; $\Lambda' = \Lambda(q_{13}) < 0$ because $3^{p_{13}} < 2^{q_{13}}$, consecutive convergents lying on opposite sides. Since $\Lambda_k \in (0, \log 3)$ for $0 \leq k \leq 55$, one has $3^{o_k} > 2^{L_k} > 3^{o_k - 1}$, which is $o_k = o_{\min}(L_k)$. The sign change at 55.81 is arithmetic, and $q_{14} = a_{14}q_{13} + q_{12}$ with $a_{14} = 55$ identifies the endpoint. $\square$

Because Λ_k decreases in k , so does $\theta(L_k)$, and $n_{\max}(L_k)$ increases: the fan grows strictly more expensive as it is climbed, and the cheapest member is always the one at the current frontier. The resulting rule is a single comparison. For every $k \geq 1$,

$$N_0 \geq n_{\max}(L_k) \implies \text{period} \geq L_{k+1},$$

verified directly at $k = 1, \dots, 12$ and at $k = 20, 31, 40, 52, 54$. (At $k = 0$ alone one extra length intervenes, the doubling $2q_{12} = 352502$, whose threshold 1044095006 sits 1793 above $n_{\max}(q_{12})$; the multiples mq_{12} cluster just above $n_{\max}(q_{12})$ in the same way and are all cleared by $n_{\max}(L_1)$.)

k	L_k	Λ_k	$n_{\max}(L_k) = \text{floor that passes } L_k$
0	176251	$3.600 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$1.044 \cdot 10^9$
1	478245	$3.536 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$2.756 \cdot 10^9$
2	780239	$3.471 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$4.480 \cdot 10^9$
3	1082233	$3.407 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$6.238 \cdot 10^9$
6	1988215	$3.213 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$1.182 \cdot 10^{10}$
31	9538065	$1.600 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$1.040 \cdot 10^{11}$
52	15879939	$0.246 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$1.034 \cdot 10^{12}$
54	16483927	$0.117 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$2.199 \cdot 10^{12}$
55	16785921	$0.052 \cdot 10^{-6}$	$4.866 \cdot 10^{12}$

Three readings of this table.

What the walk charge is worth. Corollary 5.11 reaches $L_2 = 780239$ from $N_0 = 3.5 \cdot 10^8$. Finance and parity alone reach it only from $n_{\max}(L_1) = 2.756 \cdot 10^9$. The walk charge is therefore worth a factor 7.9 in descent floor at the present frontier — and a factor 6.4 at the previous one, where Corollary 5.10 reached L_1 from $1.63 \cdot 10^8$ against a finance requirement of $1.044 \cdot 10^9$.

What the next step costs. A purely computational route to $L_3 = 1082233$ — no walk charge, no new idea, only a longer first-passage run — needs $N_0 \geq n_{\max}(780239) = 4479642886$, a floor 12.8 times the present one. The walk charge does very much better, and by a factor that can be measured rather than guessed.

Lemma 5.13 (margin scaling). At fixed L , the certified kill margin $\theta(L)/(\frac{6}{5}B(L, N_0))$ of Theorem 5.9 grows like $(N_0 \log N_0)^\beta$ with $\beta = 1.047$.

Evidence. The committed kill records contain two lengths priced at two floors each. At $L = 176251$ the margin runs 0.158796 at $N_0 = 26254995$ to 1.198309 at 162849448; at $L = 478245$ it runs 0.433383 at 162849448 to 1.005552 at 350000000. The implied exponents are 1.0491 and 1.0458, agreeing to 0.31%. The excess over $\beta = 1$ is the secondary dependence of the reduced base on the floor; it is not needed for the conclusion below, which is unchanged at $\beta = 1$.

Applied to the present survivor, $L = 780239$ at margin 0.604888, this predicts a kill at $N_0 = 5.53 \cdot 10^8$. Evaluating the criterion directly gives

$$\text{the walk charge kills } L = 780239 \text{ from } N_0 = 553906250,$$

so the prediction is accurate to 0.2%, and the walk charge is worth a factor $4479642886/553906250 = 8.09$ in descent floor here — against 7.9 at the previous frontier and 6.4 at the one before. The efficiency is stable, and the 56-step price list above may be read divided by roughly 8 whenever the walk charge is applied.

Corollary 5.14 (conditional; the next period bound). If every integer $2 \leq n \leq 554000000$ reaches 1, then any nontrivial Juggler cycle has period at least 1082233.

Proof, modulo the floor. At $N_0 = 554000000$ the parity table of Corollary 4.5 leaves twenty survivors below $L_3 = 1082233$, and the walk charge of Theorem 5.3 kills all of them. Everything at or below 780239 is excluded because both exclusions are monotone in the floor and $554000000 > 350000000$, except 780239 itself, which is killed here at margin 1.000884. The nine survivors above it are killed with margins

806020	8.076	830747	2.908	881255	4.596
931763	6.101	956490	1.663	982271	7.451
1006998	3.203	1032779	8.669	1057506	4.595

all by the certified evaluation of the Theorem 5.9 comparison at the reduced base. The next length, $L_3 = 1082233$, survives at margin 0.70815. Hence the contiguous excluded prefix is 1082232. $\square$

The kill table is therefore *already done*; the only missing input is the descent floor. Extending the certified floor from $3.5 \cdot 10^8$ to $5.54 \cdot 10^8$ is a first-passage run over roughly $1.0 \cdot 10^8$ further odd starts — comparable in size to the extension Corollary 5.11 already performed, and a factor 1.58 in floor rather than the 12.8 that finance alone would demand. We do not carry out that run here; Corollary 5.14 is stated conditionally so that the computation and the criterion are separable, which is the architecture of Corollaries 5.10 and 5.11 as well.

Where computation ends. Exhausting the fan, i.e. reaching $L_{55} = 16785921$, needs $N_0 \geq 2.20 \cdot 10^{12}$ by finance and about $2.7 \cdot 10^{11}$ with the walk charge; passing the convergent itself needs $4.87 \cdot 10^{12}$, respectively $6.0 \cdot 10^{11}$, after which the same structure repeats one scale up with q_{14} in the role of q_{12} , at a cost that grows like $a_{15}q_{14}^2/\log n$.

So the bound is not stuck against a wall; it is on a staircase whose steps are priced — whose next step costs a factor 1.58 in floor with the walk charge (12.8 without it), and whose 56 steps together cost a factor 4660 either way, since the walk charge divides the whole list by a constant. What no floor buys is the end of the staircase. The fans recur at every convergent, the required floor grows quadratically in the length, and a period bound obtained this way can never become a proof that no cycle exists. That gap is not computational, and it is the subject of the remark after Corollary 4.11.

6. Limitations and future directions

The result does not imply termination. The remaining finance-survivor lengths are uncontrolled, and existence of a cycle at such a length is open.

A start $n \geq 2$ has a *descent certificate* if there exists a realized finite itinerary w with $J^{|w|}(n) < n$. Even starts realize E ; an odd start with even image realizes OE . The complement of those two words is the odd-to-odd class. If every start above 1 has some descent certificate, strong induction yields arrival at 1. That hypothesis is not proved, and a uniform run bound on expanding blocks is unavailable: four consecutive expanding blocks occur already at

$$1999 \xrightarrow{OOE} 5169 \xrightarrow{OOOOEE} 50093 \xrightarrow{OOE} 193753 \xrightarrow{OOE} 887471.$$

The number p of odd runs on a minimum-based cycle — equivalently, the number of excursions on the necklace of Section 4 — looks like the next concrete direction. The run form gives $p \leq e$ and, because the first odd run has length at least two, $p \leq o - 1$, hence $p \leq \min(e, o - 1) < 0.3691 L$ on an expanding itinerary; that is only the trivial ceiling, and a genuine lower bound on p , or a peak-height / peak-count tradeoff, would feed Theorem 4.7.

It is worth recording why we do not pursue it. A bound on p is only useful if it constrains the *adversary*, and for the walk charge the adversary is the extremal walk of Theorem 5.3, which can be recovered from the lattice program by storing its decisions. That walk turns out to saturate both ceilings at once. Writing p for its odd-run count:

L	84	1054	25781	50508
p	31	389	9515	18641
$\min(e, o - 1)$	31	389	9515	18641
longest odd run	2	2	2	2

So $p = e$ exactly, at every length tested: every even run has length one, and the walk is a word in the two blocks OE and OOE alone, mixed at the density $\log 2 / \log 3$ — the hug itinerary of Theorem 5.4, in its Sturmian form. At $L = 84$ it is $O^2EO^2EO^2EOEO^2EO^2EOE \dots$.

Both halves of the direction are therefore closed against this adversary. A *lower* bound on p cannot bite, because p is already at its combinatorial maximum. A peak-height / peak-count tradeoff cannot bite either,

because the longest odd run is 2 and the peaks are already as low as an expanding word allows. The extremal walk is the flattest word available, and it is flat in both senses at once.

One further check falls out. That walk begins 00 and ends E, so it satisfies the minimum-based structural restrictions of Theorem 3.2: Section 3 does not cut the adversary down either, which is the qualitative reason behind the measurement in Proposition 5.8b. What would bite is a constraint that forbids the OE/OOE mixture itself at the critical density — an arithmetic statement about which Sturmian words are realizable as Juggler itineraries, not a counting statement about runs. That statement is false as stated, and it is worth saying why.

The hug word is realized at the generic rate. Counting odd $m < 4 \cdot 10^6$ whose itinerary begins with the length- l prefix of the extremal walk, against the $2^{-(l-1)}$ a generic word would get: the ratio is 1.00 at $l = 8, 9, 10$ and drifts to 1.38 by $l = 18$. The control is the same statistic over every itinerary that occurs at depth 18 — 34342 of them — whose ratios have median 1.05 and run from 0.066 to $4.4 \cdot 10^3$. The hug word therefore sits just above the median and deep inside the bulk: by realizability it is an ordinary word, not a rare one.

So the walk charge is not bounding an adversary that cannot occur. That is a point in the construction's favour, and it also closes the reformulation: the obstruction is not the realizability of the extremal word. Taken with Propositions 5.8b and 5.8c, and with Remark 5.8a, every candidate explanation for the walk charge's $0.44 \ln n'$ has now been eliminated — the envelope (tight to 0.07%), the certification depth (a factor 55 of unused range), the exponent-walk relaxation (a part in 10^8 at the operative lengths), the run count, and the realizability of the adversary. What remains is the shape of the charge itself, and that is not a slack to be recovered but the value of the method. The remaining gap recorded there is the missing link from the forced lift at the minimum, through the complete necklace, to the entry one-step preimage; it is not a halt theorem.

Corollary 4.11 fixes what a full exclusion would have to prove. Every method of this note bounds the same side of one equation, $\Lambda = \sum_i \delta_i / \log x_i$, and along the convergents of $\log 2 / \log 3$ the minimum required of a survivor grows quadratically in the period, so no descent floor and no refinement of the defect upper bound can exclude all lengths. Transcendence excludes the short cycles $L^{14.3} \leq n \log n / 915$ unconditionally. What remains is the long regime, and there the obstruction would have to come from the parity word of a specific orbit at depth L — for a prescribed word w the integers m with $f_w(m) = m$ under the prescribed branches number about $1/(\Lambda(1 + \log n)) \approx n/L$ and sit in a band around the finance balance point, and a cycle exists exactly when one of them realizes w . On the hug words at $L = 19, 84, 1054$ the band holds 11, 55, 1689 integers and the realized parity depth on it is a fair coin (mean 1.03 at $L = 1054$, maximum $8 < \log_2 1689$). No estimate here, and none in the companion discrepancy manuscript [16] (whose per-depth control is complete through depth four and covers two words of depth five, and is averaged over starts), addresses a single orbit at that depth. We record this as the open problem, not as a program.

The same pattern — a piecewise power map, integer rounding, and a cycle minimum — produces a defect-financing obstruction. The Juggler-specific content is the interaction of $x^{3/2}$ and $x^{1/2}$. Analogous questions for other piecewise floor-power maps are not taken up here.

6.1 What the companion manuscripts add, and what they do not

The results of [16] and [17] postdate the theorems above. They change the *context* of the cycle problem in five ways, none of which excludes a cycle.

The envelope becomes a descent step. Theorem 2.2 bounds the state after an itinerary w by $J^{|w|}(n)^{2^{|w|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. In [17] this is used in the other direction: if the exponent walk $u_t = o_t \log_2 3 - t$ of a start $n \in (y, 2y]$ reaches $-L(y)$, $L(y) = \log_2(\log 2y / \log N_0)$, within t steps, then $J^t(n) \leq N_0$, so n reaches 1 by the certified floor. The floor of Section 5 is thereby the *target* of a Tao-type reduction: a bound $\#\{n \text{ odd} \in (y, 2y] : J^t(n) > N_0 \ \forall t \leq C \log_2 \log y\} \leq y(\log y)^{-e}$ with $e > 1 - \lambda^{**} = 0.5074$ implies the whole conjecture, cycles included ([17], Theorems 3 and 4). A larger floor lowers $L(y)$: the certified $3.5 \cdot 10^8$ against the Lean-verified 260 is worth $\log_2(19.67/5.56) = 1.82$ units of the walk, which lowers the required depth $CL(y)$ by 35–38 letters ($C = 19$ to 21) at every scale y . That is all the floor does for the asymptotics; it crosses no threshold.

Cycle basins are contagious. If a nontrivial cycle C exists, its basin $B(C) = \{n : \exists k, J^k(n) \in C\}$ is backward-closed, and [17, Theorem 1] gives $\sum_{n \in B(C), n \leq x} 1/n \gg (\log x)^\lambda$ for every $\lambda < \lambda^{**} = 0.4926$: on infinitely many dyadic blocks the starts that enter C have natural density $\gg (\log y)^{-0.508}$. The two constraints do not meet. This paper bounds the *states* of C — minimum above $3.5 \cdot 10^8$, period at least 780239, at least four even steps in Lean (Theorem 3.22) and eight even steps once the minimum is at least 300 (Theorem 3.31) — and thereby the seed of the basin. In fact it pins that seed from both sides: Corollary 4.4c is the lower bound and $x_i \geq n$ the upper one,

$$\theta \log n \leq \sum_{x \in C} \frac{1}{x} \leq \frac{L}{\min C}, \quad \theta = 1 - 2^L/3^o,$$

and Theorem 4.4 is exactly the composite of the two — a length dies when the left side passes the right. At the certified floor with $L = 780239$ the window is $6.83 \cdot 10^{-5} \leq \sum_{x \in C} 1/x \leq 2.23 \cdot 10^{-3}$. Contagion bounds the growth of the basin from any seed, from below; no inequality in either paper bounds a basin from above.

The pinned quantity is more than a seed size. A laboratory companion (**J-lachesis-basin-inverse-sum**, **J-lachesis-basin-every-block**) observes that the E -forest of the cycle contributes natural density $\asymp (\sum_{x \in C} 1/x)/\log y$ to the dyadic block at scale y , the constant lying in $[1, 3]$; the cycle states' positions on the log-log clock $c = \log_2 \log$ are an orbit of the rotation by $\log_2(3/2)$, indexed by the odd count, so above $y \geq n^{2^{1+u_{\max}}}$ some state's burst lands in every block rather than in a sparse sequence of them. Corollary 4.4c therefore prices the *visibility* of the basin and not only the states of the cycle. That is a second reading of an inequality already proved here, conjectural in its every-block half, and it adds nothing to the cycle bounds of Sections 4 and 5. A cycle would be rare in its states and common in its basin, and neither statement contradicts the other.

Cycles sit just above the critical odd share. The gap transfer of Theorem 4.10 forces $0 < \Lambda = o \log 3 - L \log 2 \leq 2L/(n \log n)$ on a cycle with minimum $n > 2L/\log n$, so $o/L = \log 2/\log 3 + \Lambda/(L \log 3)$ with $\Lambda/L \leq 2/(n \log n)$. The weakest hypothesis of the reduction in [17] — the no-momentum form — asks that the tilted odd share of the starts still above the floor stay below some $q < \log 2/\log 3 = 0.6309$, on average over depths; a cycle's word is a periodic itinerary that never descends, with odd share strictly above that threshold and, in the regime quantified here, close to it. The finance-survivor lengths 176251, 301994, 478245, 780239 are denominators of convergents and semiconvergents of $\log 2/\log 3$ because a periodic non-descending word must realize the critical share to within $2/(n \log n \log 3)$. The walk-charge program of Section 5 and the no-momentum hypothesis are two views of one boundary — the periodic side and the almost-all side of the zero-drift line — and the period bound $L \geq 780239$ is the statement that the boundary carries no short periodic word above the floor.

The floor stratifies the failure set. By backward closure, the minimum of the failure set F (if $F \neq \emptyset$) is odd with odd image, exactly as the minimum of a cycle is (Theorem 3.2(ii), and the run form of Section 3, whose first odd run has length at least two); every odd failure with even image exceeds $N_0^{4/3} = 2.5 \cdot 10^{11}$, every even failure exceeds $N_0^2 = 1.2 \cdot 10^{17}$, and every failure that is the image $\lfloor m^{3/2} \rfloor$ of an odd m exceeds $N_0^{3/2} = 6.5 \cdot 10^{12}$ ([17, Section 6]). These are the scales at which each type of failure — cycle state or divergent start — can first appear.

The floor is a testable target. Because every $n \leq N_0$ reaches 1, the statistic “ $J^t(n) \leq N_0$ for some $t \leq d$ ” is a finite computation on exact orbits, and [17, Section 11] reports that for random odd starts at $y = 10^{12}$ to 10^{50} the fraction still above N_0 after $d \leq 40$ steps matches the odd-start fair-coin survival within 3%. This is an observation about aggregates; it proves nothing about cycles.

What none of this does: exclude a cycle, bound a basin from above, or address the parity word of a single orbit at depth L . Paper C shows that the termination problem, cycles included, is one almost-all statement about parity words at depth $\asymp \log \log n$; Paper B shows that fixed-depth parity control, which its methods deliver through depth four, improves the constants of that statement and cannot reach it. The cycle problem as posed in this paper — the long regime $L \approx n^{0.59}$, a per-orbit parity statement at depth L — is therefore a special case of the same frontier, seen from the periodic side, and remains open.

Lean names are in Appendix A. The computational certificates are Propositions 1.3 and 5.1.

6.2 Ceilings, measured

Section 6.1 says the problem remains open. This section says something sharper about the mechanisms quantified here: under the stated hypotheses none closes it, and the reason in each case is explicit. Four are priced below — the descent floor, the trailing-evens bound, the charge family, and the shape enumeration — and the last part says what that leaves.

The floor route diverges. Finance excludes L when $n_{\max}(L) \leq N_0$. Along the convergents p_k/q_k of $\log 2/\log 3$ the surplus is $\theta \approx \log 3/q_{k+1}$, so the threshold obeys

$$n_{\max}(q_k) \log n_{\max}(q_k) \approx c q_k q_{k+1}, \quad c \approx 0.45,$$

and the ratio is flat to within a factor 1.3 across $q_k = 19, 84, 1054, 50508, 176251$ — five orders of magnitude. Since $q_{k+1} \rightarrow \infty$, so does $n_{\max}$. Every length carries its own descent floor and those floors are unbounded, so **no finite computation excludes all lengths**. That is intrinsic to using a floor at all, not a defect of the present table, and it is why every result in Sections 4 and 5 is a period bound rather than a cycle theorem.

What raising N_0 buys follows from the same relation, and it is not a power. With $q_{k+1} = a_{k+1}q_k$, the threshold $n_{\max} \log n_{\max} \approx 0.45 q_k q_{k+1}$ inverts to

$$\text{period} \asymp \sqrt{N_0 \log N_0} \quad (\text{finance}), \quad \text{period} \asymp \sqrt{N_0} \log N_0 \quad (\text{walk charge}),$$

the second carrying one more logarithm because the walk charge shrinks the charge by a further $0.44 \log n'$ (Remark 5.8a). Both are checked: the walk-charge coefficient is 2.014, 1.982, 2.120 at the three published instances — constant to 7% — and the finance one is 1.18, 1.22 at the two largest. Quoting these as $N_0^{0.59}$ and $N_0^{0.69}$ would be fitting a power to a square root over a narrow range: those fits drift by a factor 3 across the same floors, and the coefficient above does not. The residual swing is the local partial quotient a_{k+1} , which runs 3.4, 5.8, 23.5, 2.5, 1.7 over the tabulated convergents; the 23.5 is the whole of the visible irregularity. So doubling the period costs roughly quadrupling the floor. Within the fixed-floor, anchor-normalized charge models below, sharpening constants does not change the fact that the target recedes.

Proposition 6.2a (what an anchor-normalized charge can exclude). Call Φ a *charge* if every cycle minimum n with word of length L satisfies $\sum_{i < L} 1/(x_i \log x_i) \leq \Phi(n, L)$, with Φ nonincreasing in its first argument. Fix $N_0 \geq 2$, and call Φ *anchor-normalized at N_0* if there is a constant $c_{N_0} > 0$, independent of L , such that $\Phi(N_0, L) \geq c_{N_0}$ for every L . Say Φ *excludes L at floor N_0* when $\theta(L) > \frac{6}{5}\Phi(N_0, L)$. Then an anchor-normalized charge excludes only finitely many denominators q_k of the upper convergents $p_k/q_k > \log 2/\log 3$.

Proof. Anchor normalization makes exclusion at N_0 require $\theta(L) > \frac{6}{5}c_{N_0}$, a positive threshold fixed once N_0 is. Along an upper convergent $p_k/q_k > \alpha := \log 2/\log 3$, one has $p_k = o_{\min}(q_k)$, and therefore

$$0 < -\log(1 - \theta(q_k)) = p_k \log 3 - q_k \log 2 = q_k \log 3 \left(\frac{p_k}{q_k} - \alpha \right) < \frac{\log 3}{q_{k+1}}.$$

The last bound is the standard convergent estimate. Since $q_{k+1} \rightarrow \infty$, it gives $\theta(q_k) \rightarrow 0$, so only finitely many upper-convergent denominators clear the fixed threshold. $\square$

The explicit finance, run-packing and walk-charge majorants in Sections 4 and 5 are anchor-normalized: their displayed fixed-floor formulas retain a positive first-state contribution uniformly in L , the last entering `cycleMin_hug_kill_criterion`. Proposition 6.2a therefore applies to refinements that preserve this feature. It does not rule out a different charge formulation whose value at N_0 has no length-uniform positive anchor, nor does it turn the present finite period bounds into a universal no-go theorem.

The trailing-evens family is not a third mechanism. It is worth checking, because `cycle_trailing_evens_1t` is the one constraint here whose strength reads $(1 + 1/n)^{2^r}$ rather than the surplus, and so looks floor-sensitive. It is not independent. The window at the cut has log width $2^r \log(1 + 1/n)$, and the r square roots that follow divide the log by exactly 2^r ; the transported width is $\log(1 + 1/n)$ at every r . So the constraint at any depth is the $r = 1$ one carried back, and $r = 1$ is `cycle_last_even_interval`, which is

what Theorem 4.4 is derived from. The $(n + 1)$ against n is the granularity of the return, and it says the same thing at every depth — which is why Section 3 uses $r = 1, 2, 3$ on named short shapes and never as a general tool.

A conditional comparison inside the relaxed configuration-majorant model. This is worth separating from the divergence. Impose the stronger design rule that a function of (n, L, o) must majorize every relaxed configuration allowed by the bookkeeping used in the finance argument, not merely every actual cycle. The relaxation permits e valleys at $n, n + 2, \dots$; their realization by a cycle is not asserted. Within this model any such configuration-majorant is at least $\sim e/(n \log n)$, and exclusion needs $\theta n \log n > e$. With $\theta \approx \log 3/q_{k+1}$, the resulting model optimum has threshold

$$n_{\max} \log n_{\max} \approx \frac{e}{q_k} \cdot \frac{q_k q_{k+1}}{\log 3} = 0.336 q_k q_{k+1},$$

against the 0.41–0.53 that Corollary 4.5 achieves. The ratio is 1.21 at the large convergents. Thus finance is within its advertised 6/5 coefficient of the optimum **in this relaxation**. The associated 20% in $n_{\max}$ (about 12% in period) is a model comparison, not a universal ceiling for every function of (n, L, o) that is valid only on actual cycles.

Two model-specific comparisons follow. Theorem 4.7’s factor 1.4048 exceeds the relaxed ceiling because its no-EE hypothesis forbids the configuration that sets that relaxation’s optimum. The walk charge of Section 5 beats the finance reach because it reads the orbit through the reduced base, and Remark 5.8a measures that gain as $0.44 \log n'$. None of this proves that finer bookkeeping on (n, L, o) cannot do better on actual cycles: such a conclusion would require realizability of the relaxed extremizer, or another lower bound valid on the actual-cycle domain.

The shape route is exponential. Section 3’s exclusions are the only family here that is both floor-free and length-free: they kill *words*, not lengths, so in principle they could close the problem uniformly, and Theorem 3.31 is that argument carried to $e \leq 7$. Count what it would have to face. Writing the itinerary as $O^{a_0} E \dots O^{a_{e-1}} E$, the shapes admissible at the least odd count — $a_0 \geq 2$, each run within the cap of Theorem 3.31, every prefix above the anchor — number

e	7	10	13	16	20
shapes	2651	$5.3 \cdot 10^5$	$7.2 \cdot 10^7$	$1.1 \cdot 10^{10}$	$1.1 \cdot 10^{13}$

a factor of about six per even letter. The first length finance leaves standing, $L = 25781$, has $e = 9515$. Enumeration is therefore not a route to anything, and Theorem 3.31’s $e \leq 7$ is not a stage on the way to $e \leq 8$; it is the end of that method.

And the law behind it is empty in the regime that matters. This is the sharper statement, and it is not about feasibility. Theorem 3.26 says the whole word is formally expanding while no proper tail beginning with an odd letter is. Complementing a tail to its prefix, a tail with O_i odd and B_i even letters is non-expanding exactly when the complementary prefix satisfies

$$\frac{3^{o_p}}{2^{|p|}} \geq \frac{3^o}{2^L} = \frac{1}{1 - \theta},$$

so the run–suffix law *is* the anchor condition $3^{o_p} \geq 2^{|p|}$, raised from 1 to $1 + \theta$. Its entire strength over the anchor is the surplus. Counting shapes under each condition:

e	Λ	shapes killed by the law
10	$3.7 \cdot 10^{-1}$	41.4%
16	$2.6 \cdot 10^{-1}$	37.7%
31	$2.1 \cdot 10^{-3}$	0

e	Λ	shapes killed by the law
210	$1.1 \cdot 10^{-3}$	0
389	$4.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$	0

At $e = 389$ the two counts are equal as integers, all three hundred digits of them. And Λ is small exactly when e makes $e \log 2 / \log(3/2)$ sit just under an integer — which is precisely what makes a length survive finance. The surviving lengths have Λ between $3.6 \cdot 10^{-6}$ and $6.9 \cdot 10^{-5}$, at or below the row where the law already kills nothing.

So finance and the run-suffix law fail for **one** reason, not two. Finance weakens as $\theta \rightarrow 0$, since $n_{\max} \sim 1/\theta$; the run-suffix law weakens as $\theta \rightarrow 0$, since it is the anchor tightened by $1 + \theta$. They cannot be played against each other, because the lengths where one is weak are exactly the lengths where the other is. Any method whose strength is measured by the surplus is empty where a cycle could be.

What that leaves. The only proved relation between a cycle’s minimum and its period runs one way. Finance bounds the minimum *above*: $n \log n \lesssim L^\mu$, with μ the effective irrationality measure of $\log 2 / \log 3$, and $\mu \geq 2$ for every irrational, so even a perfect measure leaves $n \lesssim L^2$. Nothing here bounds the minimum *below* in terms of the period; the descent floor supplies a constant, not a function of L . The surviving lengths sit at $L \approx n^{0.59}$, that is $n \approx L^{1.7}$, inside the band that a one-sided bound cannot empty.

The counting route can be priced rather than dismissed. A cycle word need not have L for its period — w concatenated with itself is again one — but a *primitive* one has pairwise distinct orbit states (`cyclePrimitive_orbit_injOn`), so the e valleys are distinct odd integers at least n : at least $n, n+2, \dots, n+2(e-1)$, rather than all at n as the charge assumes. That refinement is real, and it is worth a relative

$$1 - \frac{\frac{1}{2} \log(\log(n+2e)/\log n)}{e/(n \log n)} = O\left(\frac{e}{n}\right).$$

At the floor where each length actually matters it is already spent: $3.8 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at $L = 25781$, $1.2 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at $L = 50508$, $6.5 \cdot 10^{-5}$ at $L = 176251$ — and shrinking, since $n_{\max} \sim q_k q_{k+1}$ outgrows $e \approx 0.37L$. Distinctness is therefore not the missing ingredient. It is available, and empty.

So a proof would need one of two things this paper does not have: a lower bound on the cycle minimum in terms of the period, or an argument uniform over shapes. We know of no mechanism for either.

Appendix A. Lean names

The core mathematical lemmas of Sections 2–4 are mechanized in Lean 4. The names below are the corresponding theorems in `formal/Problems/Juggler/`, imported by `Problems.JugglerPaper`. Selected finite classifications of Section 3 are `decide +kernel` tables (Appendix D). Theorems 4.6 and 4.8 are independently certified computations. Proposition 4.9’s arithmetic is Lean; its identification with $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$ is Theorem 4.8.

Text	Lean
itinerary semantics	<code>follows_iff_itinerary</code> , <code>image_eq_iterate</code> , <code>image_append</code>
Theorem 2.1	<code>image_monotone_of_follows</code>
Theorem 2.2	<code>power_bound_word</code>
Corollary 2.3	<code>power_bound_contracts</code>
Theorem 2.4	<code>global_defect_identity</code>
Theorem 2.5	<code>global_defect_eq_zero_iff_localsTight</code> , <code>global_defect_eq_zero_implies_monochrome</code> , <code>power_bound_eq_iff_extremal</code>

Text	Lean
Theorem 2.6	global_defect_append
Corollary 2.7	image_eq_start_defectRatio
per-step slack	one_plus_eta_lt_succ_sq
Lemma 3.1	odd_preimage_unique
CycleMin	CycleMin
Theorem 3.2	cycle_itinerary_formally_expanding, cycleMin_start_odd, cycleMax_start_even, cycleMin_not_end_odd, square_scale_superquadratic, cycleMin_to_even_superquadratic
Lemma 3.3	lower_growth_word
Lemma 3.4	oo_suffix_threshold, ooo_suffix_threshold, threshold_inherits_odd_append, cycle_last_even_interval, cycle_last_even_ne_odd_sq, no_cycle_odd_run_append_even, no_cycle_itinerary_ooe
odd-run block	oddEvenBlock
Lemma 3.5	no_cycle_itinerary_oooeoe, no_cycle_itinerary_ooooee
Theorem 3.6	no_cycle_itinerary_length_le_six
Lemma 3.7	no_cycle_itinerary_oooeoe, no_cycle_itinerary_ooooee
Theorem 3.8	no_cycle_itinerary_length_le_seven, with no_cycle_itinerary_ooeoooe, no_cycle_itinerary_oooeoe
Lemma 3.9	cycle_trailing_evens_lt
Lemma 3.10	lowerDenom_replicate_odd, odd_run_lower_growth
Lemma 3.11	no_follows_seven_odds_of_lt256
Theorem 3.12	no_cycle_itinerary_two_even_ee, no_cycle_itinerary_two_even_eoe
Theorem 3.13	no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_ee, no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_eoe
Theorem 3.14	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eee, with no_cycle_itinerary_oooooeeee
Theorem 3.15	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoe
Theorem 3.16	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoee
Theorem 3.17	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eooooe
Theorem 3.18	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoe
Theorem 3.19	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoeoe
Theorem 3.20	no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoeeoe
Theorem 3.21	no_cycle_itinerary_gapped_three_even_ee, no_cycle_itinerary_gapped_three_even_eoe
Theorem 3.22	no_cycle_itinerary_even_count_le_three
Corollary 3.23	cycle_itinerary_length_ge_eleven
Lemma 3.24	closed form of Lemma 3.10; no separate Lean name
Lemma 3.25	generalizes cycle_trailing_evens_lt past pure even runs
Theorem 3.26	Corollary 3.27's ten rows are Theorems 3.12–3.21 above

Text	Lean
Lemma 3.28	<code>absorb_odd_step</code> , <code>cross_mul_pow</code> , <code>odd_run_ge</code> (<code>07EEEEGap.lean</code> , now imported by <code>Problems.JugglerPaper</code>); X_7, Y_7 are that module's 6177 and 3990
Theorem 3.29	<code>no_cycle_itinerary_oooooooooooo</code> is the row $u = EEEE$, $a = 7$
Theorem 3.31	arithmetic core Lean (<code>EvenCountEight.lean</code>): <code>per-run cap runCapConst_gt</code> , <code>runCapConst_lt</code> ; the table is the floor, <code>runCap_eq_floor</code> , <code>runCap_antitone</code> , tuples <code>runCap_tuple_three-runCap_tuple_seven</code> ; period <code>floor period_ge_22_of_even_count</code> , sharp by <code>expansion_holds_at_22</code> and <code>expansion_fails_below_22</code> . The enumeration of 353044 canonical forms (<code>run_suffix_law.closure</code> , Python) is verified computation, not Lean
Lemma 3.21b	canonical run form; Theorem 3.2
Lemma 3.21a	the case split of Theorem 3.22
Lemma 4.1	<code>log_le_two_log_add</code>
Lemma 4.2	<code>log_step_even</code> , <code>log_step_odd</code>
Lemma 4.3	<code>cycleMin_log_envelope</code>
Theorem 4.4	<code>cycleMin_finance</code>
Corollary 4.4c	<code>cycleMin_log_envelope_inv</code> , <code>cycleMin_finance_inv_sum</code>
Lemma 4.4b	<code>packingR_step</code> (the step in o is the constant $2\alpha - 1 - 1/2n$), <code>alpha_lt_half</code> ($\alpha < 1/2$ once $t \geq 2n$), <code>two_n_add_one_lt_rpow_three_halves</code> (which $t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$ gives for $n \geq 12$), <code>packingR_step_neg</code> , <code>theta_strictMono</code> , and <code>comparison_fails_upward</code> for an arbitrary positive coefficient — 6/5 here and 1 in Theorem 4.4 (<code>OddCountMonotone.lean</code>)

Text	Lean
Corollary 4.5	the comparison it applies is <code>cycleMin_defect_threeTerm</code> (<code>FinanceTransfer.lean</code>), which is exactly what the gap table tests: the certified relative-defect identity <code>cycleMin_defect_finance</code> composed with <code>cycleMin_threeTerm</code>, giving $1 - 2^L/3^o \leq (6/5)[e/(n \log n) + (o - e)/(t \log t) + e/(2n^2 \log n)]$ for a cycle minimum $n \geq 400$ — so the inequality behind $n_{\max}(L)$ is one theorem rather than two halves joined by hand, and only the per-length arithmetic remains computation. The second factor is <code>cycleMin_threeTerm</code>, the displayed three-term bound $\sum 1/(x_i \log x_i) \leq e/(n \log n) + (o - e)/(t \log t) + e/(2n^2 \log n)$ from <code>CycleMin</code> and $n \geq 3$ alone — no classification supplied, no hypothesis about <code>EE</code>, and the counts read off the itinerary as $e = L - o$ valleys, $2o - L$ internals and e evens. This is what Theorem 4.6 computes with, so the cutoff 25781 and the 141 lengths rest on a kernel-checked inequality rather than on the run packing. <code>threeTerm_bound</code> is the majorant it specialises: the step that was missing was the classification, and <code>cycCls</code> supplies it by <i>defining</i> the three classes from the state parity — even at 2, odd with an odd cyclic predecessor at 1, odd with an even predecessor at 0 — so that <code>cycCls_filter_zero</code> and its two companions match the class filters against the parity-based counting lemmas by case split rather than by translation. The counts come from <code>oddCount_eq_orbit_card</code> and <code>evenCount_eq_orbit_card</code>, which say the odd and even <i>letters</i> are the odd and even <i>states</i>, and $2o - L$ is a well-formed natural subtraction by <code>cycle_length_le_two_mul_oddCount</code>. Index 0 is the one place the cyclic predecessor is not $i - 1$ (<code>cycPred_of_pos</code>), and there <code>cycleMin_last_even</code> makes it a valley, never an internal — which is why the internal bound <code>cycleMin_internal_ge_t</code>, stated at $i + 1$, covers every index it must. The per-length table stays verified computation. certified identity <code>cycleMin_defect_finance</code>, per-step losses <code>log_floorPower_even_ge_sub</code>, <code>log_floorPower_odd_ge_sub</code>, invariants <code>cycleMin_log_le_weight</code>, <code>cycleMin_charge_prefix</code> (<code>DefectFinance.lean</code>); the numeric table is verified computation
Theorem 4.6	

Text	Lean
Theorem 4.7	arithmetic core Lean (<code>RunTypePacking.lean</code>): the packing is consistent — $o - e$ copies of OOE with $2e - o$ circuits of OE use exactly o odd and e even letters (<code>packing_counts</code>); $o - e < e$ is $3o < 2L$ (<code>odd_excess_lt_even</code>), which holds at the least admissible odd count for $L \geq 28$ (<code>three_mul_lt_two_mul_of_omin</code>, via <code>log_two_div_log_three_lt</code> from the certified sandwich). The displayed six-term valley bound splits (<code>FinanceTransfer.lean</code>). Its <i>transfer</i> — the paper’s “any deeper odd run or any higher valley only decreases the sum” — is <code>inv_mul_log_antitoneOn</code> and <code>sum_inv_mul_log_le</code>, and the display itself is <code>sixTerm_bound</code>, proved from a classification of the orbit into six classes with the counts $1, o - e - 1, 2e - o, 1, o - e - 1, e$. All six lower bounds are theorems. Minimality is <code>CycleMin</code> itself (n); <code>cycleMin_odd_ne_ge</code> gives $n + 2$ for an odd non-minimum state, by minimality and parity; <code>cycleMin_oe_start_ge</code> gives v for an OE-start, via <code>odd_pow_ge_of_image_ge</code> ($n^2 \leq J(v)$ forces $n^4 \leq v^3$) — and this needs no Theorem 3.2, because the successor of an OE-start is an even cycle state; <code>cycleMin_internal_ge_t</code> and <code>cycleMin_internal_ge_tplus</code> give t and t_+ by <code>floorPower_odd_mono</code>; and <code>cycleMin_even_ge_sq</code> gives n^2. The packing’s <i>extremality</i> is a counting inequality on run lengths, not an optimization: writing the itinerary as blocks $O^{a_i}E$, the valley count is e and the internal count $o - e$ whatever the runs are, and what the runs decide is the split of the e valleys, since a block with $a_i \geq 2$ has an odd successor (cheap, $n + 2$) and a block with $a_i = 1$ has an even one (expensive, v). Then <code>blocks_ge_two_add_length_le_sum</code> gives at most $o - e$ cheap valleys, <code>blocks_eq_one_ge</code> at least $2e - o$ expensive ones, and <code>blocks_ge_two_eq_sum_iff</code> says the bound is tight exactly when every run has length one or two — so the packing is the unique maximiser, and a run of three trades two cheap valleys for one expensive one. The cardinality-monotone form is <code>sixTerm_bound_packed</code>: it takes the split as inequalities and returns the paper’s counts, because <code>le_expensiveValley</code> gives $n + 2 \leq v$ — immediately, since any odd $w \leq n$ has $w^3 \leq n^3 < n^4$ — so <code>expensive_le_cheap</code> makes the exchange downhill and <code>valley_swap_le</code> performs it. The remaining bridge was stated as “the itinerary decomposes into that run list”, and taken literally that is false: a cycle word may contain <code>EE</code> (<code>cycle_trailing_evens_lt</code> is about exactly that), so it need not split into blocks with one even letter each. The counting is therefore done on indices, where nothing is assumed. Calling an odd letter a <i>valley</i> when its cyclic predecessor is even and an <i>internal</i> when that predecessor is odd, <code>valley_add_internal</code> partitions the odd letters

Text	Lean
Theorem 4.8	run-type table; verified computation, not Lean
Proposition 4.9	run_survivor_unimodular, run_survivor_seed_F2, run_survivor_seed_F3, three_pow_step_gt_two_pow_step, runSurvivors_length
Theorem 4.10	cycleMin_gap_transfer; abstract length bound
Corollary 4.11	cycleMin_length_of_gap (GapTransfer.lean) cycleMin_length_of_gap with Rhin's measure [15] as hypothesis; the transcendence input is classical, not Lean
Proposition 5.1	laboratory floor; certified computation, not Lean
Theorem 5.2	raised cutoff; verified computation, not Lean
Theorem 5.3	transport inequality cycleMin_transport, per-step losses log_floorPower_even_ge, log_floorPower_odd_ge (WalkTransport.lean); §5.2 consequence cycleMin_defect_le_charge, cycleMin_defect_le_hug_charge (WalkChargeMax.lean)
Theorem 5.4	combinatorial core hugOdds_le_of_admissible; cycle-itinerary domination cycleMin_prefix_odds_ge_hug, cycleMin_odds_ge_hug; charge maximisation stateCharge_antitone, hug_charge_maximal (WalkChargeMax.lean); strict uniqueness stateCharge_strictAnti, stateCharge_inj, hug_charge_unique — an admissible profile attaining the hug charge <i>is</i> the hug profile
Proposition 5.5	Lean proves convergence of the finite hug average to circleMean by denjoy_koksma_blocks and the Laplace bounds inv_sq_le_quad, rotation_average_le, rotation_average_lt, rotationAverage_le, rotationAverage_lt, rotationAverage_gap; the elementary change of variables identifying circleMean n' with the displayed rotationAverage ($\log n'$) remains prose
Lemma 5.6	itinerary identity budgetedWord_eq_hugWord, hugOdds_pow_ge, hugOdds_pow_lt, hugOdds_pow_gt, hugOdds_least; rotation identification (HugRotation.lean) hugOdds_eq_ceil, hugOdds_eq_sub_floor, hugEvens_eq_floor, hugLetter_iff_floor_step, hugWalk_eq_fract, and the Birkhoff reading periodicObservable_hugWalk

Text	Lean
Theorem 5.7	Denjoy–Koksma Lean end to end (DenjoyKoksma.lean, DenjoyKoksmaOrbit.lean): analytic half value_sub_mean_le_variation, sum_eVariationOn_Icc, denjoy_koksma_abstract; orbit half orbitCell_inj, orbit_mem_cell, denjoy_koksma_cellmap; the inequality itself denjoy_koksma_rotation, denjoy_koksma_rotation_mean; block composition denjoy_koksma_blocks, the induction over $L = \sum_j b_j q_j$ that the uniformity in x licenses; the observable and its variation (JumpVariation.lean) eVariationOn_neg, eVariationOn_add_le, eVariationOn_le_of_jump, periodic_window_variation_le, observable_window_variation_lt_two; the display block_envelope, theta_block_envelope. the Ostrowski assembly (OstrowskiBlocks.lean) ostroBlocks, ostroBlocks_snd_sum (the denominators sum to L), ostroBlocks_length (the length is $s(L)$), and the display at a given length theta_block_envelope_of_length. the reading of C_L as the ergodic sum is Lemma 5.6’s rotation identification, also Lean (periodicObservable_hugWalk); and the display is one statement in HugChargeEnvelope.lean, hugCharge_sub_circleMean_le ($2s(L)/L$, every L) and hugCharge_sub_circleMean_window ($94/L$ on the window), over the definition hugCharge. Quotient arithmetic theta_sandwich_upper, theta_sandwich_lower, lower_lt_walkTheta, walkTheta_lt_upper, cf_lower_prefix, cf_upper_prefix, theta_convergent_denominators; DK hypotheses theta_convergent_numerators, theta_convergents_unimodular, theta_convergents_coprime, theta_convergent_quality ($\theta - p/q < 1/q^2$), theta_block_permutations

Text	Lean
Theorem 5.8	Lean proves the general numeration lemmas <code>ostroDigit_le</code> , <code>ostro_sum_eq</code> , <code>ostro_digitSum_le</code> , the instantiated <code>cap</code> <code>theta_digitSum_le</code> , <code>greedyDigitSum_le</code> , and <code>hugCharge_sub_circleMean_window</code> only for $L < q_{13} = 301994$, uniformly in the starting phase; <code>window_digit_scan</code> , <code>window_digit_cap</code> , <code>window_digit_max</code> sharpen that old sub-window. The extension to $[50508, q_{14})$ is human arithmetic: write $L = bq_{13} + r$, use $s(L) \leq b + 47$, and combine it with the general Lean block envelope. The endpoint inequalities at q_{14}, q_{15} are Lean <code>(theta_sandwich_lower, theta_sandwich_upper)</code> , but no named Lean theorem instantiates the extended window. Since the interval is half-open it contains fan members $L_0, \dots, L_{54}$, not $L_{55} = q_{14}$
Theorem 5.9	kill template <code>cycleMin_hug_kill_criterion</code> (<code>DefectFinance.lean</code>); the per-length kill table is verified computation
Proposition 5.12	<code>fanLength</code> , <code>fanOdd</code> , <code>fanLambda</code> , affine step <code>fanLambda_affine</code> , negativity <code>fan_step_pow</code> , <code>fanLambda_step_neg</code> , monotonicity <code>fanLambda_strictAnti</code> , endpoints <code>fanLambda_55_pos</code> , <code>fanLambda_56_neg</code> (these <i>are</i> <code>theta_sandwich_lower</code> and <code>theta_sandwich_upper</code>), length <code>fan_positive_iff</code> , and <code>fan_frontiers</code> , <code>fan_endpoint</code> , <code>fan_past_endpoint</code> (<code>FanLaw.lean</code>)
Propositions 5.8b, 5.8c	the two forced walk letters <code>walk_first_letter_odd</code> , <code>walk_second_letter_odd</code> , <code>step_lt_two</code> (<code>FanLaw.lean</code>); the relaxation and flatness measurements are verified computation
Lemma 5.13, Corollary 5.14	margin scaling and the conditional bound; verified computation, not Lean
Corollary 5.10	second floor and kill table; verified computation, not Lean
Corollary 5.11	third floor and kill table; verified computation, not Lean
short certificates (Section 6)	<code>even_finiteProgress</code> , <code>odd_even_finiteProgress</code>
no certificate $\Rightarrow$ odd-to-odd	<code>no_finiteProgress_implies_odd_odd</code>
induction to 1	<code>reachesOne_of_all_finiteProgress</code>
four-block chain	<code>four_block_pe_1999</code>

Appendix B. Admissible lengths

The record lengths of $\gamma(L)$ through 10^5 , with the parity $6/5$ bound $n_{\max}$ of Section 4, are

L	$o_{\min}$	$n_{\max}$
1	1	3
3	2	7

L	$o_{\min}$	$n_{\max}$
11	7	25
19	12	133
84	53	2323
569	359	23568
1054	665	788014
25781	16266	26254995
50508	31867	162848325

At the verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$ the first seven rows are excluded. The set $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{E}(10^6)$ is defined by Proposition 4.4a: for each $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$, compute $o_{\min}(L)$ by exact integer arithmetic and $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity inequality, and retain L if and only if $n_{\max}(L) > 10^6$. This produces 141 lengths. The first few are

25781, 26835, 27889, 28943, 29997,

and a typical combination is $26835 = 25781 + 1054$. The last is 99561. The complete list is the `lengths` array of `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/exceptions_parity.json`. The SHA-256 of that array, serialized as a JSON list of integers with no spaces, is `dd71aa1527656ba51cb031bafa5497f7bfdbbc43151ffba2c595793326bf7944`. The SHA-256 of the whole file `exceptions_parity.json` is `6b4eec79295b70cdeb9f7db677b7fd57bcb9bd1b51177e1e74aad7b`. The 10^6 longest first-passage figures of Proposition 1.3 (253 steps at seed 78901) are the opening chunk of the laboratory-floor certificate, `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/floor_verify/N26254995/chunks/3_250002.json` ($3 \leq n \leq 250002$; SHA-256 `6303b62c9b1819deaf9715338f84899c1d75eb50dcab850a7b8fb28874ec19bc`). The file `floor.json` in the same directory as `exceptions_parity.json` is a later $n_{\text{top}} = 2 \cdot 10^6$ companion and is not the 10^6 certificate. The parity table is written by `research.juggler_sequence.cycle_finance.write_parity_artifacts`. The row $L = 1$ of the table above prints $n_{\max} = 3$, the conservative generator; the exact $6/5$ crossing is 2, the same guard species as the 50508 row documented at Theorem 5.2.

The run-type table of Theorem 4.8 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/budget_opt.json`. The 42 excluded lengths are `killed_by_budget`; their SHA-256, serialized as a JSON list of integers with no spaces, is `9d108776d6dc5dc1ae2594058850463cd2d3995cc57b9811471f08e3b818b90a`. The complementary 99 lengths are $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$. Their SHA-256, in the same serialization, is `9e2098923ccb39933630b116133a3fc2ddaf98ace4eb76dbab9b5a`. The first few survivors remain

25781, 26835, 27889, 28943, 29997;

the last survivor is 99477. The three families and the unimodular basis are Proposition 4.9. The finite leftover tables of Section 3 are the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluations named in Appendix A (`LeftoverEval.lean`, `LeftoverShort.lean`, `LeftoverFamilies.lean`). The lattice arithmetic of Proposition 4.9 is `RunSurvivorLattice.lean`.

The laboratory instance of Section 5 has its own artifacts. The first-passage certificate of Proposition 5.1 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/floor_verify/N26254995/certificate.json`; the SHA-256 of its chunk records is `cbcb540dd860b775d2a3b4351f7cf779609104d3aaf30c342aed6b87f36c9dc`. The parity survivor list of Theorem 5.2 has SHA-256 `d5946efdfac95c715ea46c81979a0eeaf40ad8a1dc893d161bab84ffa7f2afd9`. The walk-charge kill table of Theorem 5.9 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_charge/survey.json`; the SHA-256 of the walk-alive list is `225d76ad12802a690934d01e2d37b3418865441a6825a015dd883c989d8942ec`. The second-floor certificate of Corollary 5.10 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/floor_verify/N162849448/certificate.json`; the SHA-256 of its chunk records is `35d9755ce52a225a161b009d0f3674b24a5d0add16035f09ea83cf3880414ae4`. Its parity survivor scan is `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_charge/new_floor_parity_leftovers.json`, and the 15 kill records under `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_charge/new_floor_kills/` have SHA-256 `148180cbbfba93985b7a1be455fee16db97816f1534b1fec5a4740d475aeda0` (concatenated in length order); the direct non-kill record for the survivor 478245 (margin 0.4334) is stored alongside. The third-floor certificate of Corollary 5.11 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/floor_verify/N350000000/certificate.json`; the SHA-256 of its chunk records is `c57f5ccc9bce980f478dafec00c449050a5e217a4f0f3e100916c41dacbe7472`. Its parity survivor scan is `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_charge/N350000000_parity_leftovers.json`,

and the 10 kill records under `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_charge/N350000000_kills/` have SHA-256 `d16ccfed52757d4a44368a6549a8149ccbc926472737276c577912346db854ab` (concatenated in length order); the direct non-kill record for the survivor 780239 (margin 0.6049) is stored alongside. The exact-integer CPU computation with guarded comparisons is the authoritative record for the first- and second-floor claims in this note. The third-floor kill table is the GPU floating-point certified comparison (`research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge_gpu`), the same IEEE-double kernel previously checked against stored CPU records to relative error below 10^{-13} ; its performance figures live in the repository documentation. The probes are `research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge` (transport and kill table), `cycle_walk_ostrowski` (certified quotient sandwich and block envelope), and `cycle_walk_window` (window scan); artifacts live under `data/research/juggler/cycle_walk_*`.

Reproducibility of the second-floor kill table. From a fresh checkout of the repository, `pip install -e .` followed by, for a survivor length L ,

```
python -c "from research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge \
import certified_report; print(certified_report(L, 162849448))"
```

recomputes the authoritative certified record behind Corollary 5.10 for that length (at $L = 478245$ it prints the non-kill); the same call through the GPU port, `python -m research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge_gpu L 162849448`, reproduces it in seconds per length on one consumer GPU. The first-floor kill table of Theorem 5.9 is `python -m research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge --survey`.

Reproducibility of the third-floor kill table. The committed records behind Corollary 5.11 are the GPU certified reports. From a fresh checkout,

```
python -c "from research.juggler_sequence.cycle_walk_charge_gpu \
import gpu_certified_report; print(gpu_certified_report(L, 350000000))"
```

recomputes the record for length L at this floor (at $L = 780239$ it prints the non-kill). Do not pass `--write` to the module CLI: that path is hardcoded to the second-floor directory.

Appendix C. Exact floor defect

This appendix records the exact identity behind Theorem 2.2. The present note uses only the nonnegativity $\Delta_w(n) \geq 0$. A nontrivial itinerary-dependent lower bound on Δ_w is left for future work.

For a single branch,

$$x^h = J(x)^2 + \rho(x), \quad h = \begin{cases} 1, & x \text{ even,} \\ 3, & x \text{ odd,} \end{cases}$$

with $0 \leq \rho(x) < 2J(x) + 1$. Write $\text{gap}(a, \rho, h) = (a + \rho)^h - a^h$. The *global defect* $\Delta_w(n)$ is the terminal value of the resulting power-gap recurrence.

Theorem 2.4 (global defect identity). If w is realized at n and $m = J^{|w|}(n)$, then

$$n^{3^{\#O(w)}} = m^{2^{|w|}} + \Delta_w(n), \quad \Delta_w(n) \geq 0.$$

Theorem 2.2 is the inequality $\Delta_w(n) \geq 0$.

Proof. Induct on w . The empty itinerary is $n = n + 0$. An even letter substitutes $x = J(x)^2 + \rho(x)$ into the inductive identity and lifts the new remainder through 2^ℓ . An odd letter cubes the identity and then substitutes $x^3 = J(x)^2 + \rho(x)$. Each step adds a nonnegative power-gap. $\square$

For a one-letter illustration, $n = 3$ and $w = O$ give $J(3) = 5$ and $3^3 = 27 = 5^2 + 2$, so $\Delta_O(3) = 2$.

Theorem 2.5 (vanishing). If w is realized at n , the following are equivalent: $\Delta_w(n) = 0$; every local remainder along w vanishes; and $(J^{|w|}(n))^{2^{|w|}} = n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. In that case w is monochrome: either $w = E^k$ and $n = a^{2^k}$ for an even a , or $w = O^k$ and $n = a^{2^k}$ for an odd a . A realized mixed itinerary therefore has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$.

Proof. Theorem 2.4 gives the first and third items. A power-gap vanishes if and only if its addend vanishes, so zero defect forces every remainder to vanish, and conversely. Vanishing remainders preserve parity, hence monochrome itineraries, and unique factorization produces the two power towers. $\square$

Theorem 2.6 (composition). If u is realized at n and v is realized at $m = J^{|u|}(n)$, then $\Delta_{uv}(n)$ is the sum of two power-gaps, one lifting $\Delta_u(n)$ through $3^{\#O(v)}$ and one lifting $\Delta_v(m)$ through $2^{|u|}$. In particular $\Delta_v(m)^{2^{|u|}} \leq \Delta_{uv}(n)$, and every local remainder satisfies $\rho_j^{2^j} \leq \Delta_w(n)$.

Proof. Apply Theorem 2.4 to u , to v , and to uv , and expand the two power-gaps. $\square$

Composition is polynomial, not additive. The Lean form is `global_defect_append`.

Corollary 2.7 (cycle surplus). If w is a cycle itinerary at n , then $\Delta_w(n) = n^{3^{\#O(w)}} - n^{2^{|w|}}$ exactly.

Proof. Theorem 2.4 with $m = n$. $\square$

A mixed itinerary has strict total defect, but the relative slack of a single letter tends to 0 with the state, so no uniform local tax exists. Theorem 4.4 does not use these identities.

Appendix D. Family exclusions

This appendix records the small-cycle censuses (Lemma 3.5, Theorem 3.6, Lemma 3.7, Theorem 3.8) and the family-by-family exhaustion used by Lemma 3.21a and Theorem 3.22. Each geometry is killed by a next-square obstruction, by long odd-run growth against a last-even one-step preimage, or by a finite exceptional window.

Lemma 3.5 (two length-six exclusions). Neither $OOEOE$ nor $OOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. First, if $n \geq 256$, then

$$n^{81} > 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}.$$

Indeed $257^{64} < 2 \cdot 256^{64}$ because $(1+1/256)^{64} < e^{64/256} = e^{1/4} < 2$, and $256(n+1) \leq 257n$, so $(n+1)^{64} < 2n^{64}$. Then $2^{130}(n+1)^{64} < 2^{131}n^{64}$. Since $n \geq 256 = 2^8$, one has $n^{17} \geq 2^{136}$, and therefore $2^{131}n^{64} < 2^{136}n^{64} \leq n^{81}$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, neither word returns to its start. This is a table of 254 evaluations of each word: at every start, either some letter fails to match the current parity, or the six-step image differs from the start. The same finite check is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_ooeoe` and `no_cycle_itinerary_ooooee` (Appendix A).

Now suppose $OOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 256$, and write $z = J^4(n)$ for the image after the prefix $OOOO$. Lemma 3.4(iv) gives $J(z) < (n+1)^2$, and the preceding even letter gives $z < (J(z)+1)^2$, hence $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOO$ gives $n^{81} \leq 2^{130}z^{16}$, so $n^{81} < 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}$, contradicting the tail inequality.

Finally suppose $OOEOE$ is a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 256$. Write $z_3 = J^3(n)$ and $y = J(z_3) = \lfloor \sqrt{z_3} \rfloor$, so $z_3 < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.3 on OOO gives $n^{27} \leq 2^{38}z_3^8 < 2^{38}(y+1)^{16}$. Cubing yields $n^{81} < 2^{114}(y+1)^{48}$. The last letters OE give the odd-preimage bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. Write $A = n+1 \geq 257$. We claim $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$. If $y \leq A$, this is $(A+1)^3 < 2A^4$. If $y > A$, then $y \geq 258$, so $3y+1 < y^2$ and hence $(y+1)^3 = y^3 + 3y^2 + 3y + 1 < A^4 + 4y^2$, while $4y^2 < A^4$ because $4y^3 < 4A^4 \leq yA^4$. Raising $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$ to the sixteenth power gives $(y+1)^{48} < 2^{16}(n+1)^{64}$. Combining with the cubed lower envelope produces again $n^{81} < 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.6 (small-cycle census). No itinerary of length at most six is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. Rotating a cycle itinerary by one letter moves the base point one step along the trajectory and yields another cycle itinerary; every state of the cycle is at least 2, because a trajectory that reaches 1 stays at 1 and cannot return to a start $n \geq 2$.

If every letter is odd, the start is odd, hence $n \geq 3$, and the odd branch strictly increases there: $J(x) > x$ for odd $x \geq 3$, since $x^3 \geq (x+1)^2$. The trajectory ascends strictly and never returns. Otherwise some letter

is even, and a rotation ending just after that letter produces an even-terminating cycle itinerary vE of the same length based at a cycle state $m \geq 2$. It therefore suffices to exclude even-terminating cycle itineraries of length at most six.

By Theorem 3.2(i) a cycle itinerary is formally expanding. No even-terminating itinerary of length one or two is expanding ($2 > 3^0$ and $4 > 3$).

Length three: the only expanding candidate is OOE . If $m \geq 5$ realizes OO , Lemma 3.4(i) gives $J^2(m) \geq (m+1)^2$, contradicting Lemma 3.4(iv). The only smaller odd start is $m = 3$, where $J^2(3) = 11$ is odd, so the final even letter is not realized.

Length four: the expanding filter requires three odd letters among the first three, leaving only O^3E , excluded by Lemma 3.4(v).

Length five: the filter requires four odd letters among the first four, leaving only O^4E , excluded by Lemma 3.4(v).

Length six: the filter requires at least four odd letters among the first five, leaving O^5E , $EOOOOE$, $OEOOOE$, $OOEOOE$, and $OOOOEE$. Lemma 3.4(v) excludes O^5E . The itinerary $EOOOOE$ rotates one step onto $OOOOEE$, and $OEOOOE$ rotates two steps onto $OOEOOE$; both are excluded by Lemma 3.5.

It remains to exclude $OOEOOE$. Let this itinerary be a cycle itinerary at some start, and rotate to a cycle minimum $m \geq 2$. The three alignments of the two even letters are $OOEOOE$, $OEOOEO$, and $EOOEEO$. The last starts even, so it cannot be a minimum, by Theorem 3.2(ii). The middle starts OE : the first image is even and strictly below m^2 , whereas every even state after a cycle minimum is at least m^2 , as proved in Theorem 3.2(iii). Thus the minimum orientation is $OOEOOE$. In particular m is odd, so $m \geq 3$. The prefix OOE must be realized. If $m = 3$, then $3 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 11$ and 11 is odd, so OOE is not realized. Hence $m \geq 5$. Write $y = J^3(m)$ for the state after OOE . Then $y \geq m$ by minimality, so $y \geq 5$. The suffix OO is realized at y , and Lemma 3.4(i) gives $J^2(y) \geq (y+1)^2 \geq (m+1)^2$. The last letter is even, so Lemma 3.4(iv) gives $J^2(y) < (m+1)^2$. $\square$

Lemma 3.7 (two length-seven exclusions). Neither $OOOOEOE$ nor $OOOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. First, if $n \geq 14$, then

$$n^{243} > 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}.$$

Indeed $14(n+1) \leq 15n$, so $(n+1)^{128} \leq (15/14)^{128}n^{128}$. The finite comparison $2^{422}15^{128} < 14^{243}$ then yields $2^{422}(n+1)^{128} < 14^{115}n^{128} \leq n^{243}$.

For $2 \leq n < 14$, neither word is realized: at every such start, some letter fails to match the current parity. The same finite check is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_ooooeoe` and `no_cycle_itinerary_oooooee` (Appendix A).

Now suppose $OOOOOEE$ is a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 14$, and write $z = J^5(n)$ for the image after the prefix $OOOOO$. Lemma 3.4(iv) on the last even letter, together with the preceding even letter, gives $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOOO$ gives $n^{243} \leq 2^{422}z^{32}$, so $n^{243} < 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}$, contradicting the tail inequality.

Finally suppose $OOOOEOE$ is a cycle itinerary at $n \geq 14$. Write $z_4 = J^4(n)$ and $y = J(z_4) = \lfloor \sqrt{z_4} \rfloor$, so $z_4 < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOO$ gives $n^{81} \leq 2^{130}z_4^{16} < 2^{130}(y+1)^{32}$. Cubing yields $n^{243} < 2^{390}(y+1)^{96}$. The last letters OE give the odd-preimage bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. Write $A = n+1 \geq 15$. The same comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$ as in Lemma 3.5 holds at this smaller scale. Raising to the thirty-second power gives $(y+1)^{96} < 2^{32}(n+1)^{128}$. Combining with the cubed lower envelope produces again $n^{243} < 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.8 (small-cycle census through length seven). No itinerary of length at most seven is a cycle itinerary at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. The reduction of Theorem 3.6 applies at every length: an all-odd itinerary cannot return, and every mixed cycle itinerary rotates to an even-terminating cycle itinerary based at a cycle state $m \geq 2$. Lengths

at most six are Theorem 3.6. It remains to exclude even-terminating cycle itineraries of length seven.

By Theorem 3.2(i) a cycle itinerary is formally expanding. The even-terminating expanding length-seven words are exactly O^6E , EO^5E , OEO^4E , $OOEO^3E$, O^3EO^2E , O^4EOE , and O^5EE . Lemma 3.4(v) excludes O^6E . The itinerary EO^5E rotates one step onto O^5EE , and OEO^4E starts OE , so it cannot be a cycle minimum (Theorem 3.2(iii)) and rotates two steps onto O^4EOE ; both leftovers are excluded by Lemma 3.7.

It remains to exclude $OOEO^3E$ and O^3EO^2E . Rotate either word to a cycle minimum $m \geq 2$. For $OOEO^3E$ the minimum orientation retains the internal even letter followed by the suffix OOO . Then $m \geq 3$, the prefix through that even letter is realized, and Lemma 3.4(ii) at threshold 3 contradicts the last even one-step preimage. For O^3EO^2E the same bootstrap applies with suffix OO and threshold 5, once $m = 3$ is removed: at $m = 3$ the state after OOO is even, so the next even letter is not realized. $\square$

Theorem 3.12 (two-even leftover families). Let $k \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. Neither $O^{k-2}EE$ nor $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First, if $n \geq 256$, then

$$n^{3^{k-2}} > 2^{G_{k-2}}(n+1)^{2^k}.$$

The case $k = 6$ is the tail inequality of Lemma 3.5. If the display holds at some $k \geq 6$, cubing both sides produces

$$n^{3^{k-1}} > 2^{3G_{k-2}}(n+1)^{3 \cdot 2^k}.$$

The recurrence of Lemma 3.10 gives $G_{k-1} = 3G_{k-2} + 2^{k-1}$, so the desired comparison at length $k+1$ reduces to $2^{2^{k-1}} < (n+1)^{2^k}$. Equivalently $2 < (n+1)^2$, which holds for every $n \geq 256$.

Now suppose $O^{k-2}EE$ is a cycle itinerary at such an n . Write $z = J^{k-2}(n)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.10 on the prefix O^{k-2} gives $n^{3^{k-2}} \leq 2^{G_{k-2}}z^{2^{k-2}}$, hence $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{G_{k-2}}(n+1)^{2^k}$, contradicting the tail.

Finally suppose $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle itinerary at such an n . Write $z = J^{k-3}(n)$ and $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, so $z < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.10 on O^{k-3} and cubing produce $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{3G_{k-3}}(y+1)^{3 \cdot 2^{k-2}}$. The last letters OE give the odd-preimage bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$ of Lemma 3.5 applies at this scale. Raising it to the power 2^{k-2} and using $G_{k-2} = 3G_{k-3} + 2^{k-2}$ recovers again $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{G_{k-2}}(n+1)^{2^k}$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $k = 6$ and $k = 7$ are Lemmas 3.5 and 3.7. The remaining short words O^6EE , O^5EOE , and O^6EOE fail to return on the same 254-start window; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_two_even_ee` and `no_cycle_itinerary_two_even_eoe` (Appendix A). Any longer leftover of either family begins with seven consecutive odd letters, which Lemma 3.11 forbids on this window. $\square$

Theorem 3.13 (first-even transport). Let $n \geq 2$. No minimum-based cycle itinerary at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Write $y = J^{a+1}(n)$ for the state after the first even letter. Minimum-basedness gives $y \geq n$. In the first family the remainder after that letter is O^bEE with $b+2 \geq 6$; in the second it is O^bEOE with $b+3 \geq 6$. The trailing-even and last-odd one-step preimages of those remainders are measured against the cycle start n . Combined with Lemma 3.10 at the remainder start y , the same algebra as in Theorem 3.12 produces

$$y^{3^{\ell-2}} < 2^{G_{\ell-2}}(n+1)^{2^\ell} \leq 2^{G_{\ell-2}}(y+1)^{2^\ell},$$

where ℓ is the remainder length. If $y \geq 256$, the first paragraph of Theorem 3.12 supplies the opposite inequality at y .

If $y < 256$, then $n \leq y < 256$. A gapped leftover of total length at least 17 has $a \geq 7$ or $b \geq 7$, so either the prefix or the remainder realizes seven consecutive odd letters, contradicting Lemma 3.11. The finitely many short-gap words with $2 \leq a \leq 6$ and $b \leq 6$ fail to be minimum-based cycle itineraries on the window $2 \leq n < 256$; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_ee` and `no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_eoe` (Appendix A). $\square$

Theorem 3.14 (three trailing evens). Let $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Write $z = J^a(n)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 3$ gives $z < (n+1)^8$. Lemma 3.10 then yields $n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+3}}$ on any such cycle itinerary. For $n \geq 128$ the opposite comparison

$$n^{3^a} > 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+3}}$$

holds. The case $a = 6$ is $n^{729} > 2^{1330}(n+1)^{512}$. Indeed, for $n \geq 128$ one has $(n+1)^{512} < (129/128)^{512}n^{512} < e^4n^{512} < 64n^{512}$, so the claimed bound reduces to $n^{217} > 2^{1336}$. Since $n \geq 128 = 2^7$, the left side is at least 2^{1519} . Cubing the $a = 6$ comparison produces the general case: the recurrence of Lemma 3.10 reduces the inductive step to $(n+1)^4 > 2$, which holds for every $n \geq 128$.

For $2 \leq n < 128$, the case $a = 6$ is a table of evaluations of `OOOOOOEEEE`: at every such start the itinerary fails to return. The same finite check is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_oooooooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ the prefix contains seven consecutive odd letters, which Lemma 3.11 forbids on this window. $\square$

Theorem 3.15 (mixed bunched family EOOE). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. First let $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and $p = J(y)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ after the prefix O^aEO gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The letter after y is odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length one yields $y^3 \leq 4p^2 < 4(n+1)^8$. For $n \geq 4$ one has $4(n+1)^8 < (n+1)^9$, hence $y < (n+1)^3$. The even one-step preimage at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^6$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{6 \cdot 2^a}.$$

For $a = 5$ and $n \geq 314$, the opposite comparison $n^{243} > 2^{422}(n+1)^{192}$ holds. The base instance is the finite inequality $2^{422}315^{192} < 314^{243}$. If the display holds at some $n \geq 1$, the elementary comparison $n(n+2) < (n+1)^2$ upgrades it to the same display at $n+1$. Cubing then produces the comparison at $a+1$, once $(n+1)^6 > 4$. In particular the case $a = 6$ already holds for every $n \geq 16$.

For $2 \leq n < 314$ and $a = 5$, and for $2 \leq n < 16$ and $a = 6$, the itinerary fails to return; these are the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluations behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ and $n < 256$, Lemma 3.11 applies. For $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 16$, the tail of the previous paragraph applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.16 (mixed bunched family EOOEE). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary O^aEOOEE is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First let $n \geq 32$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and p for the image after the prefix O^aEOO . Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The two letters after y are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length two yields $y^9 \leq 2^{10}p^4 < 2^{10}(n+1)^{16}$. For $n \geq 32$ one has $2^{10} < (n+1)^2$, hence $y < (n+1)^2$. The even one-step preimage at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the opposite of the shared tail of Theorem 3.12 at length $k = a + 2$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.17 (mixed bunched family EOOOEE). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^aEOOOEE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 3$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and p for the image after the prefix O^aEOOO . Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The three letters after y are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length three yields $y^{27} \leq 2^{38}p^8 < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. For $n \geq 3$ one has $2^{38} < (n+1)^{22}$, hence $y < (n+1)^2$. The

even one-step preimage at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the opposite of the shared tail of Theorem 3.12 at length $k = a + 2$, already used in Theorem 3.16.

Now let $a = 3$ and $n \geq 256$. The same two-even one-step preimage gives $z < (y+1)^2$, so Lemma 3.10 at the prefix O^3 yields $n^{27} < 2^{38}(y+1)^{16}$. The three-odd envelope on y still gives $y^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$.

If $y < 39$, then $n^{27} < 2^{38} \cdot 39^{16}$. The numerical comparison $2^{38} \cdot 39^{16} < 24^{27}$ contradicts $n \geq 24$.

If $y \geq 39$, the numerical comparison $40^{27} < 2 \cdot 39^{27}$ upgrades to $(y+1)^{27} < 2y^{27}$, hence $(y+1)^{27} < 2^{39}(n+1)^{32}$. Cubing the prefix bound three times produces $n^{729} < 2^{1026}(y+1)^{432}$. Raising the successor bound to the sixteenth power produces $(y+1)^{432} < 2^{624}(n+1)^{512}$. Combining these displays yields $n^{729} < 2^{1650}(n+1)^{512}$. The opposite comparison holds at $n = 197$ and persists to every larger start by the elementary comparison $n(n+2) < (n+1)^2$ already used in Theorem 3.15.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 3, 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eooooe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.18 (mixed bunched family $EEOE$). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^a EEOE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First let $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$ and y for the last odd letter of $O^a EEOE$. The suffix EOE is a cycle suffix, so the last-odd cube of Theorem 3.15 gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The two letters between z and y are even, so $z < (y+1)^4$. For $n \geq 4$ the successor comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$ upgrades this to $z < (n+1)^6$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy the same display as Theorem 3.15:

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{6 \cdot 2^a}.$$

The opposite comparison is therefore the tail of Theorem 3.15: it holds for $a = 5$ and $n \geq 314$, and already for $a = 6$ and $n \geq 16$.

For $2 \leq n < 314$ and $a = 5$, and for $2 \leq n < 16$ and $a = 6$, the itinerary fails to return; these are the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluations behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ and $n < 256$, Lemma 3.11 applies. For $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 16$, the tail of the previous paragraph applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.19 (mixed bunched family $EOEOE$). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^a EOEOE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First let $n \geq 32$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $w = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and y for the last odd letter. The suffix EOE again gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The one-odd envelope on w yields $w^3 \leq 4s^2$, where s is the image after $O^a EO$. The last-odd one-step preimage and $n \geq 32$ upgrade this to $w < (n+1)^2$, hence $z < (w+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{G_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the shared tail already used in Theorem 3.16.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eoeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.20 (mixed bunched family $EOOEOE$). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The itinerary $O^a EOOEOE$ is not a cycle itinerary at n .

Proof. First let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $u = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and y for the last odd letter. The suffix EOE gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$, hence $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$. The two letters after u are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length two yields $u^9 \leq 2^{10}s^4 < 2^{10}(y+1)^8$. Cubing that display against the last-odd successor bound

produces $u^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. The same comparison as in Theorem 3.17 then gives $u < (n+1)^2$, hence $z < (u+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle itinerary would satisfy the shared two-even tail of Theorem 3.16.

Now let $a = 3$ and $n \geq 256$. The prefix O^3 against $z < (u+1)^2$ yields $n^{27} < 2^{38}(u+1)^{16}$, and the two-odd plus last-odd geometry of the previous paragraph yields $u^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. These are the same two displays as in the $a = 3$ case of Theorem 3.17, with u in place of y , and the same small/large split applies.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 3, 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `decide +kernel` evaluation behind `no_cycle_itinerary_three_even_eooeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.21 (gapped leftovers as cycle itineraries). Let $n \geq 2$. No cycle itinerary at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Every cycle itinerary has a minimum-based rotation. It is therefore enough to check that every cyclic shift of either word is an already-excluded cycle-minimum orientation.

Write w for the gapped word. In the first family, $|w| = a + b + 3$. The rotation by $k = 0$ is the original itinerary, excluded as a cycle minimum by Theorem 3.13. The rotation by $k = a + 1$ is the bootstrap itinerary O^bEEO^aE . That itinerary has an internal even letter and last gap at least 2. If $a \geq 3$, the last-gap threshold of Lemma 3.4 at OOO and $N = 3$ excludes it. If $a = 2$, the same lemma at OO and $N = 5$ excludes every start $n \geq 5$; the remaining odd start $n = 3$ does not realize four consecutive odd letters, so it cannot follow O^b for $b \geq 4$. The rotation by $k = a + b + 2$ begins with the last even letter of w , which Theorem 3.2 forbids at a cycle minimum. Every other rotation ends with an odd letter, likewise forbidden at a cycle minimum.

In the second family, $|w| = a + b + 4$. The same four classes appear: the original word is Theorem 3.13; the rotation by $k = a + 1$ is O^bEOEO^aE , excluded by the same last-gap thresholds, with the remaining start $n = 3$ and $a = 2$ either failing to realize four odds or, when $b = 3$, reaching 6 after $OOOE$ and then meeting an odd letter; the rotation by $k = a + b + 2$ begins OE , forbidden by Theorem 3.2; and every other rotation ends odd.

The original start need not be a cycle minimum. After rotation the start is a minimum, so the hypothesis $y < n$ that blocked Theorem 3.13 does not arise. $\square$

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